NAṢĪR AL-DĪN AL-ṬŪSĪ

Tajrīd al-iʿtiqād

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Arabic text with a complete English translation

Revised working translation

Prepared for Sachi

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Editorial note

This volume translates the complete matn across all six divisions, from the author's preface to the final conditions of enjoining what is right and forbidding what is wrong. English appears on the left and Arabic on the right. The passages remain aligned and numbered for comparison. The text is complete in scope; its translations and textual judgments remain open to scholarly revision.

The controlling Arabic text is the matn quoted in al-Ḥillī's Kashf al-murād, in the edition of Ḥasan Ḥasanzāda Āmulī available through Rafed. References marked "Āmulī" give that source's printed or electronic pagination, not the page numbers of this translation. Al-Ḥillī's explanations were consulted throughout to resolve compressed wording. His full commentary and the modern editor's annotations are outside the translated text.

Al-Jalālī's standalone edition was inspected at selected difficult passages. Differences are recorded in the notes; the two texts have not been silently combined. Three confirmed transcription errors are corrected in the displayed Arabic at §§312, 579, and 822. This is an independent translation from Arabic. During revision, the limited public preview of Naqavi's 2025 edition was consulted for textual and editorial comparison; the complete book was not collated.

The accuracy review checks the English against both the Arabic lemma and its attached explanation. The subsequent style review preserves negation, quantifiers, modality, causal direction, and the distinction between an argument and an objection. Supplied interpretations remain visible in brackets. Unresolved readings remain identified in notes.

How to read the text

Arabic in square brackets gives the corresponding technical term, normally at its first occurrence in each numbered passage and each footnote. The Arabic is given in a standard lexical form. English in square brackets marks wording supplied in translation.

Black division and chapter headings reproduce the source structure. Muted green descriptive headings are editorial reading aids, generally following the subject divisions in al-Ḥillī's commentary.

The 836 reference numbers are editorial. Unit 1 contains the preface and first argument and is displayed as 1a and 1b. Notes at the foot of the page identify difficult readings, source differences, and consequential interpretive choices.

Claims about theology, history, and transmitted reports remain the author's claims. Translation of them does not by itself authenticate every report.

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Source coverage in the Āmulī edition: I, pp.20–135; II, pp.136–279; III, pp.280–344; IV, pp.345–360; V, pp.361–398; VI, pp.399–428.

Author’s preface

§1a In the name of God, the Merciful, the Compassionate. After praising the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود] for His blessings, and invoking blessings upon the foremost of His prophets, Muḥammad the Chosen, and upon the most honoured of His trusted ones, I respond to the request that I formulate the questions of kalām precisely and arrange them in the most effective order, pointing to the choice benefits of belief and the subtleties of questions of independent inquiry, in accordance with what proof has led me to and upon which my conviction has become firm. I have entitled it The Abstract of Belief (Tajrīd al-iʿtiqād). I ask God for protection from error and for correctness, and that He make it a provision for me on the Day of Return. I have arranged it in divisions.[1]

(1a) بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم أما بعد حمد واجب الوجود على نعمائه والصلاة على سيد أنبيائه محمد المصطفى وعلى أكرم أمنائه فإني مجيب إلى ما سئلت من تحرير مسائل الكلام وترتيبها على أبلغ نظام مشيرا إلى غرر فوائد الاعتقاد ونكت مسائل الاجتهاد مما قادني الدليل إليه وقوي اعتقادي عليه وسميته بتجريد الاعتقاد والله أسأل العصمة والسداد وأن يجعله ذخرا ليوم المعاد ورتبته على مقاصد

Āmulī pp. 20–21 ·

[1] §1. The Arabic umanā’ is rendered ‘trusted ones’. The controlling recension reads ‘my conviction’ (iʿtiqādī); al-Jalālī, p.101, and the public Arabic preview of Naqavi’s 2025 edition read ‘my reliance’ (iʿtimādī). The preface and the opening division and chapter headings occur in this first source block.

Division 1
General matters

المقصد الأول في الأمور العامة

This division comprises chapters.

Chapter 1 · Existence and nonexistence

الفصل الأول في الوجود والعدم

§1b Defining them as ‘that whose entity is established’ and ‘that whose entity is negated’, or as ‘that about which information can be given’ and its opposite, or in other such ways, involves an evident circle [الدور الظاهر]. §2 Rather, the intention is to explain the expression, for nothing is better known than existence [الوجود]. §3 Arguing [for its indefinability] from the dependence upon it of assent [التصديق] to incompatibility, or from a thing’s dependence upon itself, or from the noncomposition of existence [الوجود] while supposing it [composite], or by invalidating descriptive definition [الرسم], is unsound.[2]

(1b) وتحديدهما بالثابت العين والمنفي العين أو الذي يمكن أن يخبر عنه ونقيضه أو بغير ذلك يشتمل على دور ظاهر ... (2) بل المراد تعريف اللفظ إذ لا شيء أعرف من الوجود. (3) والاستدلال بتوقف التصديق بالتنافي عليه أو بتوقف الشيء على نفسه أو عدم تركيب الوجود مع فرضه ، أو إبطال الرسم باطل. · Āmulī pp. 20–22

The common meaning of existence

§4 The following establish that [existence] [الوجود] has a common meaning: the mind’s hesitation [about what a thing is] while remaining certain of existence without qualification; the unity of the concept of its contradictory; and its admitting division.[3]

(4) وتردد الذهن حال الجزم بمطلق الوجود واتحاد مفهوم نقيضه وقبوله القسمة يعطي اشتراكه · Āmulī pp. 24

Existence and quiddity

§5 It therefore differs from quiddity [الماهية]; otherwise quiddities would be identical, or their constituent parts would have no limit. §6 Also because the two can be separated in thought; §7 because possibility in the strict sense [الإمكان الخاص] is realised; §8 because predication [الحمل] is informative; §9 because [affirming existence] [الوجود] requires inference;

(5) فيغاير الماهية وإلا اتحدت الماهيات أو لم تنحصر أجزاؤها (6) ولانفكاكهما تعقلا. (7) وتحقق الإمكان الخاص. (8) وفائدة الحمل. (9) والحاجة إلى الاستدلال. · Āmulī pp. 24–26

[2] §3. These are rejected arguments for the indefinability of existence [الوجود], not a rejection of the claim that existence is indefinable. Al-Ḥillī explains the weaknesses in each argument; the pronouns have been kept close to the compressed matn.

[3] §4. ‘A common meaning’ does not here entail equal predication [الحمل] in every instance. The later discussion expressly uses tashkīk, analogical or graded predication. It should not automatically be identified with later Ṣadrian doctrines of the gradation of existence [الوجود].

§10 because [denying existence [الوجود] of a quiddity] [الماهية] entails no contradiction [التناقض]; §11 and because [otherwise] the Necessary would be composite. §12 It subsists in quiddity [الماهية] insofar as it is itself.[4] §13 Its being additional [to quiddity] [الماهية] is thus in conception [التصور].

(10) وانتفاء التناقض. (11) وتركب الواجب.
(12) وقيامه بالماهية من حيث هي. (13) فزيادته في التصور. · Āmulī pp. 26–27

Mental and external existence

§14 It divides into mental and external [existence] [الوجود]; otherwise [real propositions] would be invalid.[5] §15 What exists in the mind is only the form [الصورة], which differs [from its external instance] in many concomitants.

(14) وهو ينقسم إلى الذهني والخارجي وإلا بطلت الحقيقة. (15) والموجود في الذهن إنما هو الصورة المخالفة في كثير من اللوازم. · Āmulī p. 28

Existence as realisation

§16 Existence [الوجود] is not a meaning by which quiddity [الماهية] is realised externally; it is that realisation itself.

(16) وليس الوجود معنى به تحصل الماهية في العين بل الحصول · Āmulī p. 29

Increase and intensification

§17 It admits neither increase nor intensification.

(17) ولا تزايد فيه ولا اشتداد · Āmulī p. 29

The goodness of existence

§18 It is pure good.

(18) وهو خير محض. · Āmulī p. 29

Existence has no contrary

§19 It has no contrary [الضد].

(19) ولا ضد له. · Āmulī p. 30

Existence has no like

§20 Nor has it a like.

(20) ولا مثل. · Āmulī p. 30

Existence and other intelligibles

§21 Its difference from [other] intelligibles [المعقول] is thereby established. §22 Yet it is not incompatible with them.

(21) فتحققت مخالفته للمعقولات. (22) ولا ينافيها : · Āmulī p. 31

[4] §12. This subsistence is understood conceptually, as the following clause explains; it does not posit existence [الوجود] as an additional external accident [العرض] inhering in an independently existent quiddity [الماهية].

[5] §14. The received line prints al-ḥaqīqa; al-Ḥillī explains it through real propositions (qaḍāyā ḥaqīqiyya), whose subjects need not presently exist externally. The bracketed rendering follows that explanation.

Existence and thingness

§23 It is coextensive with thingness [الشيئية] (shay'iyya), which is therefore not realised without it. Whoever disputes this resists the deliverance of his own reason. §24 How could [thingness] [الشيئية] be realised without it, while effective power [القدرة] is affirmed and qualification [as an additional external entity] is denied?[6] §25 And [how could this be so] given the finitude of what exists and the unintelligibility of anything additional [to external being]? §26 If differentiation entailed establishment [الثبوت] externally, impossibilities would follow. §27 Possibility [الإمكان] is conceptual, and it applies to things whose absence [externally] they concede to us.

(23) ويساوق الشيئية فلا تتحقق بدونه والمنازع مكابر مقتضى عقله. (24) وكيف تتحقق بدونه مع إثبات القدرة وانتفاء الاتصاف. (25) وانحصار الموجود مع عدم تعقل الزائد. (26) ولو اقتضى التمييز الثبوت عينا لزم منه محالات.
(27) والإمكان اعتباري يعرض لما وافقونا على انتفائه.

Āmulī pp. 32–34 ·

The rejection of states

§28 Existence [الوجود] is synonymous with establishment [الثبوت] (thubūt), and nonexistence [العدم] with negation; there is therefore no intermediate [state] [الحال].[7] §29 Existence [الوجود] does not admit the [proposed] division; the universal [الكلي] is established mentally; and an accident [العرض] may subsist in an accident. §30 They are also refuted by the state [الحال] (ḥāl) itself. §31 The excuses that [states] [الحال] admit neither likeness nor difference, and that an infinite regress [التسلسل] may be accepted, are unsound.

(28) وهو يرادف الثبوت ، والعدم النفي ، فلا واسطة. (29) والوجود لا ترد عليه القسمة والكلي ثابت ذهنا ويجوز قيام العرض بالعرض.
(30) ونوقضوا بالحال نفسها. (31) والعذر بعدم قبول التماثل والاختلاف والتزام التسلسل باطل.

Āmulī pp. 35–36 ·

Consequences of nonexistent essences and states

§32 Thus what they build upon the two [doctrines] is invalid: the realisation of infinitely many essences [الذات] in nonexistence [العدم]; the absence of an efficient cause [المؤثر]'s influence upon them and of differentiation among them; their disagreement over affirming the generic attribute and what follows it in existence [الوجود]; spatial occupancy [التحيز]'s difference from substantiality [الجوهرية]; affirming an attribute of the nonexistent in virtue of its being nonexistent; the possibility [الإمكان] of describing it as corporeal; and doubt about the Maker's existence after ascribing power [القدرة], knowledge [العلم], and life to Him.[8] §33 Likewise [invalid are] dividing states [الحال] into caused and uncaused, explaining difference by them, and other matters whose mention brings no benefit.

(32) فبطل ما فرعوا عليهما من تحقق الذوات الغير المتناهية في العدم وانتفاء تأثير المؤثر فيها وتباينها واختلافهم في إثبات صفة الجنس وما يتبعها في الوجود ومغايرة التحيز للجوهرية وإثبات صفة المعدوم بكونه معدوما وإمكان وصفه بالجسمية ووقوع الشك في إثبات الصانع بعد اتصافه بالقدرة والعلم والحياة. (33) وقسمة الحال إلى المعلل وغيره وتعليل الاختلاف بها وغير ذلك مما لا فائدة بذكره.

Āmulī pp. 37, 39 ·

[6] §24. The argument targets a theory on which essences are established while nonexistent and existence [الوجود] is a state. If neither essence, existence, nor an additional fact of qualification can be the effect of power [القدرة], effective power is left with nothing to produce. 'Qualification' is not simply denied as a meaningful predication [الحمل].

[7] §28. Thubūt [الثبوت] is kept distinct in translation even where Ṭūsī explicitly equates its extension with existence [الوجود]. The rejected intermediate is the technical ḥāl of the theory of states [الحال].

[8] §32. This is a compressed list of consequences and disputes within the doctrines under criticism, not a list of Ṭūsī's own positive theses. Al-Ḥillī takes the negation to include differentiation between essences [الذات] themselves; differentiation is instead assigned to attributes accruing to them.

Unqualified and qualified existence

§34 Existence [الوجود] may be considered without qualification, in which case a corresponding nonexistence [العدم] opposes it. The two may be combined when not considered as opposites, and both are intelligible [المعقول]. It may also be considered with a qualification, in which case a correspondingly qualified [nonexistence] opposes it.

(34) ثم الوجود قد يؤخذ على الإطلاق فيقابله عدم مثله ، وقد يجتمعان لا باعتبار التقابل ويعقلان معا ، وقد يؤخذ مقيدا فيقابله مثله. · Āmulī pp. 39

The subject of privation

§35 [Privation] [عدم الملكة] requires a subject [الموضوع], just as its corresponding possession [الملكة] does. §36 The subject [الموضوع] may be considered individually, specifically, or generically.

(35) ويفتقر إلى الموضوع كافتقار ملكته.
(36) ويؤخذ الموضوع شخصيا ونوعيا وجنسيا. · Āmulī pp. 40

The simplicity of existence

§37 Existence [الوجود] has no genus [الجنس]. Rather, it is simple, and so has no differentia [الفصل].

(37) ولا جنس له بل هو بسيط فلا فصل له. · Āmulī pp. 41

Graded predication of existence

§38 It is multiplied with the multiplicity of its subjects [الموضوع] and is predicated analogically [التشكيك] of the [particular existences] that accrue to them. §39 It is therefore not a constituent of anything else at all.

(38) ويتكثر بتكثر الموضوعات ويقال بالتشكيك على عوارضها. (39) فليس جزءا من غيره مطلقا. · Āmulī pp. 41–42

Thingness

§40 Thingness [الشيئية] is among the second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية] and is not independently rooted in existence [الوجود]. No 'thing without qualification' is therefore established [as such]; rather, [thingness] applies to the specific quiddities [الماهية].[9]

(40) والشيئية من المعقولات الثانية وليست متأصلة في الوجود فلا شيء مطلقا ثابت بل هي تعرض لخصوصيات الماهيات. · Āmulī pp. 42

Differentiation among nonexistences

§41 Nonexistences can be differentiated. Thus the nonexistence [العدم] of an effect [المعلول] depends upon the nonexistence of its cause [العلة], and not upon another [nonexistence]; the absence of a condition is incompatible with the existence [الوجود] of what is conditioned; and the absence of a contrary [الضد] makes the other contrary's existence possible, unlike other absences. §42 Nonexistence [العدم] may itself be subject to nonexistence; thus being a species [of nonexistence] and being opposed [to nonexistence] are true of it in two different respects.

(41) وقد يتمايز الأعدام ولهذا استند عدم المعلول إلى عدم العلة لا غير ، ونافى عدم الشرط وجود المشروط وصحح عدم الضد وجود الآخر بخلاف باقي الأعدام. (42) ثم العدم قد يعرض لنفسه فيصدق النوعية والتقابل عليه باعتبارين. · Āmulī pp. 43

§43 The nonexistence [العدم] of the effect [المعلول] is not a cause [العلة] of the nonexistence of the cause externally, although [the inference] is permissible mentally as a demonstration

(43) وعدم المعلول ليس علة لعدم العلة في الخارج وإن جاز في الذهن على أنه برهان إني وبالعكس

[9] §40. The denial concerns a separately established 'thing as such', not the existence [الوجود] of particular things.

from effect to cause [البرهان الإني] (innī). The reverse is a demonstration from cause to effect [البرهان اللمي] (limmī).

لمي. · Āmulī pp. 44

Generality and nonexistence

§44 Things ordered by greater and lesser generality in existence [الوجود] have the reverse order in nonexistence [العدم].

(44) والأشياء المترتبة في العموم والخصوص وجودا تتعاكس عدما. · Āmulī pp. 44

Dependence and independence

§45 Existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] each divide exclusively and exhaustively into dependent and independent.[10]

(45) وقسمة كل منهما إلى الاحتياج والغنى حقيقية. · Āmulī pp. 45

Necessity possibility and impossibility

§46 When existence [الوجود] is predicated or made a copula, three modal matters [المادة] are established in themselves. In thought they are modalities [الجهة], indicating the firmness or weakness of the connection: necessity [الوجوب] (wujūb), impossibility [الامتناع] (imtināʿ), and possibility [الإمكان] (imkān).[11] §47 The same applies to nonexistence [العدم].

(46) وإذا حمل الوجود أو جعل رابطة ثبتت مواد ثلاث في أنفسها جهات في التعقل دالة على وثاقة الربط وضعفه هي الوجوب والامتناع والإمكان.
(47) وكذلك العدم. · Āmulī pp. 45–46

Defining the three modalities

§48 The discussion of defining these is like that concerning existence [الوجود].

(48) والبحث في تعريفها كالوجود. · Āmulī pp. 46

The threefold modal division

§49 They may be considered intrinsic; the division is then exclusive and exhaustive, and [a thing's intrinsic modal status] cannot change.[12] §50 The first two may be considered through another. Their division is then mutually exclusive [but not exhaustive], and [a thing's status in it] may change; among contingent things [الممكن], the three form an exhaustive [but not mutually exclusive] division.

(49) وقد تؤخذ ذاتية فتكون القسمة حقيقية لا يمكن انقلابها. (50) وقد يؤخذ الأولان باعتبار الغير فالقسمة مانعة الجمع بينهما يمكن انقلابها ، ومانعة الخلو بين الثلاثة في الممكنات. · Āmulī pp. 46–47

Kinds of necessity and possibility

§51 Necessity [الوجوب] and impossibility [الامتناع] share the designation 'necessity [الضرورة]' (ḍarūra), although they differ by negation and affirmation. §52 Each is true of the other when their correlates are opposite [as in necessity of existence [وجوب الوجود] and impossibility [الامتناع] of nonexistence] [العدم]. §53 Possibility [الإمكان] may be taken as the negation of necessity [الضرورة] from one of the two sides; it then includes the other necessity and possibility in the strict sense

(51) ويشترك الوجوب والامتناع في اسم الضرورة وإن اختلفا بالسلب والإيجاب. (52) وكل منهما يصدق على الآخر إذا تقابلا في المضاف إليه.
(53) وقد يؤخذ الإمكان بمعنى سلب الضرورة عن أحد الطرفين فيعم الأخرى والخاص. (54) وقد

[10] §45. Ḥaqīqiyya here is a logical term: the alternatives are both exhaustive and mutually exclusive.

[11] §46. Mādda denotes the modal matter [المادة] of the connection as it is in itself; jiha denotes modality [الجهة] as conceived or expressed. The technical use differs from material substance [الجوهر].

[12] §49. "Change" (inqilab) concerns a subject's passing from one modal division to another. Al-Ḥillī contrasts immutable intrinsic necessity [الوجوب الذاتي], impossibility, and possibility [الإمكان] with necessity and impossibility through another, which change with the presence or absence of a cause.

يؤخذ بالنسبة إلى الاستقبال. (55) ولا يشترط العدم في الحال وإلا اجتمع النقيضان. · Āmulī pp. 48–49

[الإمكان الخاص]. §54 It may also be considered with reference to the future. §55 Nonexistence [العدم] in the present is not a condition [of this future possibility] [الإمكان]; otherwise contradictories would be combined.

The conceptual character of modalities

(56) والثلاثة اعتبارية لصدقها على المعدوم واستحالة التسلسل. (57) ولو كان الوجوب ثبوتيا لزم إمكان الواجب. (58) ولو كان الامتناع ثبوتيا لزم إمكان الممتنع. (59) ولو كان الإمكان ثبوتيا لزم سبق وجود كل ممكن على إمكانه. (60) والفرق بين نفي الإمكان والإمكان المنفي لا يستلزم ثبوته. · Āmulī pp. 49–51

§56 The three are conceptual considerations, since they are true of the nonexistent and an infinite regress [التسلسل] is impossible. §57 If necessity [الوجوب] were an externally established thing, the Necessary would be contingent. §58 If impossibility [الامتناع] were an externally established thing, the impossible would be possible. §59 If possibility [الإمكان] were an externally established thing, every contingent thing [الممكن]'s existence [الوجود] would precede its possibility. §60 The difference between negating possibility [الإمكان] and possibility that is negated does not entail its external establishment [الثبوت].

Intrinsic and extrinsic modalities

(61) والوجوب شامل للذاتي وغيره وكذا الامتناع. (62) ومعروض ما بالغير منهما ممكن. (63) ولا ممكن بالغير لما تقدم في القسمة الحقيقية. · Āmulī pp. 51–52

§61 Necessity [الوجوب] encompasses what is intrinsic and what is through another; the same holds for impossibility [الامتناع]. §62 What is subject to either of them through another is intrinsically contingent. §63 There is no 'possible through another', given what preceded concerning the exclusive and exhaustive division.

Modalities and quiddity

(64) وعروض الإمكان عند عدم اعتبار الوجود والعدم بالنظر إلى الماهية وعلتها. (65) وعند اعتبارهما بالنظر إليهما يثبت ما بالغير. (66) ولا منافاة بين الإمكان والغيري. (67) وكل ممكن العروض ذاتي ولا عكس. · Āmulī pp. 52–53

§64 Possibility [الإمكان] applies when existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] are left out of consideration with respect to both the quiddity [الماهية] and its cause [العلة]. §65 When they are considered with respect to these two, [necessity [الوجوب] or impossibility] [الامتناع] through another is established. §66 There is no incompatibility between possibility [الإمكان] and [necessity [الوجوب] or impossibility] [الامتناع] through another. §67 Whatever can possibly inhere [in another] is intrinsically possible, but the converse does not hold.[13]

The ground of dependence on a cause

(68) وإذا لحظ الذهن الممكن موجودا طلب العلة وإن لم يتصور غيره وقد يتصور وجود الحادث فلا يطلبها ثم الحدوث كيفية الوجود فليس علة لما يتقدم عليه بمراتب. · Āmulī pp. 53

§68 When the mind considers a contingent thing [الممكن] as existent, it seeks its cause [العلة] even without conceiving anything else. It may conceive an originated thing [الحادث]'s existence [الوجود] [if hypothetically taken as intrinsically necessary] without seeking [a cause]. Moreover, origination [الحدوث] is a manner of existence, so cannot cause what precedes it by several ranks.[14]

[13] §67. 'Possible inherence' concerns the possibility [الإمكان] of something's belonging to another; it must not be collapsed into intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي]. Al-Ḥillī gives immaterial entities and necessary concomitant attributes as cases defeating the converse.

[14] §68. Al-Ḥillī explains the second sentence through the hypothetical supposition of an originated but intrinsically necessary existent

The contingent needs a cause

§69 The judgment that a contingent thing [الممكن] requires [a cause] [العلة] is non-inferential [الضروري].

(69) والحكم باحتياج الممكن ضروري. · Āmulī pp. 54

The necessity conferred by a cause

§70 No priority [الأولوية] of either side [existence [الوجود] or nonexistence] [العدم] can be conceived by considering the thing's essence [الذات] alone. §71 Nor is an external priority [الأولوية] sufficient: supposing it does not make the opposite impossible. One must therefore arrive at necessity [الوجوب]. §72 This [necessity] [الوجوب] is antecedent. Another necessity follows [existence] [الوجود], and no proposition of actuality is without it. §73 Possibility [الإمكان] is inseparable [from a contingent quiddity] [الماهية]; otherwise the quiddity would become necessary or impossible. §74 The necessity [الوجوب] belonging to propositions of actuality accompanies the possibility [الجواز] of nonexistence [العدم], and is therefore not inseparable [from the quiddity] [الماهية].

(70) ولا نتصور الأولوية لأحد الطرفين بالنظر إلى ذاته. (71) ولا تكفي الخارجية لأن فرضها لا يحيل المقابل فلا بد من الانتهاء إلى الوجوب. (72) وهو سابق ويلحقه وجوب آخر لا يخلو عنه قضية فعلية. (73) والإمكان لازم وإلا تجب الماهية أو تمتنع. (74) ووجوب الفعليات يقارنه جواز العدم فليس بلازم. · Āmulī pp. 54–56

§75 Necessity [الوجوب] stands to possibility [الإمكان] as completeness to deficiency.

(75) ونسبة الوجوب إلى الإمكان نسبة تمام إلى نقص. · Āmulī pp. 56

Dispositional possibility

§76 Dispositional possibility [الإمكان الاستعدادي] admits strength and weakness; it ceases to exist and comes to exist in composites, and it differs from intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي].

(76) والاستعدادي قابل للشدة والضعف ويعدم ويوجد للمركبات وهو غير الإمكان الذاتي. · Āmulī pp. 56

Eternity and origination

§77 An existent, considered as unpreceded by another or by nonexistence [العدم], is eternal [القديم] (qadīm); otherwise it is originated [الحادث] (ḥādith).[15] §78 Priority [السبق] and its two counterparts [posteriority and simultaneity] are either in respect of causality [العلية], nature, time, sensible or intelligible rank, excellence, or essence [الذات]. This enumeration rests on induction [الاستقراء].

(77) والموجود إن أخذ غير مسبوق بالغير أو بالعدم فقديم وإلا فحادث. (78) والسبق ومقابلاه إما بالعلية أو بالطبع أو بالزمان أو بالرتبة الحسية أو العقلية أو بالشرف أو بالذات والحصر استقرائي. · Āmulī pp. 57

Graded predication of priority

§79 [Priority] [السبق] is predicated analogically [التشكيك], and the correlation between the two correlates is preserved throughout the kinds of [analogical predication]. §80 Where such gradation occurs, [priority] [السبق] cannot be a genus [الجنس]. §81 Priority [التقدم] always occurs through some

(79) ومقوليته بالتشكيك وتحفظ الإضافة بين المضافين في أنواعه. (80) وحيث وجد التفاوت امتنع جنسيته. (81) والتقدم دائما بعارض زماني أو مكاني أو غيرهما. (82) والقدم والحدوث

[واجب الوجود], which he expressly calls impossible. The point is to isolate possibility [الإمكان] as the ground of dependence; it is not an assertion that an actual originated thing [الحادث] exists without a cause [العلة].

[15] §77. Qidam and ḥudūth are subsequently distinguished according to kinds of priority. 'Eternal [القديم]' here includes the discussion of being unpreceded by a cause, and is not throughout merely a statement about infinite past time.

temporal, spatial, or other concomitant. §82 Eternity [القدم] and origination [الحدوث] in their proper senses do not include time in their consideration; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow. §83 Essential origination [الحدوث الذاتي] is realised.

الحقيقيان لا يعتبر فيهما الزمان وإلا تسلسل.
(83) والحدوث الذاتي متحقق. · Āmulī pp. 58–60

§84 Eternity [القدم] and origination [الحدوث] are two intellectual considerations that cease when the consideration ceases. §85 They form an exclusive and exhaustive disjunction.

(84) والقدم والحدوث اعتباران عقليان ينقطعان بانقطاع الاعتبار. (85) وتصدق الحقيقية منهما. · Āmulī pp. 60

Properties of the Necessary

§86 The same holds of intrinsic necessity [الوجوب الذاتي] and necessity through another [الوجوب بالغير] [as a division of every existent]. §87 Intrinsic [necessity] [الوجوب] cannot be true of a composite. §88 Nor can what is intrinsically [necessary] be a constituent of something else.

(86) ومن الوجوب الذاتي والغيري.
(87) ويستحيل صدق الذاتي على المركب.
(88) ولا يكون الذاتي جزءا من غيره. · Āmulī pp. 61–62

The existence and necessity of the Necessary

§89 Its existence [الوجود] and its relation [النسبة] [of necessity] [الوجوب] are not additional to it; otherwise it would be contingent. §90 The existence [الوجود] that is known is what is predicated analogically, not the existence proper to Him. §91 Existence [الوجود] is not a specific nature, as already explained; its instances can therefore differ as to whether it is predicated as additional or not. §92 It is unintelligible that quiddity [الماهية] as such should produce existence [الوجود]. §93 The counterexample drawn from the recipient is plainly invalid.

(89) ولا يزيد وجوده ونسبته عليه وإلا لكان ممكنا.
(90) والوجود المعلوم هو المقول بالتشكيك أما الخاص به فلا. (91) وليس طبيعة نوعية على ما سلف فجاز اختلاف جزئياته في العروض وعدمه.
(92) وتأثير الماهية من حيث هي في الوجود غير معقول. (93) والنقض بالقابل ظاهر البطلان. · Āmulī pp. 62–64

§94 Existence [الوجود] is among intellectual predicates, because it can neither be independent of a substrate [المحل] nor occur in one [as an additional external accident] [العرض].[16] §95 It is among the second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية]. §96 The same holds of nonexistence [العدم]; §97 of their modalities; §98 of quiddity [الماهية];

(94) والوجود من المحمولات العقلية لامتناع استغنائه عن المحل وحصوله فيه. (95) وهو من المعقولات الثانية. (96) وكذلك العدم.
(97) وجهاتهما. (98) والماهية. · Āmulī pp. 65–66

§99 of universality [الكلية] and particularity [الجزئية]; §100 of essentiality and accidentality [العرضية]; §101 and of genericity [الجنسية], differentiality [الفصلية], and specificity.

(99) والكلية والجزئية. (100) والذاتية والعرضية.
(101) والجنسية والفصلية والنوعية. · Āmulī pp. 66–67

[16] §94. The argument denies that existence [الوجود] is an additional externally inhering item alongside its subject. It does not assert that nothing exists outside thought.

Conceiving nonexistence

§102 The intellect [العقل] can consider two contradictories and judge them to contradict one another; there is no impossibility [الاستحالة] in this. §103 It can also conceive the nonexistence [العدم] of all things, even its own nonexistence and the nonexistence of nonexistence, by representing [nonexistence] in the mind and negating it. [This negation] is established in one respect and an opposed alternative in another. No judgment can be made about it precisely insofar as it is not established; there is no contradiction [التناقض].[17]

§104 Thus we divide the existent into what is established in the mind and what is not, and judge the two to be distinct. This does not require an identity for each of the things distinguished. Were an identity posited for [the latter], it would have the same status as what is established. §105 When the mind predicates external matters of external matters, a correct judgment must correspond [to what is external]; otherwise this is not required. Its correctness then consists in correspondence to the matter as it is in itself [نفس الأمر] (nafs al-amr), since falsehoods too can be conceived.[18]

(102) وللعقل أن يعتبر النقيضين ويحكم بينهما بالتناقض ولا استحالة فيه. (103) وأن يتصور عدم جميع الأشياء حتى عدم نفسه وعدم العدم بأن يتمثل في الذهن ويرفعه وهو ثابت باعتبار ، قسيم باعتبار ولا يصح الحكم عليه من حيث هو ليس بثابت ولا تناقض. · Āmulī pp. 67–68

(104) ولهذا نقسم الموجود إلى ثابت في الذهن وغير ثابت فيه ونحكم بينهما بالتمايز وهو لا يستدعي الهوية لكل من المتمايزين ولو فرض له هوية لكان حكمها حكم الثابت. (105) وإذا حكم الذهن على الأمور الخارجية بمثلها وجب التطابق في صحيحه وإلا فلا ويكون صحيحه باعتبار مطابقته لما في نفس الأمر لإمكان تصور الكواذب. · Āmulī pp. 68–69

Predicating existence and nonexistence

§106 Existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] may be predicated, or they may connect predicates [to subjects] [الموضوع]. §107 Predication [الحمل] requires the two terms to be identical in one respect and different in another. The respect of identity may be one of the two, or a third. §108 Difference does not require either to subsist in the other. Even if it did, such subsistence would not require the absence of what subsists [to be included in considering its subject] [الموضوع].
§109 Affirming the existence [الوجود] of quiddity [الماهية] does not require quiddity to exist beforehand.

§110 Denying its existence [الوجود] does not require its differentiation and establishment [الثبوت]. It is the negation of it, rather than the affirmation of a negation as belonging to it. Its establishment in the mind, though consequent, is not a condition. §111 Predication [الحمل] and subjecthood [الوضع] are second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية] and are predicated analogically [التشكيك]. Being qualified [by a predicate] is not an externally established entity; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow.

(106) ثم الوجود والعدم قد يحملان وقد يربط بهما المحمولات. (107) والحمل يستدعي اتحاد الطرفين من وجه وتغايرهما من آخر وجهة الاتحاد قد تكون أحدهما وقد تكون ثالثا. (108) والتغاير لا يستدعي قيام أحدهما بالآخر ولا اعتبار عدم القائم في القيام لو استدعاه. (109) وإثبات الوجود للماهية لا يستدعي وجودها أولا. · Āmulī pp. 70–71

(110) وسلبه عنها لا يقتضي تميزها وثبوتها بل نفيها لا إثبات نفيها ، وثبوتها في الذهن وإن كان لازما لكنه ليس شرطا. (111) والحمل والوضع من المعقولات الثانية يقالان بالتشكيك وليست الموصوفية ثبوتية وإلا تسلسل. · Āmulī pp. 72

[17] §103. The distinction is between nonexistence [العدم] as an object conceived and nonexistence precisely insofar as it is not established. No existent external object is supplied merely by conceiving it.

[18] §105. Nafs al-amr is rendered 'the matter as it is in itself [نفس الأمر]'. Al-Ḥillī's commentary records a further discussion with Ṭūsī concerning the Active Intellect [العقل الفعال], but that explanatory discussion is not part of this matn and has not been inserted into its translation.

Existence per se and per accidens

§112 Existence [الوجود] may be per se [بالذات] or per accidens [بالعرض]. §113 As for existence [الوجود] in writing or speech, that is figurative.

(112) ثم الوجود قد يكون بالذات وقد يكون بالعرض. (113) وأما الوجود في الكتابة والعبارة فمجازي.

Āmulī pp. 73 ·

Restoration after nonexistence

§114 What has ceased to exist cannot be restored [as numerically the same], since it cannot be pointed to; one therefore cannot judge that its restoration [الإعادة] is possible.[19] §115 If it were restored, nonexistence [العدم] would intervene between a thing and itself. §116 No difference would remain between it and what is newly originated. §117 Opposite determinations would be true of it at once. §118 An infinite regress [التسلسل] in time would also follow.

(114) والمعدوم لا يعاد لامتناع الإشارة إليه فلا يصح الحكم عليه بصحة العود. (115) ولو أعيد تخلل العدم بين الشيء ونفسه. (116) ولم يبق فرق بينه وبين المبتدأ. (117) وصدق المتقابلان عليه دفعة. (118) ويلزم التسلسل في الزمان.

Āmulī pp. 73–75 ·

§119 The judgment that restoration [الإعادة] is impossible rests upon something inseparable from the quiddity [الماهية] [under the relevant qualification].[20]

(119) والحكم بامتناع العود لأمر لازم للماهية.

Āmulī pp. 75 ·

Necessary and contingent existents

§120 The division of the existent into necessary and contingent is non-inferential [الضروري]. It applies to existence [الوجود] insofar as existence admits qualification and the absence of qualification.

(120) وقسمة الموجود إلى الواجب والممكن ضرورية وردت على الوجود من حيث هو قابل للتقييد وعدمه.

Āmulī pp. 75 ·

Judging possibility

§121 Judging that a contingent thing [الممكن]'s existence [الوجود] is possible is a judgment about the quiddity [الماهية] without considering existence or nonexistence [العدم]. §122 Possibility [الإمكان] may be an instrument of intellection [التعقل], or it may itself be intelligible [المعقول] as an object in its own right. §123 The mind's judgment that a contingent thing [الممكن] is possible is an intellectual consideration; its correspondence to what is in the intellect [العقل] must therefore be considered.[21]

(121) والحكم على الممكن بإمكان الوجود حكم على الماهية لا باعتبار العدم والوجود. (122) ثم الإمكان قد يكون آلة في التعقل وقد يكون معقولا باعتبار ذاته (123) وحكم الذهن على الممكن بالإمكان اعتبار عقلي فيجب أن تعتبر مطابقته لما في العقل.

Āmulī pp. 76–77 ·

The immediacy of the judgment of dependence

§124 The judgment that a contingent thing [الممكن] requires [a cause] [العلة] is non-inferential [الضروري]. The obscurity of assent [التصديق] due to the obscurity of conception [التصور] does not impair this. §125 Causal efficacy [المؤثرية] is an

(124) والحكم بحاجة الممكن ضروري وخفاء التصديق لخفاء التصور غير قادح. (125) والمؤثرية

[19] §114. The claim concerns restoring the numerically identical thing after its complete cessation. It must be read with Division VI, where bodily resurrection is defended by reassembling the original parts. It is not a denial of resurrection.

[20] §119. Al-Ḥillī explains the qualification as a quiddity [الماهية] that has become nonexistent after existing. Without that qualification the sentence would misleadingly suggest that the thing could never have existed initially.

[21] §123. This formulation is retained alongside §105. A full commentary would need to distinguish the mental character of the modal judgment from the criterion of its truth; the translation does not silently harmonise the wording.

intellectual consideration. §126 The efficient cause [المؤثر] produces the effect [الأثر] neither insofar as the effect is existent nor insofar as it is nonexistent. §127 Its influence is upon the quiddity [الماهية], and consequent necessity [الوجوب اللاحق] follows it. §128 The nonexistence [العدم] of a contingent thing [الممكن] depends upon the nonexistence of its cause [العلة], as already explained.

اعتبار عقلي. (126) والمؤثر يؤثر في الأثر لا من حيث هو موجود ولا من حيث هو معدوم. (127) وتأثيره في الماهية ويلحقه وجوب لاحق. (128) وعدم الممكن يستند إلى عدم علته على ما مر. · Āmulī pp. 78–80

Dependence throughout persistence

§129 A contingent thing [الممكن] that persists requires an efficient cause [المؤثر], because the ground [of its need] remains present. §130 The efficient cause [المؤثر] confers persistence after origination [الإحداث]. §131 Consequently, if an eternal [القديم] contingent thing [الممكن] were possible, it could depend upon a necessitating efficient cause [المؤثر الموجب]; it could not depend upon an agent acting by choice [الفاعل المختار].[22]

(129) والممكن الباقي مفتقر إلى المؤثر لوجود علته. (130) والمؤثر يفيد البقاء بعد الإحداث. (131) فلهذا جاز استناد القديم الممكن إلى المؤثر الموجب لو أمكن ولا يمكن استناده إلى المختار. · Āmulī pp. 81–82

No second eternal existent

§132 There is nothing eternal [القديم] besides God Most High, as will be shown.

(132) ولا قديم سوى الله تعالى لما يأتي : · Āmulī pp. 82

Duration and matter before origination

§133 An originated thing [الحادث] does not require a preceding duration and matter [المادة]; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow.

(133) ولا يفتقر الحادث إلى المدة والمادة وإلا لزم التسلسل. · Āmulī pp. 83

The impossibility of an eternal existent ceasing

§134 What is eternal [القديم] cannot cease to exist, because it is either intrinsically necessary or depends upon what is.

(134) والقديم لا يجوز عليه العدم لوجوبه بالذات أو لاستناده إليه. · Āmulī pp. 84

Chapter 2 · Quiddity and its concomitants

الفصل الثاني في الماهية ولواحقها

§135 'Quiddity [الماهية]' (māhiyya) derives from 'what is it?' (mā huwa), and is that by which the question 'What is it?' is answered. It is most often applied to what is conceived. 'Essence [الذات]' (dhāt) and 'reality [الحقيقة]' (ḥaqīqa) apply to it with existence [الوجود] taken into account. All are second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية]. §136 The reality [الحقيقة] of each thing is one, and differs from the considerations that attach to it; otherwise it could not be true of what conflicts with those considerations. §137 Quiddity [الماهية] together with any accompanying attribute is opposed to quiddity together with

(135) وهي مشتقة عما هو وهو ما به يجاب عن السؤال بما هو وتطلق غالبا على الأمر المتعقل ، والذات والحقيقة عليها مع اعتبار الوجود ، والكل من ثواني المعقولات. (136) وحقيقة كل شيء واحدة مغايرة لما يعرض لها من الاعتبارات وإلا لم تصدق على ما ينافيها. (137) وتكون الماهية مع كل عارض مقابلة لها مع ضده. · Āmulī pp. 84–86

[22] §131. This is a conditional causal analysis, immediately followed by the denial of any eternal [القديم] existent other than God. It should not be read as Ṭūsī affirming an eternal contingent cosmos.

that attribute's opposite.

§138 Quiddity [الماهية], considered as itself, is nothing but itself. If the question is posed in terms of the two contradictories, the answer negates each [additional determination], placing the negation before the 'qua' qualification, not after it.[23]

(138) وهي من حيث هي ليست إلا هي ولو سئل بطرفي النقيض فالجواب السلب لكل شيء قبل الحيثية لا بعدها. · Āmulī pp. 86

Kinds of universal

§139 Quiddity [الماهية] may be taken with everything besides itself excluded, so that anything joined to it would be additional and it would not be predicable of the resulting whole. This is quiddity 'on condition that nothing [be added]' (bi-sharṭ lā shay'), and it exists only in minds. §140 It may also be taken 'without any condition' (lā bi-sharṭ shay'). This is the natural universal [الكلي الطبيعي], which exists externally, is a constituent of individuals, and is predicable of the whole formed from it and what is added to it.[24]

(139) وقد تؤخذ الماهية محذوفا عنها ما عداها بحيث لو انضم إليها شيء لكان زائدا ولا تكون مقولة على ذلك المجموع وهو الماهية بشرط لا شيء ولا توجد إلا في الأذهان. (140) وقد تؤخذ لا بشرط شيء وهو كلي طبيعي موجود في الخارج وهو جزء من الأشخاص وصادق على المجموع الحاصل منه ومما يضاف إليه. · Āmulī pp. 86–87

§141 The universality [الكلية] attaching to quiddity [الماهية] is called the logical universal [الكلي المنطقي], and the composite of the two the intellectual universal [الكلي العقلي]. Both are mental. These, then, are three considerations that should be distinguished in every intelligible [المعقول] quiddity.

(141) والكلية العارضة للماهية يقال لها كلي منطقي وللمركب منهما عقلي وهما ذهنيان فهذه اعتبارات ثلاثة ينبغي تحصيلها في كل ماهية معقولة. · Āmulī pp. 87

Simple and composite quiddities

§142 Some quiddities [الماهية] are simple, having no constituent part; others are composite, having constituent parts. The existence [الوجود] of both is evident. §143 Their two attributes [simplicity [البساطة] and composition] [التركيب] are conceptual and incompatible. They may also be taken correlatively; compared with their earlier senses, the relations [النسبة] of greater and lesser generality are then reversed. §144 Just as dependence is realised in the composite, so it is in the simple. §145 Both may subsist by themselves, or may require a substrate [المحل].

(142) والماهية منها بسيط وهو ما لا جزء له ، ومنها مركب وهو ما له جزء وهما موجودان ضرورة. (143) ووصفاهما اعتباريان متنافيان وقد يتضايفان فيتعاكسان في العموم والخصوص مع اعتبارهما بما مضى. (144) وكما تتحقق الحاجة في المركب فكذا في البسيط. (145) وهما قد يقومان بأنفسهما وقد يفتقران إلى المحل. · Āmulī pp. 88–89

§146 A composite is composed only of what precedes it in existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم], with respect to both mind and external reality [الخارج]. This [priority] [التقدم] grounds [the constituent's] independence of a [further] cause [السبب]: mentally, [its belonging] is evident; externally, it requires no [further cause]. Three properties thus result: one convertible [with being a constituent], and two more general.[25]

(146) والمركب إنما يتركب عما يتقدمه وجودا وعدما بالقياس إلى الذهن والخارج وهو علة الغنى عن السبب فباعتبار الذهن بين وباعتبار الخارج غني فتحصل خواص ثلاث واحدة متعاكسة واثنتان أعم. · Āmulī pp. 90

[23] §138. The scope of negation is essential: 'Man is not, qua man, A' denies that A belongs to the quiddity [الماهية] as such; it does not make 'not-A' a constituent of that quiddity. Al-Ḥillī explicitly distinguishes this from putting negation after the 'qua' phrase.

[24] §140. The natural universal [الكلي الطبيعي] is the nature itself considered without adding universality or particularity as a condition. The text affirms its external existence [الوجود الخارجي] in individuals, not a separate universal [الكلي] standing outside them.

[25] §146. The distinction is between a constituent's priority [التقدم], its not needing a fresh cause [السبب] beyond the cause of the whole, and its

Constituent parts

§147 There must be some dependence of certain parts upon others, but it cannot encompass them all in the same respect. §148 The parts may be distinguished externally or mentally. §149 When generality and its correlate [specificity] are considered as applying to them, they may be mutually exclusive or overlap. §150 They may be considered as materials, or as predicable [constituents]. §151 Genericity [الجنسية] and differentiality [الفصلية] then attach to them.

(147) ولا بد من حاجة ما لبعض الأجزاء إلى البعض ولا يمكن شمولها باعتبار واحد. (148) وهي قد تتميز في الخارج وقد تتميز في الذهن. (149) وإذا اعتبر عروض العموم ومضايفه فقد تتباين وقد تتداخل. (150) وقد تؤخذ مواد وقد تؤخذ محمولة. (151) فتعرض لها الجنسية والفصلية. · Āmulī pp. 91–93

§152 The bringing into being of the two [genus [الجنس] and differentia [الفصل]] is one. §153 Here genus [الجنس] is like matter [المادة] and is an effect [المعلول]; the other [the differentia [الفصل]] is form [الصورة] and is a cause [العلة].[26] §154 What has no genus [الجنس] has no differentia [الفصل]. §155 There can be only one complete differentia [الفصل] [of a given quiddity] [الماهية].[27]

(152) وجعلاهما واحد. (153) والجنس هاهنا كالمادة وهو معلول والآخر صورة وهو علة. (154) وما لا جنس له فلا فصل له. (155) وكل فصل تام فهو واحد. · Āmulī pp. 93–94

§156 A single quiddity [الماهية] cannot have two genera [الجنس] at the same rank. §157 There is no intellectual composition [التركيب] except from these two [genus [الجنس] and differentia [الفصل]]. §158 Their [series] must terminate. §159 Each can be intellectual, natural, or logical, just as their genera [الجنس] [the universal [الكلي] in each case] can. §160 Among each are highest, lowest, and intermediate [members].

(156) ولا يمكن وجود جنسين في مرتبة واحدة لماهية واحدة. (157) ولا تركيب عقلي إلا منهما. (158) ويجب تناهيهما. (159) وقد يكون منهما عقلي وطبيعي ومنطقي كجنسيهما. (160) ومنهما عوال وسوافل ومتوسطات. · Āmulī pp. 94–96

§161 Some genera [الجنس] are isolated: they have no genus above them and none below them. The two [genus and differentia] [الفصل] are relational, and may coincide [in one thing under different respects] despite their opposition [التقابل].[28] §162 A genus [الجنس] cannot be taken as a genus in relation to its differentia [الفصل]. §163 Relative to [the species] to which they belong, the genus [الجنس] is broader and the differentia [الفصل] coextensive.

(161) ومن الجنس ما هو مفرد وهو الذي لا جنس له وليس تحته جنس وهما إضافيان وقد يجتمعان مع التقابل. (162) ولا يمكن أخذ الجنس بالنسبة إلى الفصل. (163) وإذا نسبا إلى ما يضافان إليه كان الجنس أعم والفصل مساويا. · Āmulī pp. 96–97

Individuation

§164 Individuation [التشخص] is a conceptual matter. Considered as an intellectual matter, it is found to share [the concept of individuation] with other individuations. No infinite regress [التسلسل] follows; [the series] ends when the consideration ends. §165 That by which individuation

(164) والتشخص من الأمور الاعتبارية فإذا نظر إليه من حيث هو أمر عقلي وجد مشاركا لغيره من التشخصات فيه ولا يتسلسل بل ينقطع

inseparability as an essential feature. Al-Ḥillī's enumeration is fuller than the very compressed matn.

[26] §153. The differentia [الفصل] is treated as causing the species' share of the genus [الجنس], not as producing the absolutely general genus as a separate existent.

[27] §155. Al-Ḥillī contrasts the complete differentia [الفصل], which cannot be multiple for the same quiddity [الماهية], with incomplete differentiae that can be its constituent parts.

[28] §161. The opposition [التقابل] is between logical roles. A single feature can be a genus [الجنس] relative to one item and a differentia [الفصل] relative to another.

[التشخص] occurs may be the quiddity [الماهية] itself, in which case it admits no plurality [الكثرة]; or it may depend upon matter [المادة] individuated by the particular accidents [العرض] inhering in it. §166 Individuation [التشخص] does not arise by joining an intellectual universal [الكلي العقلي] to another such universal [الكلي]. §167 Distinction differs from individuation [التشخص]; each of two things may be distinguished by the other.

بانقطاع الاعتبار. (165) أما ما به التشخص فقد يكون نفس الماهية فلا تكثر وقد يستند إلى المادة المتشخصة بالأعراض الخاصة الحالة فيها.
(166) ولا يحصل التشخص بانضمام كلي عقلي إلى مثله. (167) والتميز يغاير التشخص ويجوز امتياز كل من الشيئين بالآخر. · Āmulī pp. 97–98

§168 An individual's sharing [a character with others] may be left out of consideration; a universal [الكلي] may be a relative [particular] and so be distinguished; and an individual falling under a general concept is distinguished.[29]

(168) والشخص قد لا تعتبر مشاركته والكلي قد يكون إضافيا فيتميز والشخص المندرج تحت عام متميز. · Āmulī p. 98

Unity and plurality

§169 Individuation [التشخص] differs from unity [الوحدة]. §170 Unity [الوحدة] differs from existence [الوجود], since existence is true of the many as many whereas unity is not; yet unity is coextensive with existence.[30]

(169) والتشخص يغاير الوحدة (170) وهي تغاير الوجود لصدقه على الكثير من حيث هو كثير بخلاف الوحدة ، وتساوقه. · Āmulī pp. 99

The indefinability of unity

§171 Unity [الوحدة] can be defined only by explaining the expression. §172 Unity [الوحدة] and plurality [الكثرة] are on a par with respect to intellect [العقل] and imagination [الخيال]: each has its own share in being better known [unity to intellect, plurality to imagination].

(171) ولا يمكن تعريفها إلا باعتبار اللفظ.
(172) وهي والكثرة عند العقل والخيال تستويان في كون كل منهما أعرف بالاقتسام. · Āmulī pp. 100

The conceptual character of unity

§173 Unity [الوحدة] is not an external entity; it belongs to the second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية]. The same holds for plurality [الكثرة].

(173) وليست الوحدة أمرا عينيا بل هي من ثواني المعقولات وكذا الكثرة. · Āmulī pp. 100

The opposition of unity and plurality

§174 Their opposition [التقابل] arises from the relations [الإضافة] of cause [العلة] and effect [المعلول], and measure and measured, rather than from an opposition between their essences [الذات].

(174) وتقابلهما لإضافة العلية والمعلولية والمكيالية والمكيلية لا لتقابل جوهري بينهما. · Āmulī pp. 101

Kinds of unity

§175 The subject [المعروض] of the two may be one; it must then have two respects. If the respect of unity [الوحدة] neither constitutes the respect of plurality [الكثرة] nor attaches to it, the unity is accidental. If it attaches to it, [the unity concerns] a subject, or predicates attaching to one subject, or the reverse

(175) ثم معروضهما قد يكون واحدا فله جهتان بالضرورة فجهة الوحدة إن لم تقوم جهة الكثرة ولا تعرض لها فالوحدة عرضية ، وإن عرضت كانت موضوعا أو محمولات عارضة لموضوع أو

[29] §168. "Relative particular" means a universal [الكلي] subordinated to a more general universal. It can be distinguished from others without being an individual: the passage separates conceptual distinction from individuation [التشخص].

[30] §170. The text distinguishes the concepts of unity [الوحدة] and existence [الوجود] while maintaining their coextension. It is not saying that a plurality fails to exist.

[subjects sharing one predicate]. If it constitutes it, the unity is generic, specific, or differential. Their subjects may instead differ. A subject consisting solely in indivisibility is unity without qualification. Otherwise, if it has an additional concept and spatial position [الوضع], it is a point; if it has no spatial position, it is immaterial. This applies if it admits no division. If it does, it is a magnitude, a simple body [الجسم], or a composite body.[31]

§176 Some of these have a stronger claim to unity [الوحدة] than others. §177 Identity ['it is it'] follows the same pattern. §178 The names for unity [الوحدة] in an accidental or essential attribute vary according to what unity is related to. §179 Two [distinct things] becoming one is impossible. Identity therefore requires respects of difference and unity, as already explained.[32] §180 Unity [الوحدة] is the principle of number, which is constituted by unity alone.

بالعكس ، وإن قومت فوحدة جنسية أو نوعية أو فصلية ، وقد يتغاير فموضوع مجرد عدم الانقسام لا غير وحدة بقول مطلق وإلا نقطة إن كان له مفهوم زائد ذو وضع ، أو مفارق إن لم يكن ذا وضع ، هذا إن لم يقبل القسمة وإلا فهو مقدار أو جسم بسيط أو مركب. · Āmulī pp.102

(176) وبعض هذه أولى من بعض بالوحدة.
(177) والهو هو على هذا النحو. (178) والوحدة في الوصف العرضي والذاتي تتغاير أسماؤها بتغاير المضاف إليه. (179) والاتحاد محال فالهوهو يستدعي جهتي تغاير واتحاد على ما سلف.
(180) والوحدة مبدأ العدد المتقوم بها لا غيره. · Āmulī pp.103–104

[31] §175. This extended classification is retained in full. Its transitions depend on whether unity [الوحدة] is constitutive, accidental, or the indivisibility of a single subject [الموضوع]. The short bracketed phrases follow al-Ḥillī's unpacking.

[32] §179. The rejected union concerns two numerically distinct things becoming one numerically identical thing. Predicative identity remains possible through difference in conception [التصور] and unity in what is referred to.

§181 When another like it is added, twoness results, and this is a species of number. Further species with different realities [الحقيقة] then arise without limit by adding one at a time: these are the species of number. §182 Each is a conceptual matter that the intellect [العقل] predicates of realities [الحقيقة] when it joins them together intellectually in the relevant manner. §183 Unity [الوحدة] may attach to itself and to its opposite [plurality] [الكثرة], and [the iteration] ends when the consideration ends. §184 It may share a common character [with other unities], and is then specified by the commonly named correlate. The same holds for its opposite.[33]

(181) وإذا أضيف إليها مثلها حصلت الاثنينية وهي نوع من العدد ثم تحصل أنواع لا تتناهى بتزايد واحد واحد مختلفة الحقائق هي أنواع العدد. (182) وكل واحد منها أمر اعتباري يحكم به العقل على الحقائق إذا انضم بعضها إلى بعض في العقل انضماما بحسبه. (183) والوحدة قد تعرض لذاتها ومقابلها وتنقطع بانقطاع الاعتبار. (184) وقد تعرض لها شركة فتتخصص بالمشهوري وكذا المقابل. · Āmulī pp. 104–106

§185 It is related to its subject [الموضوع] in two respects, and to its opposite in a third. The same holds for its opposite.[34]

(185) وتضاف إلى موضوعها باعتبارين وإلى مقابلها بثالث وكذا المقابل. · Āmulī pp. 107

Kinds of opposition

§186 To that opposite [plurality] [الكثرة] there attaches what cannot attach to unity: opposition [التقابل]. §187 Opposition [التقابل] divides into four kinds: negation and affirmation, concerning assertion and belief [الاعتقاد]; privation [عدم الملكة] and possession [الملكة], which is the first [kind] taken with a certain restriction; the opposition of contraries [الضد], both of which are positive, and whose precise and common usages stand in the reverse relation [النسبة] to those of the preceding kind; and correlative opposition [تقابل التضايف].[35] §188 The genus [الجنس] [opposition [التقابل] itself] falls under this [last kind] by virtue of an accompanying consideration.[36]

(186) ويعرض له ما يستحيل عروضه لها من التقابل. (187) المتنوع إلى أنواعه الأربعة أعني السلب والإيجاب وهو راجع إلى القول والعقد ، والعدم والملكة وهو الأول مأخوذا باعتبار خصوصية ما ، وتقابل الضدين وهما وجوديان ويتعاكس هو وما قبله في التحقيق والمشهورية ، وتقابل التضايف. (188) ويندرج تحته الجنس باعتبار عارض. · Āmulī pp. 107–108

[33] §184. Al-Ḥillī offers more than one possible interpretation and prefers specification by the concrete subject, the 'commonly named correlate' (al-muḍāf al-mashhūrī). That reading is followed here; it is not an unambiguous expanded definition in the matn.

[34] §185. The two relations to the subject [الموضوع] are interpreted by al-Ḥillī as being its unity and inhering in it as an accident [العرض]; the third is opposition to plurality. He presents this as his closest interpretation of the wording.

[35] §187. The comparative claim concerns the breadth of common and precise usages. In the account explained by al-Ḥillī, strict contrariety is narrower than common contrariety, while the relation [النسبة] is reversed for privation [عدم الملكة] and possession [الملكة].

[36] §188. Opposition [التقابل] considered precisely as a relation to an opposite is correlative, even though the underlying opposed things need not themselves be correlatives. The genus [الجنس] consequently falls under a species only under that added consideration.

§189 It is predicated analogically [التشكيك] of the four, and the third [contrariety] [التضاد] is the strongest in opposition [التقابل]. §190 The first is called contradiction [التناقض]; it is realised in propositions under eight conditions. §191 This applies to singular propositions [القضايا الشخصية]. In quantified propositions [القضايا المحصورة] a ninth condition is required: difference in quantification. For two universals are contrary [الضد], while the two particulars may both be true. §192 In modal propositions [القضايا الموجهة] a tenth [condition is required]: the modalities must differ so that the two cannot both be true or both be false.

§193 When nonexistence [العدم] is qualified by possession [الملكة] in propositions, they are called propositions with privative predicates [القضايا المعدولة] (maʿdūla). They oppose the corresponding positive propositions in truth, but not in falsity: the subject [الموضوع] may not exist, in which case the contradictories of both are true.[37] §194 A subject [الموضوع] may necessarily have one determinate contrary [الضد], or one without determination; or it may require neither, being free of both or possessing an intermediate. §195 One thing cannot have two contraries [الضد] [in the same respect].[38]

(189) ومقوليته عليها بالتشكيك وأشدها فيه الثالث. (190) ويقال للأول تناقض ويتحقق في القضايا بشرائط ثمان. (191) هذا في القضايا الشخصية أما المحصورة فبشرط تاسع وهو الاختلاف فيه فإن الكلية ضد ، والجزئيتان صادقتان. (192) وفي الموجهات عاشر وهو الاختلاف فيها بحيث لا يمكن اجتماعهما صدقا وكذبا. · Āmulī pp. 109–111

(193) وإذا قيد العدم بالملكة في القضايا سميت معدولة وهي تقابل الوجودية صدقا لا كذبا لإمكان عدم الموضوع فيصدق مقابلاهما.
(194) وقد يستلزم الموضوع أحد الضدين بعينه أو لا بعينه ، أو لا يستلزم شيئا منهما عند الخلو أو الاتصاف بالوسط. (195) ولا يعقل للواحد ضدان. · Āmulī pp. 111–112

[37] §193. A privative predicate such as ‘non-seeing’ must be distinguished from merely negating a proposition. The source’s discussion also depends on its account of existential import when the subject [الموضوع] is absent.

[38] §195. Al-Ḥillī restricts the claim to a single respect of opposition. Opposition under two different respects gives two different oppositions and lies outside the present claim.

§196 Contrariety [التضاد] does not apply to genera [الجنس].
§197 Contrariety [التضاد] between species requires that they belong to the same [proximate] genus [الجنس].[39] §198 The bringing into being of genus [الجنس] and differentia [الفصل] is one.[40]

(196) وهو منفي عن الأجناس. (197) ومشروط في الأنواع باتحاد الجنس. (198) وجعل الجنس والفصل واحد. · Āmulī pp. 112

Chapter 3 · Cause and effect

الفصل الثالث في العلة والمعلول

§199 Everything from which something proceeds, whether independently or together with something else, is a cause [العلة] of it; what proceeds is its effect [المعلول].

(199) كل شيء يصدر عنه أمر إما بالاستقلال أو الانضمام فإنه علة لذلك الأمر والأمر معلول له. · Āmulī pp. 114

The four causes

§200 Causes are efficient [الفاعلية], material [المادية], formal [الصورية], and final [الغائية].

(200) وهي فاعلية ومادية وصورية وغائية. · Āmulī pp. 114

The efficient cause

§201 The efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] is the principle of producing an effect [المعلول]. When it exists with every respect required for its efficacy, the effect must exist. §202 Nor must [causal efficacy] [التأثير] be accompanied by [the effect [المعلول]'s prior] nonexistence [العدم].[41] §203 The effect [المعلول] cannot persist after [the efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] ceases], though this is possible in the case of a preparatory cause [العلة المعدة]. §204 When the cause [العلة] is one, the effect [المعلول] is one.[42]

§205 Multiplicity [الكثرة] then arises through a multiplicity of relations [الإضافة]. §206 This judgment is convertible. §207 In the case of specific unity [الوحدة], it is not convertible.[43] §208 The two relations [النسبة] [causality [العلية] and being an effect] [المعلول] are second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية], and are opposed correlatively. §209 They may coincide in one thing in relation [النسبة] to two different matters, but the roles cannot be reversed in those same matters.

(201) فالفاعل مبدأ التأثير وعند وجوده بجميع جهات التأثير يجب وجود المعلول. (202) ولا تجب مقارنة العدم. (203) ولا يجوز بقاء المعلول بعده وإن جاز في المعد. (204) ومع وحدته يتحد المعلول. · Āmulī pp. 115–116

(205) ثم تعرض الكثرة باعتبار كثرة الإضافات. (206) وهذا الحكم ينعكس على نفسه. (207) وفي الوحدة النوعية لا عكس. (208) والنسبتان من ثواني المعقولات وبينهما مقابلة التضايف. (209) وقد يجتمعان في الشيء الواحد بالنسبة إلى أمرين لا يتعاكسان فيهما. · Āmulī pp. 116–117

[39] §197. The qualification "proximate" follows al-Ḥillī's specification of "one lowest genus [الجنس]" (jins wahid akhir).

[40] §198. This repeats §152 in the discussion of contrariety. Al-Ḥillī proposes an explanation but explicitly allows that another reader may understand the clause differently; no unique rationale is silently inserted here.

[41] §202. Al-Ḥillī explains that prior nonexistence [العدم] is required for an act of a willing agent [الفاعل المختار], but is not a necessary condition of causation as such, since a necessitating cause can be considered otherwise.

[42] §204. Al-Ḥillī restricts the disputed one-from-one argument to a necessitating cause [العلة] considered in one respect, and criticises a proof offered for it. The matn's concise assertion is retained; the commentator's criticism is not presented as part of Ṭūsī's wording.

[43] §207. A cause one in species produces an effect one in species, but the same species of effect can have causes different in species. Al-Ḥillī uses heat from motion [الحركة], the sun, and fire.

Arguments against infinite regress

§210 Their subjects [المعروض] cannot ascend without end in a single series: no member can occur without a necessary cause [العلة], yet what is necessary through another cannot [occur without a cause] either. There must therefore be an intrinsically [necessary] cause that is an endpoint. §211 Also because of the one-to-one correspondence [التطبيق] between a totality from which finitely many members have been removed and another from which none have been removed.[44] §212 Also because applying one-to-one correspondence [التطبيق] with respect to the two relations [النسبة], so that each member is counted under both, entails that the two [series] terminate: one relation must exceed the other because of its priority [السبق].

(210) ولا يتراقى معروضاهما في سلسلة واحدة إلى غير النهاية لأن كل واحد منها ممتنع الحصول بدون علة واجبة لكن الواجب بالغير ممتنع أيضا فيجب وجود علة لذاتها هي طرف. (211) وللتطبيق بين جملة قد فصل منها آحاد متناهية وأخرى لم تفصل منها. (212) ولأن التطبيق باعتبار النسبتين بحيث يتعدد كل واحد منها باعتبارهما يوجب تناهيهما لوجوب ازدياد إحدى النسبتين على الأخرى من حيث السبق. · Āmulī pp. 117–118

§213 Also, if what produces the totality were one of its parts, a thing would produce itself and its causes [العلة]. The totality has a complete cause [العلة التامة], whereas no part is a complete cause, since the whole is not necessitated by that part. How could the whole be necessitated by something that itself depends on infinitely many members of that whole?

(213) ولأن المؤثر في المجموع إن كان بعض أجزائه كان الشيء مؤثرا في نفسه وعلله ولأن المجموع له علة تامة وكل جزء ليس علة تامة إذ الجملة لا تجب به وكيف تجب الجملة بشيء هو محتاج إلى ما لا يتناهى من تلك الجملة. · Āmulī pp. 119

Cause and effect in existence and nonexistence

§214 The two relations [النسبة] correspond on both sides of the contradictory [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم].

(214) وتتكافى النسبتان في طرفي النقيض. · Āmulī pp. 119

Reception and agency

§215 Reception [القبول] and agency are incompatible when the relation [النسبة] is the same, because their concomitants are incompatible.[45]

(215) والقبول والفعل متنافيان مع اتحاد النسبة لتنافي لازميهما. · Āmulī pp. 120

The relation between cause and effect

§216 The cause [العلة] and effect [المعلول] must differ in nature if the effect intrinsically needs that cause; otherwise this is not required.

(216) وتجب المخالفة بين العلة والمعلول إن كان المعلول محتاجا لذاته إلى تلك العلة وإلا فلا. · Āmulī pp. 121

Accompaniment and causality

§217 Neither relation [النسبة] is necessarily true of what accompanies [its bearer].

(217) ولا يجب صدق إحدى النسبتين على المصاحب. · Āmulī pp. 121

[44] §211. The one-to-one correspondence [التطبيق] (taṭbīq) arguments are translated as historical arguments against an infinite causal series. They are not silently reformulated in terms of modern set theory.

[45] §215. Reception [القبول] is considered in respect of a subject's lack of intrinsic sufficiency for the received feature; agency in respect of supplying what suffices. The qualification 'when the relation [النسبة] is the same' prevents a blanket denial that one thing can act in one respect and receive in another.

Causality among elemental individuals

§218 No individual elemental thing is the essential cause [العلة] of another such individual; otherwise the individuals would be infinite. Also because it can dispense with that [particular individual] through another; §219 because [the alleged cause] [العلة] has no priority [التقدم]; §220 because the two are on a par; §221 and because either may persist when its companion has ceased to exist.

(218) وليس الشخص من العنصريات علة ذاتية لشخص آخر منها وإلا لم تتناه الأشخاص ، ولاستغنائه عنه بغيره. (219) ولعدم تقدمه. (220) ولتكافئهما. (221) ولبقاء أحدهما مع عدم صاحبه. · Āmulī pp. 122–123

The production of human acts

§222 An agent among us requires a particular conception [التصور] to specify the action, then desire, then will [الإرادة], then movement of the muscles, so that the action arises from us. §223 Movement to a place follows a will [الإرادة] appropriate to it. The particular stages of that movement follow particular imaginings and volitions. Earlier instances of these imaginings and volitions cause earlier stages of movement, which prepare for further [volitions]. Thus volitions in the soul [النفس] and movements along the distance continue to their respective ends.

(222) والفاعل منا يفتقر إلى تصور جزئي ليتخصص الفعل ثم شوق ثم إرادة ثم حركة من العضلات ليقع منا الفعل. (223) والحركة إلى مكان تتبع إرادة بحسبها ، وجزئيات تلك الحركة تتبع تخيلات وإرادات جزئية فيكون السابق من هذه علة للسابق من تلك ، المعدة لحصول أخرى فتتصل الإرادات في النفس والحركات في المسافة إلى آخرهما. · Āmulī pp. 123–124

Spatial situation and bodily causation

§224 Spatial situation [الوضع] is required for efficacy to belong to what accompanies matter [المادة].

(224) ويشترط في صدق التأثير على المقارن الوضع. · Āmulī pp. 124

The finitude of bodily capacities

§225 So is finitude with respect to duration, number, and intensity, in terms of which finitude and its proper privation [عدم الملكة] are predicated of what produces the effect.[46] §226 For forced [motion] [الحركة] varies with the recipient; when the starting point is the same, the opposite endpoint differs.[47]

(225) والتناهي بحسب المدة والعدة والشدة التي باعتبارها يصدق التناهي وعدمه الخاص على المؤثر. (226) لأن القسري يختلف باختلاف القابل ومع اتحاد المبدإ يتفاوت مقابله. · Āmulī pp. 125–126

§227 Natural [motion] [الحركة] varies with the agent, since the small and large are equal in receptivity [القبول]. Thus, when the two move from the same starting point, finitude follows.

(227) والطبيعي يختلف باختلاف الفاعل لتساوي الصغير والكبير في القبول ، فإذا تحركا مع اتحاد المبدإ عرض التناهي. · Āmulī pp. 127

The material cause

§228 The substrate [المحل] constituted by what inheres in it is its recipient and the matter [المادة] of the composite. §229 Its receptivity [القبول] is intrinsic. §230 Nearness and remoteness [to receiving a form] [الصورة] may arise through dispositions [الاستعداد] acquired by virtue of what inheres in it.

(228) والمحل المتقوم بالحال قابل له ومادة للمركب. (229) وقبوله ذاتي. (230) وقد يحصل القرب والبعد باستعدادات يكتسبها باعتبار الحال فيه. · Āmulī pp. 127–128

The formal cause

§231 What thus inheres is the form [الصورة] of the composite and a partial efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] of its substrate [المحل]. §232 It is one.

(231) وهذا الحال صورة للمركب وجزء فاعل لمحله. (232) وهو واحد. · Āmulī pp. 128–129

[46] §225. Finitude is construed through the duration, number, or intensity of effects. 'Its proper privation [عدم الملكة]' refers to nonfinitude in a subject of the relevant kind, rather than every use of a bare negative.

[47] §226. The condensed physical argument compares motions [الحركة] from the same starting point, with differing recipients or motive forces [القوة]. Al-Ḥillī discusses objections to the argument; those objections are not part of the matn.

The final cause

§233 The end, through its quiddity [الماهية], causes the efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية]'s causality [العلية]; in its existence [الوجود] it is caused by the effect [المعلول]. §234 It belongs to every purposive agent. §235 The end of the animal motive faculty is to reach the terminus. This may or may not also be the end of the appetitive faculty. If [the latter end] is not attained, the movement is futile. Otherwise it is good, habitual, necessarily intended, or playful and aimless. §236 They affirm ends for natural events, and likewise for chance events.

(233) والغاية علة بماهيتها لعلية العلة الفاعلية ، معلولة في وجودها للمعلول. (234) وهي ثابتة لكل قاصد. (235) أما القوة الحيوانية المحركة فغايتها الوصول إلى المنتهى وهو قد يكون غاية الشوقية وقد لا يكون فإن لم تحصل فالحركة باطلة وإلا فهو إما خير أو عادة أو قصد ضروري أو عبث وجزاف. (236) وأثبتوا للطبيعيات غايات وكذا للاتفاقيات. · Āmulī pp. 129–130

Divisions of causes

§237 A cause [العلة], generally considered, may be simple or composite; §238 in potentiality [القوة] or in actuality [الفعل]; §239 universal [الكلي] or particular; §240 per se [بالذات] or per accidens [بالعرض]; §241 generic or specific;

(237) والعلة مطلقا قد تكون بسيطة وقد تكون مركبة. (238) وأيضا بالقوة أو بالفعل. (239) وكلية أو جزئية. (240) وذاتية أو عرضية. (241) وعامة أو خاصة. · Āmulī pp. 130–132

§242 proximate or remote; §243 shared or peculiar. §244 The prior nonexistence [العدم] of an originated thing [الحادث] is among its accidental principles. §245 The efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] on the two sides [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم] is one. §246 The subject [الموضوع] is like matter [المادة] [in its causal role].

(242) وقريبة أو بعيدة. (243) ومشتركة أو خاصة. (244) والعدم للحادث من المبادئ العرضية. (245) والفاعل في الطرفين واحد. (246) والموضوع كالمادة. · Āmulī pp. 132–133

The effect and its dependence

§247 The effect [الأثر]'s dependence is only with respect to one of its two sides [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم].[48] §248 The causes of quiddity [الماهية] differ from the causes of existence [الوجود]. §249 Nonexistence [العدم] must have a cause [السبب]; the same applies to [the cessation of] motion [الحركة].[49]

(247) وافتقار الأثر إنما هو في أحد طرفيه. (248) وأسباب الماهية غير أسباب الوجود. (249) ولا بد للعدم من سبب وكذا في الحركة. · Āmulī pp. 133–134

§250 Among preparatory causes [العلة المعدة] are those that lead to a like, to something different, or to a contrary [الضد]. §251 Preparation may be proximate or remote. §252 Some accidental causes are preparatory.

(250) ومن العلل المعدة ما يؤدي إلى مثل أو خلاف أو ضد. (251) والإعداد قريب وبعيد. (252) ومن العلل العرضية ما هو معد. · Āmulī pp. 134–135

[48] §247. The claim concerns making an effect [الأثر] existent or nonexistent, rather than making its essential nature what it is. Read alongside §127, where producing quiddity [الماهية] concerns its actualisation rather than altering its definition.

[49] §249. Al-Ḥillī addresses the objection that nonpersistent things, such as motions [الحركة] and sounds, cease through themselves. He instead connects their cessation to the absence of their cause [السبب] or of a condition.

Division 2
Substances and accidents

المقصد الثاني في الجواهر والأعراض

This division comprises chapters.

Chapter 1 · Substances

الفصل الأول في الجواهر

§253 A contingent existent [الممكن] either exists in a subject [الموضوع], in which case it is an accident [العرض], or does not, in which case it is a substance [الجوهر].[50] §254 A substance [الجوهر] is either separate [from matter] [المادة] in its essence [الذات] and action, in which case it is an intellect [العقل]; separate in its essence [but not its action], in which case it is a soul [النفس]; or conjoined [with matter]. In the last case, it is either a receptacle [المحل], namely matter; something inhering, namely form [الصورة]; or a composite of the two, namely body [الجسم]. §255 Subject [الموضوع] and receptacle [المحل] reverse their relations [النسبة] of generality and specificity when existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] are considered. The same holds for what inheres and accident [العرض].

(253) الممكن إما أن يكون موجودا في الموضوع وهو العرض أو لا وهو الجوهر. (254) وهو إما مفارق في ذاته وفعله وهو العقل ، أو في ذاته وهو النفس ، أو مقارن فإما أن يكون محلا وهو المادة ، أو حالا وهو الصورة ، أو ما يتركب منهما وهو الجسم. (255) والموضوع والمحل يتعاكسان وجودا وعدما في العموم والخصوص وكذا الحال والعرض. · Āmulī pp. 135–139

§256 Subject [الموضوع] and accident [العرض] are mutually exclusive. §257 "Accident [العرض]" is predicated of some receptacles [المحل] and some things that inhere. §258 Substantiality [الجوهرية] and accidentality [العرضية] are secondary intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية], because attributing either of them [to a thing] depends on a middle term [in a proof]. §259 [This is also shown by] the differing priority [الأولوية] of the species [in possessing these descriptions]. §260 What is understood as common [to them] is accidental.

(256) وبين الموضوع والعرض مباينة.
(257) ويصدق العرض على المحل والحال جزئيا :
(258) والجوهرية والعرضية من ثواني المعقولات لتوقف نسبة إحداهما على وسط.
(259) واختلاف الأنواع بالأولوية.
(260) والمعقول اشتراكه عرضي. · Āmulī pp. 139–140

§261 There is no contrariety [التضاد] among substances [الجوهر], nor between substances and anything else. §262 What is understood by annihilation is nonexistence [العدم]. §263 Contrariety [التضاد] may, however, be applied to some [substances] [الجوهر] in another respect. §264 The unity [الوحدة] of the receptacle [المحل] does not entail the unity of what inheres in it, except when [the inhering things] are alike. The converse, however, does hold. §265 As for division, neither side entails [division of] the other.

(261) ولا تضاد بين الجواهر ولا بينها وبين غيرها.
(262) والمعقول من الفناء العدم. (263) وقد يطلق التضاد على البعض باعتبار آخر.
(264) ووحدة المحل لا تستلزم وحدة الحال إلا مع التماثل بخلاف العكس. (265) وأما الانقسام فغير مستلزم في الطرفين. · Āmulī pp. 141–142

§266 The subject [الموضوع] is among the individuating factors [of an accident] [العرض]. §267 What inheres may require an intermediate receptacle [المحل].

(266) والموضوع من جملة المشخصات.
(267) وقد يفتقر الحال إلى محل

[50] §253. "Subject [الموضوع]" (mawḍūʿ) is a self-subsistent support for an accident [العرض]; "receptacle [المحل]" (maḥall) is broader and can include prime matter [الهيولى] as the receptacle of substantial form. The distinctions in §§255–257 depend on keeping these terms separate.

متوسط. · Āmulī pp.143

Atoms and the divisibility of body

§268 Nothing that has spatial position [الوضع] and is indivisible exists independently.[s1] §269 For an intervening [atom] [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] blocks [the two outer atoms from touching]. §270 And because of the movement of the two [atoms] [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] placed at the ends of a [line] composed of three [atoms]. §271 Or of four, with the two [moving atoms] [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] exchanging positions. §272 Their position entails what sense perception [الحس] attests to be false: disintegration, the rest [السكون] of what is moving, and the nonexistence [العدم] of the circle.

(268) ولا وجود لوضعي لا يتجزى بالاستقلال. (269) لحجب المتوسط. (270) ولحركة الموضوعين على طرفي المركب من ثلاثة. (271) أو من أربعة على التبادل. (272) ويلزمهم ما يشهد الحس بكذبه من التفكك وسكون المتحرك وانتفاء الدائرة. · Āmulī pp.143–145

§273 A point is an accident [العرض] inhering in what is divisible, in respect of its termination. §274 Motion [الحركة] does not exist in the present [instant]; it does not follow that motion does not exist at all. §275 The instant has no actuality outside the mind. §276 Were motion [الحركة] composed of indivisibles, it would not exist. §277 Besides the preceding objections, the proponent of infinitely many [actual] parts is refuted by the existence [الوجود] of a composite made from finitely many parts; generalizing [this refutation to all bodies] [الجسم] requires proportionality.

(273) والنقطة عرض قائم بالمنقسم باعتبار التناهي. (274) والحركة لا وجود لها في الحال ولا يلزم نفيها مطلقا. (275) والآن لا تحقق له خارجا. (276) ولو تركبت الحركة مما لا يتجزى لم تكن موجودة. (277) والقائل بعدم تناهي الأجزاء يلزمه مع ما تقدم النقض بوجود المؤلف مما يتناهى ويفتقر في التعميم إلى التناسب. · Āmulī pp.145–147

§278 It also entails that the faster [body] [الجسم] cannot overtake the slower. §279 And that a finite distance cannot be traversed in a finite time. §280 Self-evident judgment [الضرورة] rules out both leaping [الطفرة] [over intervening positions] and interpenetration [التداخل]. §281 Division in its several forms produces a duality in which the nature of each [part] is the same as the nature of the whole. §282 Impossibility [الامتناع] of separation due to an incidental factor does not entail intrinsic impossibility [الامتناع الذاتي].

(278) ويلزم عدم لحوق السريع البطيء. (279) وأن لا يقطع المسافة المتناهية في زمان متناه. (280) والضرورة قضت ببطلان الطفرة والتداخل. (281) والقسمة بأنواعها تحدث اثنينية يساوي طباع كل واحد منهما طباع المجموع. (282) وامتناع الانفكاك لعارض لا يقتضي الامتناع الذاتي. · Āmulī pp.148–149

§283 It has thus been established that body [الجسم] is one continuous thing, capable of division without limit. §284 This does not entail the existence [الوجود] of matter [المادة] other than body [الجسم], because an infinite regress [التسلسل] and the existence of infinitely many [actual things] are impossible.

(283) فقد ثبت أن الجسم شيء واحد متصل يقبل الانقسام إلى ما لا يتناهى. (284) ولا يقتضي ذلك ثبوت مادة سوى الجسم لاستحالة التسلسل ووجود ما لا يتناهى. · Āmulī pp.149–150

Natural place and shape

§285 Every body [الجسم] has a natural place [المكان الطبيعي], which

(285) ولكل جسم مكان طبيعي يطلبه عند الخروج

[s1] §268. The denial concerns an independently existing spatial indivisible: the atom [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ]. It does not deny a point existing as a boundary of something divisible (§273). The brief geometrical objections that follow are not complete standalone proofs; Ḥillī expands their constructions.

it seeks by the shortest route when displaced from it. §286 Were [its natural place] [المكان الطبيعي] multiple, it would cease to be [natural]. §287 The place of a composite is the place of its predominant [element], or the place in which it happens to exist. §288 The same applies to shape; the natural shape is the sphere. §289 What is understood by the former [that is, place] is dimension; the indications support this.

على أقرب الطرق. (286) فلو تعدد انتفى. (287) ومكان المركب مكان الغالب أو ما اتفق وجوده فيه. (288) وكذا الشكل والطبيعي منه الكرة. (289) والمعقول من الأول البعد فإن الأمارات تساعد عليه. · Āmulī pp. 150–152

§290 Know that dimension is of two kinds: one is conjoined with matter [المادة], inheres in body [الجسم], and excludes an equal [material dimension from interpenetrating it]; the other is separate, with bodies occupying it. It meets them in their entirety and interpenetrates them, coinciding with and uniting with the dimension of what occupies it. There is no impossibility [الامتناع] in its being free of matter.[52] §291 If place were a surface, the judgments [about motion [الحركة] and rest] [السكون] would be contradictory. §292 Nor would place extend to every [body] [الجسم].

(290) واعلم أن البعد منه ملاق للمادة وهو الحال في الجسم ويمانع مساويه ، ومنه مفارق تحل فيه الأجسام ويلاقيها بجملتها ويداخلها بحيث ينطبق على بعد المتمكن ويتحد به ولا امتناع لخلوه عن المادة. (291) ولو كان المكان سطحا لتضادت الأحكام. (292) ولم يعم المكان. · Āmulī pp. 152–153

§293 This place cannot be unoccupied. Otherwise motion [الحركة] with an impediment would equal motion without one, when a lesser impediment is assumed in the ratio of their two times.

(293) وهذا المكان لا يصح عليه الخلو من شاغل وإلا لساوت حركة ذي المعاوق حركة عديمه عند فرض معاوق أقل بنسبة زمانيهما. · Āmulī pp. 154

Direction

§294 Direction is the extremity of the extension established along the line of pointing. §295 It is not divisible. §296 It has position and is the object both of movement aimed at reaching it and of pointing. §297 The natural directions are above and below; the others are unlimited.

(294) والجهة طرف الامتداد الحاصل في مأخذ الإشارة. (295) وليست منقسمة. (296) وهي من ذوات الأوضاع المقصودة بالحركة للحصول فيها وبالإشارة. (297) والطبيعي منها فوق وسفل وما عداهما غير متناه. · Āmulī pp. 154–155

Chapter 2 · Bodies

الفصل الثاني في الأجسام

§298 They are of two kinds, celestial and elemental. Of the celestial bodies [الجسم], the comprehensive spheres are nine: an unstarred sphere encompassing all, beneath it the sphere of the fixed stars, then the spheres of the seven wandering stars. These include epicycles and eccentric spheres, twenty-four in all. They contain seven wandering stars and a thousand and twenty-odd fixed stars. §299 They are all simple. §300 [They are] free of active and passive qualities [الكيفية] and what follows from those qualities. §301 [They are] transparent. §302 There are

(298) وهي قسمان فلكية وعنصرية أما الفلكية فالكلية منها تسعة واحد غير مكوكب محيط بالجميع وتحته فلك الثوابت ، ثم أفلاك الكواكب السيارة السبعة ، وتشتمل على أفلاك تداوير وخارجة المراكز ، والمجموع أربعة وعشرون وتشتمل على سبعة متحيرة وألف ونيف وعشرين كوكبا ثوابت.

[52] §290. The text distinguishes material dimension, which excludes another material dimension, from the dimension identified with place, which is itself described as free of matter [المادة]. This differs from the question whether a place can be physically unoccupied, answered negatively at §293.

four simple elements, all spherical: fire, air, water, and earth. Their number is derived from the pairings of active and passive qualities [الكيفية].

(299) والكل بسائط. (300) خالية من الكيفيات الفعلية والانفعالية ولوازمها. (301) شفافة : (302) وأما العناصر البسيطة فأربعة كرية النار والهواء والماء والأرض واستفيد عددها من مزاوجات الكيفيات الفعلية والانفعالية. · Āmulī pp.156–158

§303 Each changes into its adjacent [element], and into a nonadjacent one through one or more intermediaries. §304 Fire is hot, dry, and transparent. It moves in dependence [on the sphere], has a single layer, and has the capacity [القوة] to transform a composite into itself. §305 Air is hot, moist, and transparent, and has four layers. §306 Water is cold, moist, and transparent. It surrounds three quarters of the earth and has one layer. §307 Earth is cold and dry, stationary at the center, transparent, and has three layers.

(303) وكل منها ينقلب إلى الملاصق ، وإلى الغير بواسطة أو بوسائط. (304) فالنار حارة يابسة شفافة متحركة بالتبعية لها طبقة واحدة وقوة على إحالة المركب إليها. (305) والهواء حار رطب شفاف له أربع طبقات. (306) والماء بارد رطب شفاف محيط بثلاثة أرباع الأرض له طبقة واحدة. (307) والأرض باردة يابسة ساكنة في الوسط شفافة لها ثلاث طبقات. · Āmulī pp.159–162

§308 As for composites, these four are their elements. §309 Composites originate when some [elements] act upon others. §310 A quality [الكيفية] acts upon matter [المادة] and diminishes the purity of the quality it bears. The result is an intermediate quality, uniform throughout the whole: temperament [المزاج]. §311 [This occurs] while the forms [الصورة] of the simple [elements] are preserved. §312 Temperaments [المزاج] then differ in their preparation [of composites to receive forms] [الصورة], according to their proximity to, or distance from, equilibrium.[53]

(308) وأما المركبات فهذه الأربعة أسطقساتها. (309) وهي حادثة عند تفاعل بعضها في بعض. (310) فتفعل الكيفية في المادة فتكسر صرافة كيفيتها وتحصل كيفية متشابهة في الكل متوسطة هي المزاج. (311) مع حفظ صور البسائط. (312) ثم تختلف الأمزجة في الإعداد بحسب قربها وبعدها من الاعتدال. · Āmulī pp.163–165

§313 Although individual temperaments [المزاج] are unlimited, each species has two extremes, of excess and deficiency. They

(313) مع عدم تناهيها بحسب الشخص وإن كان

[53] §312. The electronic transcription reads al-aʿdād (‘numbers’). Al-Ḥillī’s explanation concerns preparation (al-iʿdād), and the reading الإعداد is confirmed in al-Jalālī, p.152. The displayed Arabic corrects this transcription error.

[the principal temperaments] are nine.

لكل نوع طرفا إفراط وتفريط وهي تسعة.

Āmulī pp. 165 ·

Chapter 3 · Further judgments concerning bodies

الفصل الثالث في بقية أحكام الأجسام

§314 All bodies [الجسم] must be finite. For what is assumed to be infinite must be finite when compared with an equal [magnitude], on the assumption that it is smaller than that magnitude.[54] §315 And because the ratio between the two sides of an angle and what they enclose is preserved, while the latter must be finite. §316 The unity [الوحدة] of the definition and the absence of division within it indicate unity [of bodily nature]. §317 Self-evident judgment [الضرورة] affirms their persistence. §318 Bodies [الجسم] may be devoid of qualities [الكيفية] that are tasted, seen, or smelled, as air is.

(314) وتشترك الأجسام في وجوب التناهي لوجوب اتصاف ما فرض له ضده به عند مقايسته بمثله مع فرض نقصانه عنه (315) ولحفظ النسبة بين ضلعي الزاوية وما اشتملا عليه مع وجوب اتصاف الثاني به. (316) واتحاد الحد وانتفاء القسمة فيه يدل على الوحدة. (317) والضرورة قضت ببقائها. (318) ويجوز خلوها عن الكيفيات المذوقة والمرئية والمشمومة كالهواء.

Āmulī pp. 166–169 ·

§319 They can be seen provided that light and color are present; this is self-evident. §320 All bodies [الجسم] have originated in time, since they are inseparable from finitely many originated particulars. For they are never without motion [الحركة] or rest [السكون], and each of these originates, as is evident. §321 Their particulars are finite because the existence [الوجود] of infinitely many [things] is impossible, by the argument from correspondence [التطبيق]; also because every originated event [الحادث] is described by the two opposed relations [الإضافة] [of preceding and following]. What is described by one, insofar as it is so described, must exceed what is described by the other. Thus the lesser series terminates, and the greater does too.

(319) ويجوز رؤيتها بشرط الضوء واللون وهو ضروري. (320) والأجسام كلها حادثة لعدم انفكاكها من جزئيات متناهية حادثة فإنها لا تخلو عن الحركة والسكون وكل منهما حادث وهو ظاهر. (321) وأما تناهي جزئياتها فلأن وجود ما لا يتناهى محال للتطبيق ، ولوصف كل حادث بالإضافتين المتقابلتين ويجب زيادة المتصف بإحداهما من حيث هو كذلك على المتصف بالأخرى فينقطع الناقص والزائد أيضا.

Āmulī pp. 170, 172 ·

§322 Self-evident judgment [الضرورة] affirms the origination [الحدوث] of whatever is inseparable from finitely many originated events [الحادث]. §323 Bodies [الجسم], therefore, originate; and since [corporeal] accidents [العرض] cannot subsist except in bodies, their origination [الحدوث] is established as well.[55] §324 Origination [الحدوث] occurs at its particular [first] time because no time precedes it. According to some, a voluntary agent [الفاعل المختار] gives preference to one of two alternatives within its power [القدرة] without a [further determining] factor. §325 [The requirement of preexistent] matter [المادة] is denied. §326 Priority [القبلية] does not require time; this has already been established.

(322) والضرورة قضت بحدوث ما لا ينفك عن حوادث متناهية. (323) فالأجسام حادثة ولما استحال قيام الأعراض إلا بها ثبت حدوثها. (324) والحدوث اختص بوقته إذ لا وقت قبله ، والمختار يرجح أحد مقدوريه لا لأمر عند بعضهم. (325) والمادة منفية. (326) والقبلية لا تستدعي الزمان وقد سبق تحقيقه.

Āmulī pp. 173–175 ·

[54] §314. The elliptical argument compares two supposedly infinite lines after removing a finite portion from one. Their part-by-part correspondence is alleged to force the shorter, and hence the longer, to terminate.

الفصل الرابع في الجواهر المجردة

§327 As for intellect [العقل], no proof of its impossibility [الامتناع] has been established. §328 The proofs of its existence [الوجود] are defective: for example, their claim that two things cannot proceed from the One; that what is conditioned, in its action or its existence, by something posterior cannot have priority [السبق]; and that neither can what lacks the capacity to act as a cause [العلة]. [These arguments fail] because the cause here acts voluntarily.

(327) أما العقل فلم يثبت دليل على امتناعه :
(328) وأدلة وجوده مدخولة كقولهم الواحد لا يصدر عنه أمران ، ولا سبق لمشروط باللاحق في تأثيره أو وجوده ، ولا لما انتفت صلاحية التأثير عنه لأن المؤثر هنا مختار. · Āmulī pp. 175–176

§329 So too their claim that circular motion [الحركة] requires will [الإرادة], which requires assimilation to what is perfect: seeking what is already actual, or what is potential [and attainable all at once], would bring the motion to an end, while seeking the impossible is impossible. [This argument fails] because it depends on the uninterrupted continuity of what we have shown to be temporally bounded [at its beginning], and on an exhaustive division of the kinds of seeking; moreover, the impossibility [الامتناع] of seeking the impossible is disputed.[56]

(329) وقولهم : استدارة الحركة توجب الإرادة المستلزمة للتشبه بالكامل إذ طلب الحاصل فعلا أو قوة يوجب الانقطاع ، وغير الممكن محال لتوقفه على دوام ما أوجبنا انقطاعه ، وعلى حصر أقسام الطلب ، مع المنازعة في امتناع طلب المحال. · Āmulī pp. 178

§330 So too their claim that neither of the correlatives [the encompassing and the encompassed] can cause the other, lest the impossible become possible, or the stronger be caused by the weaker. [This fails] because impossibility in itself [الامتناع الذاتي] [of a void] is denied.

(330) وقولهم لا علية بين المتضايفين وإلا لأمكن الممتنع أو علل الأقوى بالأضعف لمنع الامتناع الذاتي. · Āmulī pp. 180

The soul and its immateriality

§331 The soul [النفس] is the first perfection [الكمال الأول] of a natural, organic body [الجسم] possessing life potentially. §332 It differs from that for which it is a condition [namely, temperament] [المزاج], because circularity [الدور] is impossible. §333 And because [soul [النفس] and temperament] [المزاج] oppose one another in what they require. §334 And because one can cease while the other persists. §335 It also differs from that of which one can be unaware [namely, the body] [البدن].

(331) وأما النفس فهي كمال أول لجسم طبيعي آلي ذي حياة بالقوة. (332) وهي مغايرة لما هي شرط فيه لاستحالة الدور. (333) وللممانعة في الاقتضاء (334) ولبطلان أحدهما مع ثبوت الآخر.
(335) ولما تقع الغفلة عنه. · Āmulī pp. 181–183

§336 And from that through which [one] shares [a nature with other bodies] [الجسم]. §337 And from that in which replacement occurs. §338 It is an immaterial substance [الجوهر المجرد], because its accident [العرض] [knowledge] [العلم] is immaterial. §339 And because that accident [العرض] is indivisible. §340 And because the soul [النفس] has the capacity [القوة] to do what things

(336) والمشاركة به. (337) والتبدل فيه
(338) وهي جوهر مجرد لتجرد عارضها.
(339) وعدم انقسامه. (340) وقوتها على ما تعجز المقارنات عنه. · Āmulī pp. 184–185

[55] §323. Al-Ḥillī expressly restricts this inference to corporeal accidents [العرض]. He treats the origination [الحدوث] of noncorporeal accidents under the separate argument that everything other than God has originated.

[56] §329. Here the limit on the alleged perpetuity of motion [الحركة] refers back to the proof that the world originated in time. Al-Ḥillī explicitly identifies that argument; the clause does not establish that celestial motion must cease at some future time.

conjoined with matter [المادة] cannot.

§341 And because its accident [العرض] [of intellection] [التعقل] has its supposed receptacle [المحل] [the heart or brain] as an object only intermittently. §342 And because the independence of the accident [العرض] entails the independence of its bearer. §343 And because [the soul [النفس]'s intellectual faculty] [القوة] does not follow [the body [البدن]'s weakening]. §344 And because the contrary [الضد] occurs [its intellectual faculty [القوة] grows stronger through repeated activity]. §345 Their inclusion under one definition entails their unity [الوحدة] [in species].

(341) ولحصول عارضها بالنسبة إلى ما يعقل محلا منقطعا. (342) ولاستلزام استغناء العارض استغناء المعروض. (343) ولانتفاء التبعية. (344) ولحصول الضد. (345) ودخولها تحت حد واحد يقتضي وحدتها. · Āmulī pp. 186–187

§346 Differences in accidents [العرض] do not entail differences [in the souls [النفس]' species]. §347 Souls [النفس] originate in time. This is evident on our view; on the opponent's view, were they beginningless, opposites would coincide, what has been established would be invalidated, or what is impossible would be established. §348 Souls [النفس] and bodies [البدن] correspond one to one. §349 The soul [النفس] does not perish when the body [البدن] perishes. §350 Nor does it become the principle of a form [الصورة] for another [body] [البدن]; otherwise the correspondence we have established would be invalidated.

(346) واختلاف العوارض لا يقتضي اختلافها. (347) وهي حادثة وهو ظاهر على قولنا ، وعلى قول الخصم لو كانت أزلية لزم اجتماع الضدين أو بطلان ما ثبت أو ثبوت ما يمتنع. (348) وهي مع البدن على التساوي. (349) ولا تفنى بفنائه. (350) ولا تصير مبدأ صورة لآخر وإلا بطل ما أصلناه من التعادل. · Āmulī pp. 188, 190–191

§351 It apprehends intelligibles [المعقول] through itself, and perceives through instruments, since things differing in spatial position [الوضع] are distinguished without reference [to anything outside the perceiver].[57]

(351) وتعقل بذاتها وتدرك بالآلات للامتياز بين المختلفين وضعا من غير إسناد. · Āmulī pp. 191

Faculties of the soul

§352 The soul [النفس] has faculties through which it shares [functions] with other living things: the faculties of nutrition, growth, and reproduction. §353 It has other, more specialized faculties by which apprehension [الإدراك] of either the particular or the universal [الكلي] occurs. §354 The nutritive faculty [القوة الغاذية] has the attractive, retentive, digestive, and expulsive [faculties]. §355 These may be duplicated for certain organs. §356 Growth and fattening are distinct.

(352) وللنفس قوى تشارك بها غيرها وهي الغاذية والنامية والمولدة (353) وأخرى أخص يحصل بها الإدراك إما للجزئي أو للكلي. (354) فللغاذية الجاذبة والماسكة والهاضمة والدافعة. (355) وقد تتضاعف هذه لبعض الأعضاء. (356) والنمو مغاير للسمن. · Āmulī pp. 192–194

[57] §351. Ḥillī explains "without reference" as without reference to an external object: imagined right and left eyes remain distinguishable even when no external image exists. The argument concerns bodily instruments for particular perception, contrasted with the soul [النفس]'s unaided apprehension of universals.

§357 In my view, the formative faculty [القوة المصورة] is untenable, because these ordered, composite actions cannot proceed from a simple faculty wholly without awareness. §358 As for the faculties that perceive particulars, one is touch, which is spread throughout the whole body [البدن]. §359 Whether it is multiple is open to examination. §360 Another is taste, which requires the mediation of salivary moisture devoid of a like or contrary [الضد] [taste]. §361 Another is smell, which requires air affected [by an odour], or [particles of] the odorous body [الجسم], to reach the nasal cavity.[58]

(357) والمصورة عندي باطلة لاستحالة صدور هذه الأفعال المحكمة المركبة عن قوة بسيطة ليس لها شعور أصلا. (358) وأما قوة الإدراك للجزئي فمنه اللمس وهو قوة منبثة في البدن كله.
(359) وفي تعدده نظر. (360) ومنه الذوق ويفتقر إلى توسط الرطوبة اللعابية الخالية عن المثل والضد.
(361) ومنه الشم ويفتقر إلى وصول الهواء المنفعل ، أو ذي الرائحة إلى الخيشوم. · Āmulī pp. 194–195

§362 Another is hearing, which depends on compressed air reaching the auditory passage. §363 Another is sight, whose proper objects are light and color. §364 In us, sight consists in the pupil's being affected. §365 It necessarily occurs when its conditions are present. §366 [It occurs] by the emission of a ray.[59]

(362) ومنه السمع ويتوقف على وصول الهواء المنضغط إلى الصماخ. (363) ومنه البصر ويتعلق بالذات بالضوء واللون. (364) وهو راجع فينا إلى تأثر الحدقة. (365) ويجب حصوله مع شرائطه.
(366) بخروج الشعاع. · Āmulī pp. 196–197

§367 If the ray is reflected back to the perceiver, he sees his face. §368 If the two visual axes become separated, the object appears multiple. §369 Among these faculties is phantasia [بنطاسيا] [the common sense] [الحس المشترك], which judges among the objects of the senses. §370 [Its existence [الوجود] is shown] by seeing a falling drop as a line and a flame as a circle. §371 And by the delirious person's seeing what has no [external] actuality.

(367) فإن انعكس إلى المدرك أبصر وجهه.
(368) وإن عرض تفرق السهمين تعدد المرئي.
(369) ومن هذه القوى بنطاسيا الحاكمة بين المحسوسات (370) لرؤية القطرة خطا والشعلة دائرة. (371) والمبرسم ما لا تحقق له. · Āmulī pp. 197–199

§372 And imagination [الخيال], because the receiving faculty must differ from the preserving faculty. §373 And estimation [الوهم], which apprehends particular meanings. §374 And memory [الحافظة] [which preserves those meanings]. §375 And the compositive imagination [المتخيلة], which combines forms [الصورة] and meanings with one another.

(372) والخيال لوجوب المغايرة بين القابل والحافظ. (373) والوهم المدرك للمعاني الجزئية.
(374) والحافظة. (375) والمتخيلة المركبة للصور والمعاني بعضها مع بعض. · Āmulī pp. 200

Chapter 5 · Accidents

الفصل الخامس في الأعراض

§376 These are restricted to nine [categories].

(376) وتنحصر في تسعة. · Āmulī pp. 201–202

[58] §361. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes two accounts: the surrounding air takes on the odour's quality, or particles detach from the odorous body [الجسم] and travel to the sense organ. He understands Ṭūsī as allowing both.

[59] §366. The positive reading "by the emission of a ray" is present both in the electronic Āmulī text and in Jalālī's matn, p.161, checked against the scan. Ḥillī expressly attributes the outward-ray account to Ṭūsī before criticizing it. No negation has been supplied, despite the preceding reference to the pupil's being affected.

Quantity

§377 First: Quantity [الكم]. Its continuous kinds whose parts coexist are [mathematical] body [الجسم], surface, and line; the kind whose parts do not coexist is time; and its discrete kind is number.[60] §378 They all admit equality and its absence, division, and the possible existence [الوجود] of a unit that measures them. §379 Quantity [الكم] is either intrinsic or accidental. §380 In both divisions, the second member can occur in the first [discreteness in continuity, and accidental quantity [الكم] in intrinsic quantity]. §381 The presence of what is incompatible [with contrariety] [التضاد], and the absence of its condition, indicate that contrariety is absent [from quantity] [الكم].

(377) الأول الكم فمتصله القار جسم وسطح وخط وغيره الزمان ومنفصله العدد.
(378) ويشملها قبول المساواة وعدمها والقسمة وإمكان وجود العاد. (379) وهو ذاتي وعرضي
(380) ويعرض ثاني القسمين فيهما لأولهما
(381) وفي حصول المنافي وعدم الشرط دلالة على انتفاء الضدية. · Āmulī pp. 203–205

§382 Quantity [الكم] is described by increase and multiplicity [الكثرة] and their opposites, but not by intensity and its opposite. §383 The species of continuous quantity [الكم] may be mathematical. §384 Although they differ in a certain manner of consideration. §385 The exclusion of substantiality [الجوهرية] from what is given in answer to "What is it?" in each case indicates its accidentality [العرضية]. §386 Change while the reality [الحقيقة] remains, the need to prove finitude, the existence [الثبوت] of a true sphere, dependence on an accident [العرض], and constitution by it indicate, respectively, the accidentality [العرضية] of mathematical body [الجسم التعليمي], surface, line, time, and number.

(382) ويوصف بالزيادة والكثرة ومقابليهما دون الشدة ومقابلها. (383) وأنواع متصله قد تكون تعليمية (384) وإن كانت تختلف بنوع ما من الاعتبار (385) وتخلف الجوهرية عما يقال في جواب ما هو في كل واحد يعطي عرضيته.
(386) والتبدل مع بقاء الحقيقة وافتقار التناهي إلى برهان وثبوت الكرة الحقيقية والافتقار إلى عرض والتقوم به ، يعطي عرضية الجسم التعليمي والسطح والخط والزمان والعدد. · Āmulī pp. 205–206

§387 Extremities are not nonexistences, although they are described by nonexistence [العدم] together with a kind of relation [الإضافة]. §388 The genus [الجنس] [quantity] [الكم] is the bearer of finitude and its [privative] absence.[61] §389 Both are conceptual considerations.

(387) وليست الأطراف أعداما وإن اتصفت بها مع نوع من الإضافة. (388) والجنس معروض التناهي وعدمه. (389) وهما اعتباريان. · Āmulī pp. 207–208

Quality

§390 Second: Quality [الكيف]. It is characterized by negative qualifications that, taken together, distinguish it from everything else. §391 Its divisions are four. §392 Sensible qualities [الكيفية] are either affective qualities [الكيفيات الانفعالية] or affections [الانفعالات] [depending on their stability].[62] §393 They differ from shapes because different things are predicated of them. §394 And [they differ] from temperament [المزاج], because they are more general.

(390) الثاني الكيف ويرسم بقيود عدمية تخصه جملتها بالاجتماع. (391) وأقسامه أربعة.
(392) فالمحسوسات إما انفعاليات أو انفعالات.
(393) وهي مغايرة للأشكال لاختلافهما في الحمل.
(394) والمزاج لعمومها. · Āmulī pp. 208–211

[60] §377. Al-Ḥillī defines qārr al-dhāt through the coexistence of its parts and contrasts it with time, whose different portions cannot coexist. 'Body [الجسم]' here is mathematical body [الجسم التعليمي], or three-dimensional magnitude, rather than substance [الجوهر].

[61] §388. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes privative nonfinitude, which presupposes quantity [الكم], from mere negation of finitude, which can be said of things without quantity. This keeps the assertion from attributing positive infinite magnitude to everything that is not finite.

[62] §392. "Affective qualities [الكيفيات الانفعالية]" and "affections [الانفعالات]" render the traditional distinction between relatively stable sensible qualities [الكيفية] and transient sensible states. They do not refer specifically to emotion.

Tangible qualities and inclination

§395 Among them are the primary tangible qualities [الكيفية]: heat, cold, moisture, and dryness. The remainder are referred to these. §396 Heat gathers together things of like nature and separates things of unlike nature; cold does the reverse. §397 The two are contraries [الضد]. §398 "Heat" is also applied to other meanings differing in reality [الحقيقة] from the [sensible] quality [الكيفية]. §399 Moisture is a quality [الكيفية] entailing ease of taking shape; dryness is the reverse.

(395) فمنها أوائل الملموسات وهي الحرارة والبرودة والرطوبة واليبوسة والبواقي منتسبة إليها.
(396) فالحرارة جامعة للمتشاكلات ، مفرقة للمختلفات ، والبرودة بالعكس. (397) وهما متضادتان. (398) وتطلق الحرارة على معان أخر مخالفة للكيفية في الحقيقة. (399) والرطوبة كيفية تقتضي سهولة التشكل ، واليبوسة بالعكس :

Āmulī pp. 211–212 ·

§400 They differ from softness and hardness. §401 Heaviness is a quality [الكيفية] entailing the body [الجسم]'s movement to where its center coincides with the center of the world, if heaviness is absolute. Lightness is the reverse. The terms are also used relatively, in two respects. §402 Inclination [الميل] is natural, forced, or psychical. §403 It is the proximate cause [العلة القريبة] of motion [الحركة], and through it something changing proceeds from something constant.
§404 [Inclinations] [الميل] differing [in direction] are contrary [الضد].

(400) وهما مغايرتان للين والصلابة. (401) والثقل كيفية تقتضي حركة الجسم إلى حيث ينطبق مركزه على مركز العالم إن كان مطلقا ، والخفة بالعكس ، ويقالان بالإضافة باعتبارين.
(402) والميل طبيعي وقسري ونفساني. (403) وهو العلة القريبة للحركة وباعتباره يصدر عن الثابت متغير. (404) ومختلفه متضاد ·

Āmulī pp. 213–214 ·

§405 Without its existence [الثبوت], what has an impediment would be equal [in motion] [الحركة] to what lacks one.[63]
§406 According to others, it is a genus [الجنس] with [species] corresponding to the number of directions, and its instances are alike or different in respect of those directions.
§407 Heaviness is one of its kinds; others among them regard it as different. §408 Some inclination [الميل] is inseparable, and some separable. §409 It requires a receptacle [المحل], and only one.

(405) ولو لا ثبوته لتساوي ذو العائق وعادمه
(406) وعند آخرين هو جنس بحسب عدد الجهات ومتماثل ومختلف باعتبارها. (407) ومنه الثقل وآخرون منهم جعلوه مغايرا. (408) ومنه لازم ومفارق. (409) ويفتقر إلى محل لا غير ·

Āmulī pp. 214–216 ·

§410 It lies within our power [القدرة]. §411 Things are generated from it: some by its own nature without a condition, some under a condition, and some not by its own nature [but through an intermediary].

(410) وهو مقدور لنا. (411) وتتولد عنه أشياء بعضها لذاته من غير شرط ، وبعضها بشرط ، وبعضها لا لذاته. ·

Āmulī pp. 216 ·

Color and light

§412 Among [sensible qualities] [الكيفية] are the primary visible qualities, color and light. §413 Each has two extremes. §414 The former [color] has a reality [الحقيقة] of its own. §415 Its two extremes are blackness and whiteness, which are contraries [الضد]. §416 It depends on the latter [light] for being perceived, not for existing.

(412) ومنها أوائل المبصرات وهي اللون والضوء
(413) ولكل منهما طرفان. (414) وللأول حقيقة.
(415) وطرفاه السواد والبياض المتضادان.
(416) ويتوقف على الثاني في الإدراك لا الوجود. ·

Āmulī pp. 217–218 ·

[63] §405. Al-Ḥillī understands this as an argument for natural inclination [الميل] in a body capable of forced motion [الحركة]. The natural inclination supplies an internal resistance; the ratio argument compares motion with and without resistance.

§417 The two [color and light] are perceptibly different. §418 Both admit intensity and weakness; [the intense and weak instances] differ in species. §419 If the latter [light] were a body [الجسم], the result would contradict what the senses perceive. §420 Rather, it is an accident [العرض] inhering in a receptacle [المحل]; it prepares what faces that receptacle to acquire a similar [quality]. §421 It is intrinsic or accidental, primary or secondary.

(417) وهما متغايران حسا. (418) قابلان للشدة والضعف ، المتباينان نوعا. (419) ولو كان الثاني جسما لحصل ضد المحسوس. (420) بل هو عرض قائم بالمحل معد لحصول مثله في المقابل. (421) وهو ذاتي وعرضي ، أول وثان. · Āmulī pp. 218–220

§422 Darkness is a privation [عدم الملكة].

(422) والظلمة عدم ملكة. · Āmulī pp. 220

Sound, letters, and speech

§423 Among [sensible qualities] are audible things: sounds arising from undulation caused by striking and pulling apart. §424 On condition of resistance. §425 [Sound occurs] outside [the ear]. §426 Its persistence is impossible, because the formal configuration [الهيئة الصورية] [of successive sounds] must be perceived. §427 Another [sound] arises from it [as an echo].

(423) ومنها المسموعات وهي الأصوات الحاصلة من التموج المعلول للقرع والقلع. (424) بشرط المقاومة. (425) في الخارج. (426) ويستحيل بقاؤه لوجوب إدراك الهيئة الصورية. (427) ويحصل منه آخر. · Āmulī pp. 220–222

§428 A sound bears a distinguishing quality [الكيفية], in virtue of which it is called a letter. §429 [A letter] is either a vowel or a consonant; [consonants] are alike or different, intrinsically or accidentally. §430 Speech, in its various divisions, is composed of them. §431 No other [kind of speech] is intelligible.[64]

(428) وتعرض له كيفية مميزة ، تسمى باعتبارها حرفا. (429) إما مصوت أو صامت ، متماثل أو مختلف بالذات أو بالعرض. (430) وينتظم منها الكلام بأقسامه. (431) ولا يعقل غيره. · Āmulī pp. 222–223

Tastes and smells

§432 Among [sensible qualities] [الكيفية] are the nine tastes, arising from the interaction of three [qualities] with an equal number [of others]. §433 And smells: their species have no names except in respect of agreeableness or disagreeableness.

(432) ومنها المطعومات التسع الحادثة من تفاعل الثلاث في مثلها. (433) ومنها المشمومات ولا أسماء لأنواعها إلا من حيث الموافقة والمخالفة. · Āmulī pp. 223–224

Dispositions

§434 [Another class comprises] dispositions [الاستعداد] intermediate between the two sides of contradiction [التناقض] [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم].

(434) والاستعدادات المتوسطة بين طرفي النقيض. · Āmulī pp. 224

Psychical qualities

§435 Psychical qualities [الكيفيات النفسانية] are either passing states [الحال] or established dispositions [الملكة].

(435) والنفسانية حال أو ملكة. · Āmulī pp. 225

[64] §431. Ḥillī explains this as denying a kind of speech beyond the articulated speech just defined; the immediate polemical target is speech conceived as an additional inner attribute.

Knowledge

§436 Among them is knowledge [العلم]: either conception [التصور], or assent [التصديق] that is firm, corresponds [to its object], and is stable.[65] §437 It is not susceptible to definition. §438 Both [conception [التصور] and assent] [التصديق] divide into non-inferential [الضروري] and acquired [knowledge] [العلم]. §439 [Knowledge] [العلم] requires the impression [of a form] [الصورة]. §440 In an immaterial receptacle [المحل] capable of receiving it.

(436) منها العلم وهو إما تصور أو تصديق جازم مطابق ثابت. (437) ولا يحد. (438) ويقتسمان الضرورة والاكتساب. (439) ولا بد فيه من الانطباع. (440) في المحل المجرد القابل.
Āmulī pp. 225–226 ·

§441 The inherence of a likeness differs [from the inherence of the thing itself]. §442 Union [of intellect [العقل] and intelligible] [المعقول] is impossible. §443 [Knowledge] [العلم] differs according to differences in what is understood. §444 As with the present and the future. §445 It can be understood only in relation [to an object]; the difficulty is therefore greater when there is identity [of knower and known].[66]

(441) وحلول المثال مغاير. (442) ولا يمكن الاتحاد. (443) ويختلف باختلاف المعقول. (444) كالحال والاستقبال. (445) ولا يعقل إلا مضافا فيقوى الإشكال مع الاتحاد.
Āmulī pp. 227–228 ·

§446 It is an accident [العرض], because the definition [of an accident] applies to it. §447 It is active, passive, or neither. §448 And non-inferential [الضروري], with six divisions, or acquired. §449 And necessary or possible [in its existence] [الوجود]. §450 It follows [the known], in the sense that what corresponds to it [the known] is primary in their correspondence.

(446) وهو عرض لوجود حده فيه. (447) وهو فعلي وانفعالي وغيرهما. (448) وضروري أقسامه ستة ، ومكتسب. (449) وواجب وممكن. (450) وهو تابع بمعنى أصالة موازيه في التطابق.
Āmulī pp. 229–230 ·

§451 Thus the circularity [الدور] is removed. §452 It requires preparedness: for non-inferential knowledge [العلم الضروري], through the senses; for acquired knowledge [العلم الكسبي], through the former [non-inferential knowledge]. §453 In one usage, knowledge [العلم] differs from apprehension [الإدراك] as a species differs from its genus [الجنس]; in another, they differ as two species. §454 Complete knowledge [العلم] of the cause [العلة] entails complete knowledge of the effect [المعلول]. §455 Its degrees are three.

(451) فزال الدور. (452) ولا بد فيه من الاستعداد أما الضروري فبالحواس وأما الكسبي فبالأول. (453) وباصطلاح يفارق الإدراك مفارقة الجنس النوع وباصطلاح آخر مفارقة النوعين. (454) وتعلقه على التمام بالعلة يستلزم تعلقه كذلك بالمعلول. (455) ومراتبه ثلاث.
Āmulī pp. 231–233 ·

§456 What has a cause [السبب] is known only through its cause, in a universal [الكلي] manner.[67] §457 Intellect [العقل] is an innate disposition [الغريزة] entailing knowledge [العلم] of non-inferential [الضروري] truths when the instruments are sound. §458 The term is applied to other things equivocally.

(456) وذو السبب إنما يعلم به كليا. (457) والعقل غريزة يلزمها العلم بالضروريات عند سلامة الآلات. (458) ويطلق على غيره بالاشتراك.
Āmulī pp. 233–234 ·

[65] §436. Here "knowledge [العلم]" is used broadly enough to include conception [التصور] as well as true, firm, stable assent [التصديق]. Subsequent clauses distinguish this broad usage from narrower epistemic usages. "Non-inferential" renders epistemic ḍarūrī and does not mean metaphysical necessity.

[66] §445. The difficulty concerns self-knowledge [العلم]: if knowledge is an impressed likeness and a relation, how can knower and known be identical? The main text raises the difficulty tersely; it does not state the full attempted solutions discussed by Ḥillī.

[67] §456. "Universally" describes the mode of causal knowledge [العلم]. Ḥillī illustrates it with knowledge of a particular eclipse through its causes and universal [الكلي] conditions. The clause is compressed and should not be expanded into a general denial that particulars can be perceived.

Belief, doubt, and opinion

§459 "Belief [الاعتقاد]" is applied to one of the two divisions of knowledge [العلم] [assent] [التصديق]. §460 Thus the relations [النسبة] of generality and specificity between belief [الاعتقاد] and knowledge [العلم] are reversed [under different usages]. §461 Contrariety [التضاد] occurs in belief [الاعتقاد], unlike knowledge [العلم]. §462 Inattention is a privation [عدم الملكة] of knowledge [العلم]; it may be distinguished from forgetting. §463 Doubt is the mind's wavering between the two alternatives.

(459) والاعتقاد يقال لأحد قسميه.
(460) فيتعاكسان في العموم والخصوص.
(461) ويقع فيه التضاد بخلاف العلم.
(462) والسهو عدم ملكة العلم وقد يفرق بينه وبين النسيان. (463) والشك تردد الذهن بين الطرفين. · Āmulī pp. 235–236

§464 Both belief [الاعتقاد] and knowledge [العلم] can have themselves and one another as objects; the difference is then one of consideration, not of forms [الصورة]. §465 Ignorance in one sense is opposed to both; in another sense it is a division of one of them [belief] [الاعتقاد]. §466 Opinion [الظن] is giving preponderance to one of two alternatives; it differs from believing that there is such preponderance. §467 It admits intensity and weakness, and its two extremes are knowledge [العلم] and [simple] ignorance.[68]

(464) وقد يصح تعلق كل من الاعتقاد والعلم بنفسه وبالآخر فيتغاير الاعتبار لا الصور.
(465) والجهل بمعنى يقابلهما وآخر قسم لأحدهما.
(466) والظن ترجيح أحد الطرفين وهو غير اعتقاد الرجحان. (467) ويقبل الشدة والضعف وطرفاه علم وجهل. · Āmulī pp. 237–238

Reflection and proof

§468 It is self-evident that acquired knowledge [العلم الكسبي] results from reflection [النظر] when both its parts [matter [المادة] and form] [الصورة] are sound.[69] §469 When either is defective, the contrary [الضد] [ignorance] may result. §470 The production of knowledge [العلم] by sound reflection [النظر] is necessary. §471 There is no need for a teacher. §472 There must, however, be the formal part [الجزء الصوري] [the proper arrangement of the premises].

(468) وكسبي العلم يحصل بالنظر مع سلامة جزأيه ضرورة. (469) ومع فساد أحدهما قد يحصل ضده (470) وحصول العلم عن الصحيح واجب.
(471) ولا حاجة إلى المعلم. (472) نعم لا بد من الجزء الصوري. · Āmulī pp. 238–241

§473 Reflection [النظر] requires both the absence of its goal [knowledge [العلم] of what is sought] and the absence of that goal's contrary [الضد] [false conviction], while what is sought must be present [as a question in the mind]. §474 The obligation to reflect is rational: what the two rational duties [gratitude and removal of fear] depend upon is obligatory; and supposing the contrary of the desired conclusion [that the obligation depends solely on revelation] would negate that contrary itself. §475 What entails knowledge [العلم] is a proof; what entails opinion [الظن] is an indication. §476 Its simple constituents [premises] are rational or mixed [rational and transmitted], because circularity [الدور] is impossible. §477 Verbal evidence may yield certainty.

(473) وشرطه عدم الغاية وضدها وحضورها.
(474) ولوجوب ما يتوقف عليه العقليان وانتفاء ضد المطلوب على تقدير ثبوته كان التكليف به عقليا. (475) وملزوم العلم دليل والظن أمارة.
(476) وبسائطه عقلية ومركبة لاستحالة الدور.
(477) وقد يفيد اللفظي القطع. · Āmulī pp. 241, 243

§478 It must be interpreted when there is conflict [with another

(478) ويجب تأويله عند التعارض. (479) وهو

[68] §467. Al-Ḥillī identifies this ignorance with pure doubt, in which neither alternative has preponderance. The endpoint is not the false conviction called compound ignorance in §465.

[69] §468. The claim here concerns the self-evidence of sound reflection [النظر]'s efficacy; the following claim at 470 concerns the necessity of knowledge [العلم] resulting from sound reflection. This distinction follows Ḥillī's explanation of the two passages.

transmitted proof or with rational proof]. §479 Proof is either syllogism [القياس] or one of the two other divisions [induction [الاستقراء] and analogy] [التمثيل].

قياس وقسيماه. · Āmulī pp. 244

Syllogistic forms

§480 Syllogism [القياس] is either conjunctive [الاقتراني] or exceptive [الاستثنائي].[70] §481 The former has four divisions in respect of its proximate form [الصورة], and two in respect of its remote form.[71]

(480) فالقياس اقتراني واستثنائي. (481) فالأول باعتبار الصورة القريبة أربعة والبعيدة اثنان. · Āmulī pp. 244–245

§482 And five in respect of its proximate matter [المادة], and four in respect of its remote matter.[72] §483 The latter, when implicative, yields two valid forms; so too when its disjunction is nonexclusive or nonexhaustive. A strict disjunction yields twice that number.[73]

(482) وباعتبار المادة القريبة خمسة والبعيدة أربعة. (483) والثاني متصل فناتجه أمران وكذا غير الحقيقي من المنفصل ، ومنه ضعفه. · Āmulī pp. 245–246

§484 The last two [induction [الاستقراء] and analogy] [التمثيل] yield opinion [الظن]. The details of these matters are treated in another discipline.

(484) والأخيران يفيدان الظن وتفاصيل هذه الأشياء مذكورة في غير هذا الفن. · Āmulī pp. 246

Intellection and immateriality

§485 Intellection [التعقل] and immateriality [التجرد] entail one another. Division of the receptacle [المحل] would entail division of what inheres: if [the parts] were alike, position would belong to what is immaterial; otherwise it would be composed of infinitely many parts. §486 And because immateriality [التجرد] entails the possibility [الإمكان] of being understood, which entails the possibility of association [with another intelligible] [المعقول].

(485) والتعقل والتجرد متلازمان لاستلزام انقسام المحل انقسام الحال فإن تشابهت عرض الوضع للمجرد وإلا تركب مما لا يتناهى. (486) ولاستلزام التجرد صحة المعقولية المستلزمة لإمكان المصاحبة. · Āmulī pp. 246–247

[70] §480. Conjunctive [الاقتراني] (iqtirānī) syllogisms contain the conclusion only potentially in their premises. Exceptive [الاستثنائي] (istithnāʾī) syllogisms explicitly affirm or deny a component of a conditional or disjunctive premise.

[71] §481. Ḥillī identifies the four proximate forms [الصورة] as the four syllogistic figures and the two remote forms as categorical and conditional.

[72] §482. The five kinds by proximate matter [المادة] are demonstration, dialectic, rhetoric, sophistry, and poetry. The four kinds by remote matter are accepted, probable, specious, and imaginative premises, according to Ḥillī's explanation.

[73] §483. The two implicative forms are affirming the antecedent and denying the consequent. A disjunction that is exclusive without necessarily being exhaustive, or exhaustive without necessarily being exclusive, permits two forms; a strict disjunction, both exclusive and exhaustive, permits four.

Power

§487 Among [psychical qualities] [الكيفيات النفسانية] is power [القدرة]. It differs from nature because it is accompanied by awareness, and from temperament [المزاج] because what follows from it [its effects] is different. §488 It makes the act possible in relation [النسبة] [to the agent]. §489 It extends to both alternatives. §490 It precedes the act: because the unbeliever is subject to obligation; because of incompatibility [on the contrary hypothesis]; and because, without its priority [التقدم], one of two impossibilities would follow.[74] §491 A single act cannot be brought about by more than one possessor of power [القدرة].[75]

(487) ومنها القدرة وتفارق الطبيعة والمزاج بمقارنة الشعور والمغايرة في التابع. (488) مصححة للفعل بالنسبة. (489) وتعلقها بالطرفين. (490) وتتقدم الفعل لتكليف الكافر وللتنافي ولزوم أحد محالين لولاه. (491) ولا يتحد وقوع المقدور مع تعدد القادر. · Āmulī pp. 247–249

§492 There is no implausibility in powers [القدرة] being alike. §493 Power [القدرة] is opposed to incapacity [العجز] as possession [الملكة] is opposed to privation [عدم الملكة]. §494 Power [القدرة] and character differ because contrary [الضد] judgments apply to them; [character also differs] from the act.[76]

(492) ولا استبعاد في تماثلها. (493) وتقابل العجز تقابل الملكة والعدم (494) وتغاير الخلق لتضاد أحكامهما والفعل. · Āmulī pp. 249–250

Pain and pleasure

§495 Among [psychical qualities] [الكيفيات النفسانية] are pain and pleasure. They are two species of apprehension [الإدراك], distinguished by a relation [الإضافة] that varies according to what they are compared with. §496 Pleasure is not merely departure from the natural state.[77] §497 Pain may be grounded in the disruption of continuity. §498 Each is either sensory or intellectual; the latter is stronger.

(495) ومنها الألم واللذة وهما نوعان من الإدراك تخصصا بإضافة تختلف بالقياس. (496) وليست اللذة خروجا عن الحالة الطبيعية لا غير.
(497) وقد يستند الألم إلى التفرق. (498) وكل منهما حسي وعقلي هو أقوى. · Āmulī pp. 250–251

Will, aversion, and life

§499 Among [psychical qualities] [الكيفيات النفسانية] are will [الإرادة] and aversion [الكراهة], which are two species of knowledge [العلم] [in the broad sense].[78] §500 One entails the other when [their objects] are opposed.[79]

(499) ومنها الإرادة والكراهة وهما نوعان من العلم. (500) وأحدهما لازم مع التقابل. · Āmulī pp. 252

[74] §490. The last two reasons are strongly elliptical. In his first explanation, Ḥillī treats the "two impossibilities" as temporal origination of divine power or beginninglessness of the act. He also offers an alternative interpretation involving opposed acts. The translation does not silently choose one of these as the wording of Ṭūsī himself.

[75] §491. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes one act being within the power [القدرة] of two agents from its actually being produced by both. He permits the former if the act is realised through one of them; his objection to joint production treats each power as sufficient for the act in its own right.

[76] §494. Following Ḥillī, "and the act" is taken to add that character differs from the act, after distinguishing character from power [القدرة]. Character (khuluq) is an established disposition from which acts issue easily.

[77] §496. The principal reading in both the electronic text and Jalālī's matn, p.176, says "departure from the natural state." Jalālī's apparatus records "nonnatural" in one witness and cites Qūshjī's fuller reading, "departure from the nonnatural state into the natural state." That alternative would yield the familiar rejection of defining pleasure merely as restoration to the natural state. The main translation preserves the printed principal reading.

[78] §499. Al-Ḥillī takes knowledge [العلم] here broadly to include belief or opinion concerning the benefit or harm in an act. The classification does not require the agent's assessment to be certain or true.

[79] §500. This follows Ḥillī's first reading: willing a thing entails aversion to its opposite. He also suggests that the clause may mean that knowledge [العلم] entails one or the other of will and aversion, depending on benefit or harm. The Arabic is exceptionally compressed.

§501 They are considered differently in relation [النسبة] to the agent and in relation to someone else. §502 They may concern themselves, unlike appetite and repugnance. §503 These qualities [الكيفية] require life. In our case, life is a characteristic entailing sensation and movement and is conditioned by equilibrium of temperament [المزاج]. §504 Thus a bodily structure is necessary. §505 [Life] requires the vital spirit [الروح].

(501) ويتغاير اعتبارهما بالنسبة إلى الفاعل وغيره.
(502) وقد تتعلقان بذاتيهما بخلاف الشهوة والنفرة.
(503) فهذه الكيفيات تفتقر إلى الحياة وهي صفة تقتضي الحس والحركة مشروطة باعتدال المزاج عندنا. (504) فلا بد من البنية. (505) وتفتقر إلى الروح. · Āmulī pp. 252–254

§506 It is opposed to death as possession [الملكة] is opposed to privation [عدم الملكة].

(506) وتقابل الموت تقابل العدم والملكة. · Āmulī pp. 254

Other psychical qualities

§507 Among psychical qualities [الكيفيات النفسانية] are health and disease. §508 And joy and distress. §509 And anger, sorrow, worry, shame, and rancor.

(507) ومن الكيفيات النفسانية الصحة والمرض.
(508) والفرح والغم (509) والغضب والحزن والهم والخجل والحقد. · Āmulī pp. 254–255

Qualities of quantity

§510 Qualities [الكيفية] specific to quantity [الكم] concern either continuous quantity, such as straightness, circularity, curvature, concavity, convexity, shape, and appearance; or discrete quantity, such as evenness and oddness. §511 The straight line is the shortest of the lines joining two points. Just as it exists, so does the circle. §512 There is no contrariety [التضاد] between the straight and the circular; nor, therefore, between their [corresponding] attributes. §513 Shape is the configuration in which a boundary or boundaries encompass a body [الجسم]; with the addition of color, appearance results.

(510) والمختصة بالكمية إما المتصلة كالاستقامة والاستدارة والانحناء والتقعير والتقبيب والشكل والخلقة ، أو المنفصلة كالزوجية والفردية.
(511) فالمستقيم أقصر الخطوط الواصلة بين نقطتين وكما أنه موجود فكذا الدائرة. (512) والتضاد منتف عن المستقيم والمستدير فكذا عن عارضيهما.
(513) والشكل هيئة إحاطة الحد أو الحدود بالجسم ومع انضمام اللون تحصل الخلقة. · Āmulī pp. 255–256

Relation

§514 Third: The Relative. §515 It is either relative in the strict sense [المضاف الحقيقي] or in ordinary usage [the relation [الإضافة] itself or the thing bearing it]. §516 It necessarily involves reciprocity and parity [of the correlatives], in actuality [الفعل] or potentiality [القوة]. §517 It occurs in all existents. §518 Its existence [الثبوت] is mental; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow. Saying that relation [الإضافة] is relative in itself does not help.

(514) الثالث المضاف. (515) وهو حقيقي ومشهوري. (516) ويجب فيه الانعكاس والتكافؤ بالفعل أو القوة (517) ويعرض للموجودات أجمع.
(518) وثبوته ذهني وإلا تسلسل ولا ينفع تعلق الإضافة بذاتها. · Āmulī pp. 257–258

§519 And because its existence [الوجود] would precede [its own existence].[80] §520 And an infinity [of relations] [الإضافة] would follow at every position in the series of numbers. §521 And the attributes of God Most High would be multiplied. §522 Every relative in ordinary usage [المضاف المشهوري] has its own relative in the strict sense [المضاف الحقيقي]. Difference and agreement therefore occur in the latter. [The relation [الإضافة] belongs to its bearer] either through an additional factor or without one.[81]

(519) ولتقدم وجودها عليه. (520) ولزم عدم التناهي في كل مرتبة من مراتب الأعداد. (521) وتكثر صفاته تعالى. (522) ويخص كل مضاف مشهوري مضاف حقيقي فيعرض له الاختلاف والاتفاق إما باعتبار زائد أو لا. · Āmulī pp. 259–260

Place and motion

§523 Fourth: Where, which is relation [النسبة] to place. §524 According to some, its species are four: motion [الحركة], rest [السكون], conjunction, and separation. §525 Motion [الحركة] is the first perfection [الكمال الأول] of what is potential, insofar as it is potential; or the body [الجسم]'s being in one place after another. §526 Its existence [الوجود] is self-evident. §527 It depends on the two opposites [starting point and endpoint], the two causes [mover and moved], that to which it is referred [the category in which it occurs], and its measure [time].

(523) الرابع الأين وهي النسبة إلى المكان. (524) وأنواعه أربعة عند قوم هي الحركة والسكون والاجتماع والافتراق. (525) فالحركة كمال أول لما بالقوة من حيث هو بالقوة أو حصول الجسم في مكان بعد آخر. (526) ووجودها ضروري. (527) يتوقف على المتقابلين والعلتين والمنسوب إليه والمقدار. · Āmulī pp. 261–262

§528 The starting point and endpoint may have the same locus, or may be contrary [الضد] intrinsically or accidentally. §529 They have two opposed considerations, one with reference to that of which they are predicated [and the other with reference to each other]. §530 If the two causes were identical, the effect [المعلول] [motion] [الحركة] would not occur. §531 And [motion] [الحركة] would be universal [to all bodies] [الجسم]. §532 This differs from nature, which varies and entails [motion [الحركة] only] in a certain condition.

(528) فما منه وما إليه قد يتحدان محلا وقد يتضادان ذاتا وعرضا. (529) ولهما اعتباران متقابلان أحدهما بالنظر إلى ما يقالان له. (530) ولو اتحدت العلتان انتفى المعلول. (531) وعم. (532) بخلاف الطبيعة المختلفة المستلزمة في حال ما. · Āmulī pp. 263–264

§533 There are four [categories] to which motion [الحركة] is referred. For simple substances [الجوهر] come into existence [الوجود] all at once, and composite substances cease to exist when [one of] their parts ceases to exist.[82] §534 The relative is dependent [on other categories]. §535 So too is when. §536 Having comes about all at once. §537 No motion [الحركة] is intelligible in the categories of acting and being acted upon.

(533) والمنسوب إليه أربع فإن بسائط الجواهر توجد دفعة ومركباتها تعدم بعدم أجزائها. (534) والمضاف تابع. (535) وكذا متى. (536) والجدة دفعة. (537) ولا تعقل حركة في مقولتي الفعل والانفعال. · Āmulī pp. 265–266

[80] §519. The pronoun is ambiguous. Ḥillī first understands the argument as requiring the existence [الوجود] of relation to precede its own existence; he also allows "its receptacle [المحل]" as the referent. The first interpretation supplies the bracketed words.

[81] §522. Al-Ḥillī first distinguishes unlike relations [الإضافة], such as fatherhood and sonship, from like relations, such as brotherhood and neighbourhood. The final qualification concerns how a relation belongs to its bearer: knowledge [العلم] supplies an additional factor in the knower, whereas being to the right or left requires no such further quality.

[82] §533. The argument concerns a composite's dependence on its constituents: the loss of one constituent suffices. Al-Ḥillī explicitly glosses the plural "parts" with "one of its parts."

The categories in which motion occurs

§538 In quantity [الكم], [motion [الحركة] occurs] in two respects: [rarefaction and condensation, as shown] by water entering a vessel inverted upon it, and by vessels bursting when their contents boil. §539 And [growth, as shown] by the proportional movement of the parts of what is nourished in all dimensions. §540 In quality [الكيف], [motion [الحركة] occurs] because alteration is perceived, while concealment and influx [as explanations] are certainly false, since sense perception [الحس] refutes both.[83] §541 In place and position it is evident. §542 Unity [الوحدة] occurs in motion [الحركة] through the unity of its measure, locus, and recipient.[84]

(538) ففي الكم باعتبارين لدخول الماء القارورة المكبوبة عليه ، وتصدع الآنية عند الغليان.
(539) وحركة أجزاء المغتذي في جميع الأقطار على التناسب. (540) وفي الكيف للاستحالة المحسوسة مع الجزم ببطلان الكمون والورود لتكذيب الحس لهما. (541) وفي الأين والوضع ظاهر.
(542) وتعرض لها وحدة باعتبار وحدة المقدار والمحل والقابل. · Āmulī pp. 266–268

§543 Difference in the two opposites and in that to which motion [الحركة] is referred entails difference [in motion]. §544 And contrariety [التضاد] in the first two entails contrariety [of motions] [الحركة]. §545 Neither the two opposites nor the agent has a role in [motion [الحركة]'s] division. §546 Motion [الحركة] has a quality [الكيفية] that makes it fast when intensified and slow when weakened. The quiddity [الماهية] of motion does not differ on that account. §547 The cause [السبب] of slowness is external or internal resistance, not intervening rests; otherwise what possesses the opposite [speed] would not be perceived.

(543) واختلاف المتقابلين والمنسوب إليه يقتضي الاختلاف. (544) وتضاد الأولين التضاد.
(545) ولا مدخل للمتقابلين والفاعل في الانقسام.
(546) وتعرض لها كيفية تشتد فتكون الحركة سريعة ، وتضعف فتكون بطيئة ولا تختلف بهما الماهية. (547) وسبب البطء الممانعة الخارجية أو الداخلية لا تخلل السكنات وإلا لما أحس بما اتصف بالمقابل. · Āmulī pp. 268–270

§548 Motions [الحركة] involving angles or reversal are not continuous, because an interval of time lies between the two instants of inclination [الميل].

(548) ولا اتصال لذوات الزوايا والانعطاف لوجود زمان بين آني الميلين. · Āmulī p. 270

Rest and kinds of spatial state

§549 Rest [السكون] preserves relations [النسبة]; it is therefore a contrary [الضد] [of motion] [الحركة]. §550 It is opposed to both motions [الحركة] [toward and away from the place of rest].[85] §551 Outside the category of where, [rest [السكون] is] the preservation of the species [of state within the category]. §552 Instances of rest [السكون] are contrary [الضد] because what they occur in is contrary. §553 Among spatial states [motion [الحركة] and rest] [السكون], some are natural, some forced, and some voluntary.[86]

(549) والسكون حفظ النسب فهو ضد.
(550) يقابل الحركتين. (551) وفي غير الأين حفظ النوع. (552) ويتضاد لتضاد ما فيه.
(553) ومن الكون طبيعي وقسري وإرادي. · Āmulī pp. 271–272

[83] §540. "Concealment" (kumūn) explains apparent alteration as the emergence of a previously hidden quality [الكيف]; "influx" (wurūd) explains it by entry of something from outside. The text rejects both as general substitutes for genuine qualitative alteration.

[84] §542. The measure is time. Ḥillī takes the remaining terms as the subject and the category in which motion [الحركة] occurs, but explicitly allows "locus" and "recipient" to exchange those references. The translation preserves the general terms.

[85] §550. The bracket follows Ḥillī's first interpretation: rest is opposed both to movement from its place and to movement into it. He also allows "the two motions [الحركة]" to mean rectilinear and circular motion.

[86] §553. Kawn here is the genus [الجنس] of bodily occupation of place, encompassing motion [الحركة] and rest [السكون], not origination or existence [الوجود] in its unrestricted metaphysical sense.

§554 Natural motion [الحركة] occurs only when something unnatural accompanies [the body] [الجسم]. §555 To return the body [الجسم] to its natural condition, at which point it comes to rest [السكون]. §556 Thus it cannot be circular. §557 Forced motion [الحركة] rests on an acquired force [القوة] capable of weakening. §558 Natural rest [السكون] is grounded in nature without qualification.

(554) فطبيعي الحركة إنما يحصل عند مقارنة أمر غير طبيعي. (555) ليرد الجسم إليه فيقف (556) فلا تكون دورية (557) وقسريها مستند إلى قوة مستفادة قابلة للضعف. (558) وطبيعي السكون يستند إلى الطبيعة مطلقا. · Āmulī pp. 272–274

§559 Simplicity [البساطة] and its opposite [composition] [التركيب] occur in motion [الحركة] alone [among these spatial states]. §560 Neither the genus [الجنس] nor its species is explained by what entails circularity [الدور].

(559) وتعرض البساطة ومقابلها للحركة خاصة. (560) ولا يعلل الجنس ولا أنواعه بما يقتضي الدور. · Āmulī pp. 274

Time and when

§561 Fifth: When, which is relation [النسبة] to time or its extremity. §562 Time is the measure of motion [الحركة] in respect of priority [التقدم] and posteriority, which belong to motion under a different consideration [that of distance, rather than time itself]. §563 This category belongs intrinsically to changing things, and accidentally to their bearer. §564 The existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] of its bearer do not depend on time.[87] §565 The extremity [the instant] is like the point; its nonexistence [العدم] occurs in time without being gradual.

(561) الخامس المتى وهو النسبة إلى الزمان أو طرفه. (562) والزمان مقدار الحركة من حيث التقدم والتأخر العارضين لها باعتبار آخر. (563) وإنما تعرض المقولة بالذات للمتغيرات ، وبالعرض لمعروضها. (564) ولا يفتقر وجود معروضها وعدمه إليه. (565) والطرف كالنقطة وعدمه في الزمان لا على التدريج. · Āmulī pp. 275–276

§566 The origination [الحدوث] of the world entails the origination of time.

(566) وحدوث العالم يستلزم حدوثه. · Āmulī pp. 276

Position

§567 Sixth: Position, a configuration occurring in a body [الجسم] in respect of two relations [النسبة] [among its parts, and between its parts and external things]. §568 It admits contrariety [التضاد], intensity, and weakness.

(567) السادس الوضع وهو هيئة تعرض للجسم باعتبار نسبتين. (568) وفيه تضاد وشدة وضعف. · Āmulī pp. 276–277

Possession

§569 Seventh: Possession [الملك], which is the relation [النسبة] of having.

(569) السابع الملك وهو نسبة التملك. · Āmulī pp. 277

Acting and being acted upon

§570 Eighth and Ninth: Acting and Being Acted Upon. §571 The truth is that these two have mental existence [الوجود الذهني]; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow.[88]

(570) الثامن والتاسع أن يفعل وأن ينفعل. (571) والحق ثبوتها ذهنا وإلا لزم التسلسل. · Āmulī pp. 278

[87] §564. Ḥillī offers two interpretations of the bearer: the substrate [المحل] of changing states, or time itself as one term of the temporal relation. The translation leaves the reference open.

[88] §571. Ḥillī explicitly takes the pronoun to refer to the last two categories, acting and being acted upon. Their mental status is not a denial that effects occur.

Division 3
Establishing the Maker, exalted is He, His attributes, and His effects

المقصد الثالث في إثبات الصانع تعالى وصفاته وآثاره

This division comprises chapters.

Chapter 1 · His existence, exalted is He

الفصل الأول في وجوده تعالى

§572 If an existent is necessary, [the desired conclusion follows]; otherwise, it entails [a necessary existent] [واجب الوجود], since circular dependence [الدور] and infinite regress [التسلسل] are impossible.

(572) الموجود إن كان واجبا وإلا استلزمه لاستحالة الدور والتسلسل. · Āmulī pp. 279–280

Chapter 2 · His attributes

الفصل الثاني في صفاته

§573 The existence [الوجود] of the world after its nonexistence [العدم] excludes necessitation [الإيجاب] [by its cause].[89] §574 An intermediary [between God and everything other than Him] is unintelligible. §575 Necessity [الوجوب] and possibility [الإمكان] can accrue to an effect under two [different] considerations. §576 And power [القدرة] [to produce an effect] in the future can coexist with [its present] nonexistence [العدم]. §577 The absence of an act is not the performance of its contrary.

(573) وجود العالم بعد عدمه ينفي الإيجاب. (574) والواسطة غير معقولة. (575) ويمكن عروض الوجوب والإمكان للأثر باعتبارين. (576) واجتماع القدرة على المستقبل مع العدم. (577) وانتفاء الفعل ليس فعل الضد. · Āmulī pp. 281–283

§578 The universality of the ground [of being subject to power] [القدرة] entails the universality of the attribute [of power].[90]

(578) وعمومية العلة تستلزم عمومية الصفة. · Āmulī pp. 283

Divine knowledge

§579 [The world's] perfected order, [His] immateriality [التجرد], and the dependence of everything upon Him are proofs of [His] knowledge [العلم]. §580 The last [proof] is universal [in its scope]. §581 The distinction [between knower and known in self-knowledge] [العلم] is one of consideration. §582 Knowledge [العلم] does not require forms distinct from the things known [to be present] with Him, because the relation of [those things'] presence to Him is stronger than the relation of intelligible forms [الصور المعقولة] to us. §583 Change in relations is possible [without change in His essence].

(579) والإحكام والتجرد واستناد كل شيء إليه دلائل العلم. (580) والأخير عام. (581) والتغاير اعتباري. (582) ولا يستدعي العلم صورا مغايرة للمعلومات عنده لأن نسبة الحصول إليه أشد من نسبة الصور المعقولة لنا. (583) وتغير الإضافات ممكن. · Āmulī pp. 284–286

[89] §573. The claim concerns a cause that produces its effect necessarily by its essence (mūjib), as opposed to a willing agent [الفاعل المختار]. It does not exclude the necessity of an effect once a willing agent's complete causal conditions obtain; the following clauses make this distinction.

[90] §578. Al-Ḥillī identifies the common ground as possibility [الإمكان]: everything possible falls within the scope of divine power [القدرة].

§584 Necessity [الوجوب] and possibility [الإمكان] can coexist under two [different] considerations.

(584) ويمكن اجتماع الوجوب والإمكان باعتبارين. · Āmulī pp. 287

Life

§585 Whatever possesses power [القدرة] and knowledge [العلم] is necessarily living.

(585) وكل قادر عالم حي بالضرورة. · Āmulī pp. 287

Will

§586 Singling out some possible things for existence [الوجود] at a [particular] time indicates His will [الإرادة], exalted is He. §587 It is not additional to the motive [الداعي] [for acting]; otherwise, an infinite regress [التسلسل] or a plurality of beginningless entities would follow.

(586) وتخصيص بعض الممكنات بالإيجاد في وقت يدل على إرادته تعالى. (587) وليست زائدة على الداعي وإلا لزم التسلسل أو تعدد القدماء. · Āmulī pp. 288

Perception

§588 Transmitted revelation [النقل] indicates that He possesses perception [الإدراك], and reason [العقل] [indicates] the impossibility of [His having perceptual] organs.

(588) والنقل دل على اتصافه بالإدراك والعقل على استحالة الآلات. · Āmulī pp. 289

Speech and truthfulness

§589 The universality of His power [القدرة] indicates that speech [الكلام] is established [for Him]; internal speech [الكلام النفسي] (kalām nafsī) [as a distinct attribute] is unintelligible. §590 The absence of badness [القبح] from Him, exalted is He, indicates His truthfulness [الصدق].

(589) وعمومية قدرته تدل على ثبوت الكلام والنفساني غير معقول. (590) وانتفاء القبح عنه تعالى يدل على صدقه. · Āmulī pp. 289–290

Eternity and attributes negated

§591 Necessity of existence [وجوب الوجود] indicates His eternity [السرمدية] and the negation of an additional [attribute of subsistence]. §592 And [it negates] a partner. §593 And a like. §594 And composition in its [various] senses. §595 And a contrary.

(591) ووجوب الوجود يدل على سرمديته ونفي الزائد. (592) والشريك (593) والمثل. (594) والتركيب بمعانيه. (595) والضد. · Āmulī pp. 290–292

§596 And spatial occupation [التحيز]. §597 And inherence [الحلول] [in another]. §598 And union [الاتحاد] [with another]. §599 And [location in a] direction. §600 And the inherence [الحلول] of temporally originated things in Him.

(596) والتحيز. (597) والحلول. (598) والاتحاد. (599) والجهة. (600) وحلول الحوادث فيه. · Āmulī pp. 293–294

§601 And need. §602 And pain absolutely, and pleasure arising from bodily temperament [المزاج]. §603 And entitative attributes [المعاني] (maʿānī), states [الأحوال] (aḥwāl), and attributes additional [to the essence] in concrete reality.

(601) والحاجة. (602) والألم مطلقا واللذة المزاجية. (603) والمعاني والأحوال والصفات الزائدة عينا. · Āmulī pp. 295–296

The vision of God

§604 And [His being an object of visual] seeing [الرؤية].
§605 Moses' request [to see God] was on behalf of his people.[91]
§606 Looking does not imply seeing [الرؤية]; moreover, [the relevant expression] admits of interpretation. §607 Making seeing [الرؤية] conditional upon the moving mountain's remaining still does not indicate [the] possibility [الإمكان] [of seeing God]. §608 A common feature among effects does not indicate a common feature among their causes; moreover, [the need for] causal explanation and the exhaustiveness [of the proposed alternatives] are denied.

(604) والرؤية. (605) وسؤال موسى لقومه.
(606) والنظر لا يدل على الرؤية مع قبوله التأويل.
(607) وتعليق الرؤية على استقرار الجبل المتحرك لا يدل على الإمكان. (608) واشتراك المعلولات لا يدل على اشتراك العلل مع منع التعليل والحصر.

Āmulī pp. 296–298 ·

Other divine attributes

§609 And [necessity of existence [وجوب الوجود] indicates] the establishment of generosity [الجود] [in Him]. §610 And sovereignty [الملك]. §611 And completeness [التمام], and being above completeness. §612 And being the Real [الحق] (al-ḥaqq). §613 And goodness [الخيرية] (khayriyya).[92]

§614 And wisdom [الحكمة]. §615 And compelling might [التجبر] (tajabbur).[93] §616 And overpowering dominion [القهر] (qahr).[94]

§617 And self-subsistence and the sustaining of others [القيومية] (qayyūmiyya). §618 As for hand, face, beginninglessness [القدم], mercy, munificence, good pleasure and bringing into being [التكوين], they refer back to what has preceded.[95]

(609) وعلى ثبوت الجود. (610) والملك.
(611) والتمام وفوقه. (612) والحقية.
(613) والخيرية.

Āmulī pp. 299–300 ·

(614) والحكمة. (615) والتجبر.
(616) والقهر.

Āmulī pp. 301 ·

(617) والقيومية. (618) وأما اليد والوجه والقدم والرحمة والكرم والرضا والتكوين فراجعة إلى ما تقدم.

Āmulī pp. 301 ·

[91] §605. This clause is present in the matn transmitted within al-Ḥillī's commentary used here; it is absent from the corresponding main text of al-Jalālī's edition, p. 194.

[92] §613. Al-Ḥillī explains this as pure existential goodness [الخيرية]: evil is the privation of a perfection due to a thing, whereas the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود] lacks no perfection. This is distinct from the classification of acts as ḥasan or qabīḥ below.

[93] §615. Al-Ḥillī explains this attribute through God's bringing what is potential into actuality and completion; the term here is not a moral attribution of tyranny.

[94] §616. Al-Ḥillī explains qahr here as overcoming nonexistence [العدم] through existence [الوجود] and actualisation, just as he explains tajabbur at §615 through completing what is potential.

[95] §618. The unvocalised القدم is read qidam, 'beginninglessness [القدم]', following al-Ḥillī's explanation of a proposed attribute distinct from subsistence (baqā'). It is not translated as qadam, 'foot'.

Chapter 3 · His acts

الفصل الثالث في أفعاله

§619 An act characterised by something additional [to its occurrence] is either good [الحسن] or bad [القبيح]; the good has four kinds.[96] §620 Both [goodness [الحسن] and badness] [القبح] are rationally knowable, because the goodness of beneficence [الإحسان] and the badness of injustice [الظلم] are known without revelation. §621 And because both would disappear altogether if they were established [only] through revelation. §622 And [otherwise] their reversal would be possible. §623 Differences in [the evidentness of] cognitions are possible because of differences in conceptualisation.

(619) الفعل المتصف بالزائد إما حسن أو قبيح والحسن أربعة. (620) وهما عقليان للعلم بحسن الإحسان وقبح الظلم من غير شرع. (621) ولانتفائهما مطلقا لو ثبتا شرعا. (622) ولجاز التعاكس. (623) ويجوز التفاوت في العلوم لتفاوت التصور. · Āmulī pp. 302–304

§624 And [the reply is] undertaking the less bad of two bad acts, together with the possibility [الإمكان] of a way out [of the dilemma].[97] §625 And compulsion [الجبر] [as an account of human action] is false.

(624) وارتكاب أقل القبيحين مع إمكان المخلص. (625) والجبر باطل. · Āmulī pp. 304–305

Divine action and badness

§626 His independence and His knowledge [العلم] indicate the absence of badness [القبح] from His acts, exalted is He. §627 Although He has power [القدرة] over it [the bad], because [His power's] relation is universal; consequent impossibility [الامتناع اللاحق] does not conflict [with this power].

(626) واستغناؤه وعلمه يدلان على انتفاء القبح عن أفعاله تعالى. (627) مع قدرته عليه لعموم النسبة ولا ينافي الامتناع اللاحق. · Āmulī pp. 305–306

Purpose

§628 Denying a purpose entails pointlessness; [the benefit of] the purpose need not return to Him.

(628) ونفي الغرض يستلزم العبث ولا يلزم عوده إليه. · Āmulī pp. 306

Will and human action

§629 Willing the bad is bad, as is failing to will the good; and [the same conclusion follows] from command and prohibition.[98] §630 Some acts depend upon us; [God's] being overcome does not follow, and knowledge [العلم] follows [the thing known].

(629) وإرادة القبيح قبيحة وكذا ترك إرادة الحسن وللأمر والنهي (630) وبعض الأفعال مستندة إلينا والمغلوبية غير لازمة والعلم تابع. · Āmulī pp. 307

[96] §619. Al-Ḥillī identifies the four as obligatory, recommended, permissible and disliked. 'Good [الحسن]' here means an act whose performance does not merit blame, so it includes the disliked.

[97] §624. This compressed reply concerns objections about lying to save a prophet and promising to lie. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes choosing the lesser wrong from the further possibility [الإمكان] of avoiding a lie by equivocation; the clause is not a general instruction to choose wrongdoing when an innocent alternative exists.

[98] §629. Al-Ḥillī explains 'the good' in this argument through acts of obedience (ṭā'āt) and what God commands. It should not be read as saying that every merely permissible act, or every act falling under the broad technical category ḥasan at §619, must be willed.

Human agency

§631 It is immediately certain that our acts depend upon us. §632 Necessity [الوجوب] due to a motive [الداعي] does not conflict with power [القدرة], as [is also the case] with the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود]. §633 Bringing into existence [الإيجاد] does not entail knowledge [العلم] unless accompanied by intention [القصد]; then general knowledge suffices. §634 When [the two powers] come together, what He wills, exalted is He, occurs. §635 Temporal origination [الحدوث] is a matter of consideration.

(631) والضرورة قاضية باستناد أفعالنا إلينا. (632) والوجوب للداعي لا ينافي القدرة كالواجب. (633) والإيجاد لا يستلزم العلم إلا مع اقتران القصد فيكفي الإجمال. (634) ومع الاجتماع يقع مراده تعالى. (635) والحدوث اعتباري. · Āmulī pp. 308–310

§636 The impossibility of [our producing] a body is due to something other than [temporal origination] [الحدوث].[99] §637 The inability to produce an exact likeness in some acts is due to the inability to comprehend [all their details]. §638 There is no comparison in goodness [الخيرية] between our act and His act, exalted is He. §639 Gratitude [to God] is for the prerequisites of faith [الإيمان]. §640 The transmitted evidence [السمع] [adduced against us] is interpreted and countered by its like; the grounds for preference favour us.

(636) وامتناع الجسم لغيره. (637) وتعذر المماثلة في بعض الأفعال لتعذر الإحاطة. (638) ولا نسبة في الخيرية بين فعلنا وفعله تعالى. (639) والشكر على مقدمات الإيمان. (640) والسمع متأول ومعارض بمثله والترجيح معنا. · Āmulī pp. 310–311

Generated acts

§641 The goodness [الحسن] of praise and blame for a generated act [الفعل المتولد] entails knowledge [العلم] that it is attributable to us.[100] §642 The necessity [الوجوب] [of the effect] through choosing its cause is consequent [necessity]. §643 In casting a child [into fire], blame concerns that [casting], not the burning.

(641) وحسن المدح والذم على المتولد يقتضي العلم بإضافته إلينا. (642) والوجوب باختيار السبب لاحق. (643) والذم في إلقاء الصبي عليه لا على الإحراق. · Āmulī pp. 313–315

Divine decree and determination

§644 If divine decree [القضاء] and determination [القدر] (qaḍā' and qadar) mean the creation of the [human] act, an impossibility follows; if they mean imposing obligation [الإلزام], [the assertion] is true only of what is obligatory; if they mean making known, it is true without restriction. The Commander of the Faithful, peace be upon him, explained this in the report of al-Aṣbagh.

(644) والقضاء والقدر إن أريد بهما خلق الفعل لزم المحال أو الإلزام صح في الواجب خاصة أو الإعلام صح مطلقا وقد بينه أمير المؤمنين عليه‌السلام في حديث الأصبغ. · Āmulī pp. 315

Guidance and misguidance

§645 Leading astray means pointing towards what is contrary to the truth, producing misguidance, or causing destruction. Guidance has the corresponding opposite senses. The first two [senses of leading astray] are denied of Him, exalted is He.

(645) والإضلال الإشارة إلى خلاف الحق وفعل الضلالة والإهلاك والهدى مقابل والأولان منفيان عنه تعالى. · Āmulī pp. 317

[99] §636. This clause is present in the matn transmitted within al-Ḥillī's commentary used here; it is absent from the corresponding main text of al-Jalālī's edition, p. 199.

[100] §641. A generated act [الفعل المتولد] (mutawallid) is an effect produced through another act, rather than an act performed immediately. The clause distinguishes evidence that we already know its attribution from a demonstration of the attribution itself.

Those not subject to moral obligation

§646 Punishing someone not subject to moral obligation [التكليف] is bad. Noah's words, peace be upon him, are figurative; [a child's] service is not a punishment [العقوبة] of him; and derivative status in some rulings is permissible.

(646) وتعذيب غير المكلف قبيح وكلام نوح عليه‌السلام مجاز والخدمة ليست عقوبة له والتبعية في بعض الأحكام جائزة. · Āmulī pp. 318

Moral obligation

§647 Imposing moral obligation [التكليف] (taklīf) is good because it contains a benefit that cannot be obtained without it. §648 It differs from wounding and then treating [the wound], and from exchanges; [explaining it as repayment in] gratitude is invalid. §649 And because the [human] species needs mutual assistance, which requires an established law whose practice benefits [spiritual] discipline, sustained reflection upon higher matters, and recollection of warnings that lead to the establishment of justice [العدل], together with increased recompense and reward [الثواب]. §650 And [imposing moral obligation] [التكليف] is obligatory because it restrains [people] from bad acts.

(647) والتكليف حسن لاشتماله على مصلحة لا تحصل بدونه. (648) بخلاف الجرح ثم التداوي ، والمعاوضات والشكر باطل. (649) ولأن النوع محتاج إلى التعاضد المستلزم للسنة النافع استعمالها في الرياضة وإدامة النظر في الأمور العالية ، وتذكر الإنذارات المستلزمة لإقامة العدل مع زيادة الأجر والثواب. (650) وواجب لزجره عن القبائح. · Āmulī pp. 319–321

§651 The conditions of its goodness [الحسن] are: the absence of a harmful consequence [of imposing the obligation]; its preceding [the act]; the possibility [الإمكان] of its object; the presence [in the act] of an attribute additional to its goodness; the imposer's knowledge [العلم] of the act's attributes and of the amount deserved [in reward] [الثواب], his power [القدرة] to [deliver] it, and the impossibility of badness [القبح] on his part; and the obligated person [المكلف]'s power to perform the act, his knowledge of it or ability [to acquire that knowledge], and the availability of the [required] instrument.[101] §652 Its object is either knowledge [العلم], rational or transmitted; probable judgment [الظن]; or action.

(651) وشرائط حسنه انتفاء المفسدة وتقدمه وإمكان متعلقه وثبوت صفة زائدة على حسنه وعلم المكلف بصفات الفعل وقدر المستحق وقدرته عليه وامتناع القبيح عليه وقدرة المكلف على الفعل وعلمه به أو إمكانه وإمكان الآلة. (652) ومتعلقه إما علم إما عقلي أو سمعي وإما ظن وإما عمل. · Āmulī pp. 322

§653 It comes to an end, [as shown] by consensus [الإجماع] and [the need] to deliver reward [الثواب]. §654 The ground of its goodness [الحسن] is universal [for believer and unbeliever]. §655 The unbeliever's harm comes from his own choice. §656 It is a harm, but not insofar as [it arises from] the imposition of obligation [التكليف], unlike what we stipulated [must be absent]. §657 And the benefit [of offering the opportunity for reward] [الثواب] is established.

(653) وهو منقطع للإجماع ولإيصال الثواب. (654) وعلة حسنه عامة. (655) وضرر الكافر من اختياره. (656) وهو مفسدة لا من حيث التكليف بخلاف ما شرطناه. (657) والفائدة ثابتة. · Āmulī pp. 323–324

[101] §651. The unvocalised المكلف occurs in two different roles: mukallif, the imposer of obligation, and mukallaf, the person obligated. The translation distinguishes them following al-Ḥillī. 'Additional to its goodness [الحسن]' means, for a positive act, that it is obligatory or recommended rather than merely permissible. Here mafsada includes an effect that impairs this person's or another person's discharge of moral obligations. The requirement does not exclude the ordinary hardship intrinsic to taklīf.

Gracious assistance

§658 Gracious assistance [اللطف] (luṭf) is obligatory because the purpose is attained through it.[102] §659 If it is His act, exalted is He, it is obligatory upon Him. If it is the obligated person [المكلف]'s act, He must make him aware of it and require him to perform it. If it is the act of someone other than those two, knowing that the act [of assistance] will occur is a condition of [imposing] the obligation. §660 The grounds of badness [القبح] are absent [from it]; the unbeliever is not without gracious assistance [اللطف]; and announcing [someone's future] felicity or wretchedness is not a corrupting influence.

(658) واللطف واجب لتحصيل الغرض به.
(659) فإن كان من فعله تعالى وجب عليه وإن كان من المكلف وجب أن يشعره به ويوجبه وإن كان من غيرهما شرط في التكليف العلم بالفعل.
(660) ووجوه القبح منتفية والكافر لا يخلو من لطف والإخبار بالسعادة والشقاوة ليس مفسدة. · Āmulī pp. 324–325

§661 For Him, exalted is He, to punish while withholding it [gracious assistance] [اللطف] would be bad; to blame while withholding it would not. §662 There must be a correspondence [between the assistance and the act assisted]; otherwise, there would be preference without a preferring ground in relation to the two related terms. §663 It does not reach the point of compulsion [الإلجاء]. §664 The obligated person [المكلف] must know the gracious assistance [اللطف], generally or in detail. §665 Gracious assistance [اللطف] has an aspect additional to [mere] goodness [الحسن].

(661) ويقبح منه تعالى التعذيب مع منعه دون الذم. (662) ولا بد من المناسبة وإلا ترجح بلا مرجح بالنسبة إلى المنتسبين. (663) ولا يبلغ الإلجاء. (664) ويعلم المكلف اللطف إجمالا أو تفصيلا. (665) ويزيد اللطف على جهة الحسن. · Āmulī pp. 327–328

§666 It admits of a choice [between alternatives]. §667 Provided that both alternatives are good.

(666) ويدخله التخيير. (667) بشرط حسن البدلين. · Āmulī pp. 328

Pain

§668 Some pain is bad and proceeds from us alone; some is good and proceeds from Him, exalted is He, and from us. Its goodness [الحسن] is either because it is deserved, because it includes a greater benefit or averts a greater harm, because it occurs according to the customary order [of causes], or because it is inflicted in defence.[103] §669 In [pain] that contains benefit, gracious assistance [اللطف] is also necessary. §670 Where [pain] is deserved, it may be punishment [العقاب]. §671 Gracious assistance [اللطف] alone does not suffice for the goodness [الحسن] of pain inflicted upon an obligated person [المكلف]. §672 Nor is [pain] good when pleasure would provide its [same] gracious assistance [اللطف].

(668) وبعض الألم قبيح يصدر منا خاصة وبعضه حسن يصدر منه تعالى ومنا وحسنه إما لاستحقاقه أو لاشتماله على النفع أو دفع الضرر الزائدين أو لكونه عاديا أو على وجه الدفع.
(669) ولا بد في المشتمل على النفع من اللطف.
(670) ويجوز في المستحق كونه عقابا. (671) ولا يكفي اللطف في ألم المكلف في الحسن.
(672) ولا يحسن مع اشتمال اللذة على لطفيته. · Āmulī pp. 329–331

§673 The actual choice of the person suffering is not a condition of [the pain's] goodness [الحسن].

(673) ولا يشترط في الحسن اختيار المتألم بالفعل. · Āmulī pp. 332

[102] §658. Here luṭf is assistance that brings an obligated person [المكلف] nearer to obedience and further from disobedience, without supplying the basic capacity to act or reaching the point of compulsion [الإلجاء]. Al-Ḥillī also distinguishes assistance that in fact secures a freely chosen act of obedience.

[103] §668. 'According to the customary order' refers in al-Ḥillī's example to the regular occurrence of burning upon being cast into fire. It is not merely a statistical claim that common suffering is thereby good.

Compensation

§674 Compensation [العوض] (ʿiwaḍ) is a deserved benefit devoid of honour and exaltation. §675 It is owed by Him, exalted is He, through inflicting pains, depriving [someone] of benefits for another's advantage, and inflicting grief, whether it arises from immediate knowledge [العلم الضروري], acquired knowledge [العلم المكتسب] or probable judgment [الظن], but not when it arises from the servant's own act; and through His commanding His servants to cause harm or permitting it, and enabling nonrational [creatures to cause harm]. §676 This differs from burning upon [someone's] being cast into fire, and killing on the basis of false testimony.[104] §677 Securing redress [الانتصاف] is obligatory upon Him, exalted is He, by reason [العقل] and transmitted revelation [السمع].

§678 It is therefore impermissible to enable a wrongdoer to inflict wrong without [his already possessing an entitlement to] compensation [العوض] commensurate with his wrongdoing.[105] §679 If the wronged person belongs among the people of Paradise, God, exalted is He, distributes his compensation [العوض] over different times, or graciously grants him its like. If he belongs among those punished, He deducts through it a portion of his punishment [العقاب], so that the alleviation is not apparent to him, by distributing the deducted amount over different times.

§680 Its permanence is not obligatory: an excess [of benefit] for which the pain would be chosen is good even if it comes to an end. Nor must it occur in this world, since delaying it may serve a benefit. [The claim that] its cessation causes pain is denied; moreover, that lies outside the point at issue. §681 It is not obligatory to make its recipient aware that it is being delivered as compensation [العوض]. §682 Its benefits are not confined to any particular [kind]. §683 It cannot validly be waived.[106]

§684 Compensation [العوض] owed by Him, exalted is He, must exceed [the pain] to the point that every rational person would be content [to accept the pain for it]; compensation owed by us must be equal [to the injury].

(674) والعوض نفع مستحق خال عن تعظيم وإجلال. (675) ويستحق عليه تعالى بإنزال الآلام وتفويت المنافع لمصلحة الغير وإنزال الغموم سواء استندت إلى علم ضروري أو مكتسب أو ظن لا ما تستند إلى فعل العبد وأمر عباده بالمضار أو إباحته وتمكين غير العاقل. (676) بخلاف الإحراق عند الإلقاء في النار والقتل عند شهادة الزور. (677) والانتصاف عليه تعالى واجب عقلا وسمعا. · Āmulī pp. 332, 334–335

(678) فلا يجوز تمكين الظالم من الظلم من دون عوض في الحال يوازي ظلمه. (679) فإن كان المظلوم من أهل الجنة فرق الله تعالى أعواضه على الأوقات أو تفضل عليه بمثلها وإن كان من أهل العقاب أسقط بها جزءا من عقابه بحيث لا يظهر له التخفيف بأن يفرق الناقص على الأوقات. · Āmulī pp. 335–336

(680) ولا يجب دوامه لحسن الزائد بما يختار معه الألم وإن كان منقطعا ولا يجب حصوله في الدنيا لاحتمال مصلحة التأخير والألم علي القطع ممنوع مع أنه غير محل النزاع. (681) ولا يجب إشعار صاحبه بإيصاله عوضا. (682) ولا يتعين منافعه. (683) ولا يصح إسقاطه. · Āmulī pp. 336–338

(684) والعوض عليه تعالى يجب تزايده إلى حد الرضا عند كل عاقل وعلينا يجب مساواته. · Āmulī pp. 339

[104] §676. Al-Ḥillī explains that compensation [العوض] in these examples is owed by the person who casts the victim into the fire, or by the false witnesses, rather than by God.

[105] §678. The wrongdoer's compensatory entitlement, accrued through suffering, supplies what may be transferred to the injured party in divine redress. 'At that time' is rendered by 'already'; the proposition is not that every earthly wrong has already been visibly compensated.

[106] §683. This clause is present in the matn transmitted within al-Ḥillī's commentary but absent from the corresponding main text of al-Jalālī's edition, p.207, which passes directly from the indeterminacy of the compensatory benefits to the amount of compensation [العوض]. Al-Ḥillī disagrees with the no-waiver statement in his commentary and argues for transfer or waiver of the compensatory right.

Appointed terms

§685 A living creature's appointed term [الأجل] is the time when its life ends, as known to God Most High. §686 For someone killed, both [continued life and death] would have been possible had the killing not occurred. §687 The appointed term [الأجل] may be gracious assistance [اللطف] for another, but not for the obligated person [المكلف] [whose term it is].

(685) وأجل الحيوان الوقت الذي علم الله تعالى بطلان حياته فيه. (686) والمقتول يجوز فيه الأمران لولاه. (687) ويجوز أن يكون الأجل لطفا للغير لا للمكلف. · Āmulī pp. 339–340

Provision

§688 Provision [الرزق] is that from which benefit may legitimately be taken and from which no one is entitled to exclude [the recipient]. §689 Striving to obtain it may be obligatory, recommended, permissible or forbidden.

(688) والرزق ما صح الانتفاع به ولم يكن لأحد منعه منه. (689) والسعي في تحصيله قد يجب ويستحب ويباح ويحرم. · Āmulī pp. 341

Prices

§690 Price is the assessment of the countervalue for which something is sold. It is low or high; customary practice and sameness of time and place must be considered. It depends upon Him, exalted is He, and also upon us.

(690) والسعر تقدير العوض الذي يباع به الشيء وهو رخص وغلاء ولا بد من اعتبار العادة واتحاد الوقت والمكان ويستند إليه تعالى وإلينا أيضا. · Āmulī pp. 342

What is most beneficial

§691 What is most beneficial [الأصلح] is obligatory in some circumstances, owing to the presence of the motive [الداعي] and the absence of a dissuading factor.[107]

(691) والأصلح قد يجب لوجود الداعي وانتفاء الصارف. · Āmulī pp. 343

[107] §691. Al-Ḥillī identifies this qualified position with Abū al-Ḥusayn al-Baṣrī and states that Ṭūsī adopts it; the claim is neither unrestricted obligation nor merely uncertainty about whether an obligation exists.

Division 4
Prophecy

المقصد الرابع في النبوة

The benefits of prophetic mission

§692 The sending of prophets [البعثة] is good because it comprises benefits: reinforcing reason [العقل] in what reason indicates; learning the judgement concerning what reason does not indicate; removing fear; learning what is good and bad, beneficial and harmful; preserving the human species and perfecting its individuals according to their differing dispositions; teaching them recondite crafts, moral character, and the governance of human affairs; and informing them of punishment [العقاب] and reward [الثواب]. Thus gracious assistance [اللطف] (luṭf) is provided to the morally responsible person [المكلف]. §693 The Brahmins' objection is invalidated by what has preceded.

(692) البعثة حسنة لاشتمالها على فوائد كمعاضدة العقل فيما يدل عليه واستفادة الحكم فيما لا يدل وإزالة الخوف واستفادة الحسن والقبح والنافع والضار وحفظ النوع الإنساني وتكميل أشخاصه بحسب استعداداتهم المختلفة وتعليمهم الصنائع الخفية والأخلاق والسياسات والإخبار بالعقاب والثواب فيحصل اللطف للمكلف. (693) وشبهة البراهمة باطلة بما تقدم. · Āmulī pp. 344–346, 348

The obligation of prophetic mission

§694 It is obligatory because it comprises gracious assistance [اللطف] in fulfilling the obligations known by reason.

(694) وهي واجبة لاشتمالها على اللطف في التكاليف العقلية. · Āmulī pp. 348

The qualities required of prophets

§695 A prophet must be protected from error and sin [العصمة] ('iṣma), so that confidence [in him] may be secured and the purpose [of his mission] thereby achieved; also because [without such protection] following him and its contrary would both be obligatory, and it would be obligatory to censure him.[108]

(695) ويجب في النبي العصمة ليحصل الوثوق فيحصل الغرض ولوجوب متابعته وضدها والإنكار عليه. · Āmulī pp. 349

§696 [He must also possess] perfection of intellect [العقل], intelligence, discernment, and sound judgement; and freedom from inadvertence and from everything that would repel people from him: baseness of fathers, unchastity of mothers, harshness, coarseness, the condition of desiring receptive anal intercourse (ubna) and similar conditions, eating in the road, and similar conduct.[109]

(696) وكمال العقل والذكاء والفطنة وقوة الرأي وعدم السهو وكلما ينفر عنه من دناءة الآباء وعهر الأمهات والفظاظة والغلظة والأبنة وشبهها والأكل على الطريق وشبهه. · Āmulī pp. 349

Miracles and prophetic truthfulness

§697 The way to know his truthfulness [الصدق] is the

(697) وطريق معرفة صدقه ظهور المعجز على يده

[108] §695. The final two reasons are compressed counterfactual arguments: if the prophet sinned, obedience to him and refusal to follow the sin would conflict, and the duty to censure wrongdoing would require censuring him. See al-Ḥillī on this lemma.

[109] §696. Ubna is a historical medical and sexual category, not a modern clinical diagnosis. Al-Ḥillī lists it among conditions regarded as repellent; al-Tahānawī, Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al-funūn, s.v. al-ubna (1996 ed., I, p.90), explains its sexual sense. The translation retains the source's historical judgement. Primary dictionary text: https://islamport.com/l/mjm/5287/134.htm .

manifestation of a miracle [المعجزة] at his hand: the occurrence of something uncustomary, or the nonoccurrence of something customary, with a breach of customary order [خرق العادة] and correspondence to the claim.

وهو ثبوت ما ليس بمعتاد أو نفي ما هو معتاد مع خرق العادة ومطابقة الدعوى. · Āmulī pp. 350

Extraordinary signs outside prophetic claims

§698 The story of Mary and other such stories establish the possibility [الإمكان] of its manifestation at the hands of the righteous. §699 This does not entail its ceasing to be miraculous, repelling people [from prophets], failure to distinguish [the prophet], invalidation of its evidentiary force, or its universal occurrence [for every truthful person]. §700 His miracles [المعجزة]—peace be upon him—before prophethood [النبوة] establish [the possibility [الإمكان] of] preparatory signs [الإرهاص] (irhāṣ). §701 The story of Musaylima and that of Abraham's Pharaoh establish the possibility [الإمكان] of manifesting a miracle [المعجزة] contrary [to a claimant's claim].[110]

(698) وقصة مريم وغيرها تعطي جواز ظهوره على الصالحين. (699) ولا يلزم خروجه عن الإعجاز ولا التنفير ولا عدم التميز ولا إبطال دلالته ولا العمومية. (700) ومعجزاته عليه‌السلام قبل النبوة تعطي الإرهاص. (701) وقصة مسيلمة وفرعون إبراهيم تعطي جواز إظهار المعجزة على العكس. · Āmulī pp. 351–353

The continuing need for prophetic guidance

§702 The proof of the obligation [to send prophets] establishes its universality [throughout time].[111] §703 A revealed law [الشريعة] is not required [for every prophetic mission].[112]

(702) ودليل الوجوب يعطي العمومية. (703) ولا تجب الشريعة. · Āmulī pp. 353–354

The prophethood of Muḥammad

§704 The manifestation of the miracle [المعجزة] of the Qur'ān and of other miracles, conjoined with the claim of our Prophet Muḥammad—God bless him and his family—indicates his prophethood [النبوة]. The challenge, together with failure [to meet it] despite the abundance of motives [الداعي] [to do so], indicates miraculous inimitability [الإعجاز]. The miracles transmitted with recurrent agreement in their common import [التواتر المعنوي] (tawātur maʿnawī) reinforce it. §705 The Qur'ān's miraculous inimitability [الإعجاز] is said to derive from its eloquence; or from its manner of composition together with its eloquence; or from divine prevention [الصرفة] (ṣarfa). All are possible.[113]

(704) وظهور معجزة القرآن وغيره مع اقتران دعوة نبينا محمد صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله يدل على نبوته. والتحدي مع الامتناع وتوفر الدواعي يدل على الإعجاز. والمنقول معناه متواترا من المعجزات يعضده. (705) وإعجاز القرآن قيل لفصاحته وقيل لأسلوبه وفصاحته وقيل للصرفة والكل محتمل. · Āmulī pp. 354, 357

[110] §701. 'Abraham's Pharaoh' is the matn's expression; al-Ḥillī identifies the ruler as Nimrod. The point is an extraordinary event that exposes a false claimant by producing the opposite of what he announces.

[111] §702. Al-Ḥillī explains this as the requirement that no period be without a prophet's revealed dispensation; it does not state that a new prophet must appear at every moment.

[112] §703. Al-Ḥillī contrasts Abū 'Alī's allowance of a prophet sent to confirm what reason knows with Abū Hāshim's requirement that a prophet bring a revealed law [الشريعة]. The issue is whether such a law is required for every prophetic mission.

[113] §705. Ṣarfa [الصرفة] means God's preventing would-be challengers from producing a counterpart, as distinct from locating the incapacity wholly in the composition itself. The matn does not choose between the three accounts here.

Abrogation and changing benefits

§706 Abrogation [النسخ] follows considerations of benefit. §707 It has occurred: some things permitted to Noah's predecessors were forbidden to him; circumcision was made obligatory after its postponement [had been allowed]; marriage to two sisters together was prohibited; and other rulings [were likewise changed]. §708 Their report from Moses—peace be upon him—prescribing perpetuity is fabricated; even if it were granted, it would not establish the intended meaning conclusively.[114]

(706) والنسخ تابع للمصالح. (707) وقد وقع حيث حرم على نوح بعض ما أحل لمن تقدمه وأوجب الختان بعد تأخيره وحرم الجمع بين الأختين وغير ذلك من الأحكام. (708) وخبرهم عن موسى عليه‌السلام بالتأبيد مختلق ومع تسليمه لا يدل على المراد قطعا. · Āmulī pp. 357–358

The universality and rank of the prophets

§709 Transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates the universality of his prophethood [النبوة]—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. §710 He is superior to the angels, as are the other prophets—peace be upon them—because [within them] there is something opposed to the rational faculty, and they compel it to obey that faculty.

(709) والسمع دل على عموم نبوته صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله‌وسلم. (710) وهو أفضل من الملائكة وكذا غيره من الأنبياء عليه‌السلام لوجود المضاد للقوة العقلية وقهره على الانقياد عليها. · Āmulī pp. 359–360

[114] §708. The antecedent is the report invoked by opponents of abrogating Moses' law. The statement about fabrication is Ṭūsī's judgement.

Division 5
The imamate

المقصد الخامس في الإمامة

The obligation to appoint an imam

§711 The imam is gracious assistance [اللطف] (luṭf); therefore God Most High is obliged to appoint him, so that the purpose [of moral obligation] [التكليف] may be achieved. §712 The absence of harmful consequences is known, and rational persons know that this gracious assistance [اللطف] is confined to him. His existence [الوجود] is gracious assistance, and his exercise of authority is another; its absence is due to us.[115]

(711) الإمام لطف فيجب نصبه على الله تعالى تحصيلا للغرض. (712) والمفاسد معلومة الانتفاء وانحصار اللطف فيه معلوم للعقلاء ووجوده لطف وتصرفه آخر وعدمه منا. · Āmulī pp. 360–362

Protection from error and sin

§713 The impossibility of an infinite regress [التسلسل] requires his protection from error and sin [العصمة]. [This is also required] because he preserves the revealed law [الشريعة]; because, if he committed a sin, censuring him would be obligatory, contradicting the command to obey him and defeating the purpose of his appointment; and because [otherwise] his rank would fall below that of the least of the common people. §714 Protection from error and sin [العصمة] does not conflict with power [القدرة] [to commit sin].

(713) وامتناع التسلسل يوجب عصمته ولأنه حافظ للشرع ولوجوب الإنكار عليه لو أقدم على المعصية فيضاد أمر الطاعة ويفوت الغرض من نصبه ولانحطاط درجته عن أقل العوام.
(714) ولا تنافي العصمة القدرة. · Āmulī pp. 364–365

Superiority and explicit designation

§715 The badness [القبح] of giving precedence to the inferior is known; and, where [candidates] are equal, there is no ground of preference. §716 Protection from error and sin [العصمة] requires explicit designation [النص], as does the conduct of [the Prophet]—peace be upon him.

(715) وقبح تقديم المفضول معلوم ولا ترجيح في المساوي (716) والعصمة تقتضي النص وسيرته عليه‌السلام. · Āmulī pp. 366

Arguments for the imamate of ʿAlī

§717 Both [protection from error and sin [العصمة] and explicit designation] [النص] belong uniquely to ʿAlī—peace be upon him. §718 [There is] the unambiguous designation [النص الجلي] in his sayings, 'Greet him as Commander of the Faithful', 'You are the successor after me', and others. §719 Also His—Most High—saying, 'Your guardian is only God and His Messenger', to the end of the verse; the attributes [mentioned there] are found together only in ʿAlī—peace be upon him.[116] §720 Also the recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] report of Ghadīr. §721 Also the recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] report of the Station [of Aaron].[117]

(717) وهما مختصان بعلي عليه‌السلام.
(718) والنص الجلي في قوله سلموا عليه بإمرة المؤمنين وأنت الخليفة من بعدي وغيرهما.
(719) ولقوله تعالى (إِنَّما وَلِيُّكُمُ اللهُ وَرَسُولُهُ) الآية وإنما اجتمعت الأوصاف في علي عليه‌السلام.
(720) ولحديث الغدير المتواتر. (721) ولحديث المنزلة المتواتر. · Āmulī pp. 367–369

[115] §712. 'Its absence' is interpreted through al-Ḥillī as the absence of the imam's effective exercise of authority: the subjects fail to support and obey him. It does not mean that the imam does not exist.

§722 Also his appointing him as deputy over Medina, which extends generally by consensus [الإجماع]. §723 Also his saying—peace be upon him—"You are my brother, my legatee, my successor after me, and the adjudicator of [matters of] my religion"—with a kasra on the dāl [of dīnī].[118] §724 Also because he is superior, and the imamate [الإمامة] of an inferior person is rationally bad. §725 Also because miracles [المعجزة] appeared at his hand: uprooting the gate of Khaybar, conversing with the serpent, lifting the immense rock from the well, fighting the jinn, bringing back the sun, and others. He claimed the imamate [الإمامة]; therefore he was truthful.

(722) ولاستخلافه على المدينة فيعم للإجماع.
(723) ولقوله عليه‌السلام أنت أخي ووصيي وخليفتي من بعدي وقاضي ديني بكسر الدال.
(724) ولأنه أفضل وإمامة المفضول قبيحة عقلا.
(725) ولظهور المعجزة على يده كقلع باب خيبر ومخاطبة الثعبان ورفع الصخرة العظيمة عن القليب ومحاربة الجن ورد الشمس وغير ذلك وادعى الإمامة فيكون صادقا. · Āmulī pp. 369–370

§726 Also because the others' prior unbelief [الكفر] disqualifies them for the imamate [الإمامة], leaving him—peace be upon him—as the one determined [for it]. §727 Also His—Most High—saying, 'Be with the truthful.'[119] §728 Also His—Most High—saying, 'And those vested with authority among you.'[120]

(726) ولسبق كفر غيره فلا يصلح للإمامة فتعين هو عليه‌السلام. (727) ولقوله تعالى (وَكُونُوا مَعَ الصَّادِقِينَ). (728) ولقوله تعالى (وَأُولِي الْأَمْرِ مِنْكُمْ). · Āmulī pp. 371

Arguments against the competing claimants

§729 For the group apart from ʿAlī—peace be upon him—are unfit for the imamate [الإمامة], on account of their wrongdoing through their prior unbelief [الكفر].

(729) ولأن الجماعة غير علي عليه‌السلام غير صالح للإمامة لظلمهم بتقدم كفرهم. · Āmulī pp. 372

Objections concerning Abū Bakr

§730 Abū Bakr contradicted the Book of God Most High by preventing inheritance from God's Messenger—God bless him and his family—on the basis of a report that he himself related. §731 He withheld Fadak from Fāṭima—peace be upon her—despite her claim that it had been given to her as a gift and the testimony of ʿAlī—peace be upon him—and Umm Ayman; yet he accepted the wives' claims that their rooms belonged to them. For this reason ʿUmar ibn ʿAbd al-ʿAzīz restored it. §732 She instructed that Abū Bakr should not perform the funeral prayer over her; she was therefore buried at night.

(730) وخالف أبو بكر كتاب الله تعالى في منع إرث رسول الله صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله بخبر رواه هو.
(731) ومنع فاطمة عليها‌السلام فدكا مع ادعاء النحلة لها وشهد علي عليه‌السلام وأم أيمن وصدق الأزواج في ادعاء الحجرة لهن ولهذا ردها عمر بن عبد العزيز. (732) وأوصت أن لا يصلي عليها أبو بكر فدفنت ليلا. · Āmulī pp. 372–373

[116] §719. Qurʾān 5:55. Ṭūsī's argument depends on identifying the person described in the remainder of the verse with ʿAlī; the matn gives only this opening fragment.

[117] §721. The 'Station' report is the saying comparing ʿAlī's relation to Muḥammad with Aaron's relation to Moses, except for prophethood [النبوة] after Muḥammad; the source cites its title rather than quoting it.

[118] §723. The text deliberately reads dīnī ('my religion'), not daynī ('my debt'). Al-Ḥillī treats the phrase as explicit authority and succession.

[119] §727. Qurʾān 9:119.

[120] §728. Qurʾān 4:59.

§733 Also because of his saying, 'Release me [from office], for I am not the best of you while 'Alī is among you.' §734 Also because of his saying that a devil sometimes overtakes him. §735 Also because of 'Umar's saying, 'The pledge to Abū Bakr was an unpremeditated occurrence whose evil God averted; whoever returns to anything like it, kill him.' §736 At his death he doubted his entitlement to the imamate [الإمامة]. §737 He contradicted the Messenger—God bless him and his family—by appointing a successor, according to their own account, and by appointing someone whom he—God bless him and his family—had dismissed.[121]

(733) ولقوله أقيلوني فلست بخيركم وعلي فيكم. (734) ولقوله إن له شيطانا يعتريه (735) ولقول عمر كانت بيعة أبي بكر فلتة وقى الله شرها فمن عاد إلى مثلها فاقتلوه. (736) وشك عند موته في استحقاقه للإمامة (737) وخالف الرسول صلى الله عليه وآله في الاستخلاف عندهم وفي تولية من عزله صلى الله عليه وآله. · Āmulī pp. 373–374

§738 [He also contradicted him] by staying behind from Usāma's army, although they knew the intention was to send them away. [The Prophet] appointed Usāma over them, so Usāma is superior [to them]; whereas no one was appointed over 'Alī—peace be upon him—and he is superior to Usāma. §739 He held no office during his [the Prophet's] lifetime. [The Prophet] gave him Sūrat Barā'a, but Gabriel descended and instructed [the Prophet] to recall him and take the sūra from him, and that no one should recite it except himself or someone of his household. He therefore sent 'Alī—peace be upon him—with it.

(738) وفي التخلف عن جيش أسامة مع علمهم بقصد البعد وولى أسامة عليهم فهو أفضل وعلي عليه السلام لم يول عليه أحدا وهو أفضل من أسامة. (739) ولم يتول عملا في زمانه وأعطاه سورة براءة فنزل جبرئيل فأمره برده وأخذ السورة منه وأن لا يقرأها إلا هو أو أحد من أهل بيته فبعث بها عليا عليه السلام. · Āmulī pp. 375

§740 He did not know the legal rulings: he cut off a thief's left hand and burned [a man] with fire; he did not know [the ruling on] collateral inheritance (kalāla) or the grandmother's inheritance; his rulings were inconsistent; and he neither imposed the prescribed penalty on Khālid nor exacted retaliation from him.[122]

(740) ولم يكن عارفا بالأحكام حتى قطع يسار سارق وأحرق بالنار ولم يعرف الكلالة ولا ميراث الجدة واضطرب في أحكامه ولم يحد خالدا ولا اقتص منه. · Āmulī pp. 376

§741 He was buried in the house of God's Messenger—God bless him and his family—although God Most High had prohibited entering it without permission during his lifetime. He sent [men] to the house of the Commander of the Faithful—peace be upon him—when he refused the pledge, and had it set on fire while Fāṭima, al-Ḥasan, al-Ḥusayn, and a group of the Banū Hāshim were inside. Al-Ḥasan and al-Ḥusayn objected to him when allegiance was pledged to him; and he regretted violating the house of Fāṭima—peace be upon her.

(741) ودفن في بيت رسول الله صلى الله عليه وآله وقد نهى الله تعالى دخوله في حياته بغير إذن وبعث إلى بيت أمير المؤمنين عليه السلام لما امتنع من البيعة فأضرم فيه النار وفيه فاطمة والحسن والحسين وجماعة من بني هاشم ورد عليه الحسنان لما بويع وندم على كشف بيت فاطمة عليها السلام. · Āmulī pp. 376

[121] §737. 'According to their own account' refers to the opponents' claim that the Prophet had appointed no successor. It is an argument from their premises, not Ṭūsī's own acceptance of that claim.

[122] §740. Al-Ḥillī identifies the person burned as al-Fujā'a al-Sulamī. The matn does not name him.

Objections concerning ʿUmar

§742 ʿUmar ordered the stoning of a pregnant woman and of another woman who was insane. ʿAlī—peace be upon him—prevented him, and he said, 'Were it not for ʿAlī, ʿUmar would have perished.' §743 He doubted the Prophet's death—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—until Abū Bakr recited to him, 'You shall die, and they shall die.' He then said, 'It is as though I had never heard this verse.'[123] §744 He said, 'Everyone understands the law better than ʿUmar, even secluded women', when he prohibited excessive marriage payments.

§745 He gave [public funds] to the Prophet's wives—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—borrowed [from those funds], and withheld from the People of the House—peace be upon them—their fifth. §746 He issued a hundred rulings concerning [inheritance by] the grandfather, favoured some over others in distributions, and prohibited the two mutʿas.[124] §747 He decided the arrangements for the consultative council contrary to what was correct. §748 He tore up Fāṭima's document—peace be upon her.

(742) وأمر عمر برجم امرأة حامل وأخرى مجنونة فنهاه علي عليه‌السلام فقال لو لا علي لهلك عمر. (743) وتشكك في موت النبي صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله‌وسلم حتى تلا عليه أبو بكر : إنك ميت وإنهم ميتون فقال كأني لم أسمع هذه الآية. (744) وقال كل أفقه من عمر حتى المخدرات لما منع من المغالاة في الصداق. · Āmulī pp. 377–378

(745) وأعطى أزواج النبي صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله‌وسلم واقترض ومنع أهل البيت عليهم‌السلام من خمسهم. (746) وقضى في الجد مائة قضية وفضل في القسمة ومنع المتعتين : (747) وحكم في الشورى بضد الصواب. (748) وخرق كتاب فاطمة عليها‌السلام. · Āmulī pp. 378–379

Objections concerning ʿUthmān

§749 ʿUthmān appointed men whose transgression [الفسق] was evident, so that they introduced into Muslim affairs the innovations they introduced. §750 He preferred his relatives in the allocation of wealth. §751 He reserved grazing land for himself. §752 He committed reprehensible acts against the Companions: he beat Ibn Masʿūd until he died and burned his copy of the Qur'ān; he beat ʿAmmār until he suffered a hernia; and he beat Abū Dharr and exiled him to al-Rabadha. §753 He waived retaliation against Ibn ʿUmar and the prescribed penalty against al-Walīd, although both were obligatory.

§754 The Companions abandoned him until he was killed. The Commander of the Faithful—peace be upon him—said, 'God killed him.' He was not buried until three days later, and they censured his absence from Badr, Uḥud, and the pledge [of al-Riḍwān].

(749) وولى عثمان من ظهر فسقه حتى أحدثوا في أمر المسلمين ما أحدثوا. (750) وآثر أهله بالأموال. (751) وحمى لنفسه. (752) ووقع منه أشياء منكرة في حق الصحابة فضرب ابن مسعود حتى مات وأحرق مصحفه وضرب عمارا حتى أصابه فتق وضرب أبا ذر ونفاه إلى الربذة. (753) وأسقط القود عن ابن عمر والحد عن الوليد مع وجوبهما. · Āmulī pp. 379–380

(754) وخذله الصحابة حتى قتل وقال أمير المؤمنين عليه‌السلام : الله قتله. ولم يدفن إلا بعد ثلاثة أيام وعابوا غيبته عن بدر وأحد والبيعة. · Āmulī pp. 381

The superiority of ʿAlī

§755 ʿAlī—peace be upon him—is superior because of his extensive striving in battle and his outstanding service in all the campaigns of the Prophet—God bless him and his family

(755) وعلي عليه‌السلام أفضل لكثرة جهاده وعظم بلائه في وقائع النبي صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله‌وسلم

[123] §743. Qur'ān 39:30.

[124] §746. Al-Ḥillī identifies the two as temporary marriage and tamattuʿ in pilgrimage, the performance of ʿumra followed by ḥajj in the same pilgrimage season.

and grant them peace. No one attained his rank at Badr, Uḥud, the Day of the Confederates, Khaybar, Ḥunayn, and the other campaigns.

§756 Also because he is the most knowledgeable, owing to the strength [القوة] of his immediate insight and his close, constant attendance on the Messenger—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. The Companions referred to him in most cases after making mistakes. The Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—said, 'The best judge among you is 'Alī.' The eminent masters of all the sciences traced their learning back to him, and he—peace be upon him—himself declared this. §757 Also His—Most High—saying, 'And ourselves.'[125] §758 Also because his generosity exceeded that of others.

§759 He was the most ascetic of people after the Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. §760 And the most devoted in worship. §761 And the most forbearing. §762 And the noblest in character. §763 And the earliest in faith [الإيمان].

§764 And the most eloquent. §765 And the soundest in judgement. §766 And the most zealous to uphold the limits prescribed by God Most High. §767 And the most accomplished in memorising the Mighty Book. §768 Also because of his reports of the unseen.

§769 And the answering of his supplication. §770 And the miracles [المعجزة] manifested through him. §771 And his distinctive kinship [with the Prophet]. §772 And brotherhood [with him]. §773 And the obligation to love [him].

§774 And his support [of the Messenger]. §775 And his equality with the prophets.[126] §776 And the reports of the Bird, the Station [of Aaron], Ghadīr, and others. §777 Also because no unbelief [الكفر] preceded [his faith] [الإيمان]. §778 Also because of the abundance of benefit derived from him.

§779 And his distinction in perfections of soul [النفس], body, and external circumstances.

بأجمعها ولم يبلغ أحد درجته في غزاة بدر وأحد ويوم الأحزاب وخيبر وحنين وغيرها. · Āmulī pp. 381

(756) ولأنه أعلم لقوة حدسه وشدة ملازمته للرسول صلى الله عليه وآله وسلم ورجعت الصحابة إليه في أكثر الوقائع بعد غلطهم وقال النبي صلى الله عليه وآله وسلم أقضاكم علي واستند الفضلاء في جميع العلوم إليه وأخبر هو عليه السلام بذلك. (757) ولقوله تعالى (وَأَنْفُسَنا). (758) ولكثرة سخائه على غيره. · Āmulī pp. 383, 385

(759) وكان أزهد الناس بعد النبي صلى الله عليه وآله وسلم. (760) وأعبدهم. (761) وأحلمهم. (762) وأشرفهم خلقا. (763) وأقدمهم إيمانا. · Āmulī pp. 386–388

(764) وأفصحهم. (765) وأسدهم رأيا. (766) وأكثرهم حرصا على إقامة حدود الله تعالى. (767) وأحفظهم للكتاب العزيز. (768) ولإخباره بالغيب. · Āmulī pp. 389–390

(769) واستجابة دعائه. (770) وظهور المعجزات عنه. (771) واختصاصه بالقرابة. (772) والأخوة. (773) ووجوب المحبة. · Āmulī pp. 391–392

(774) والنصرة. (775) ومساواة الأنبياء. (776) وخبر الطائر والمنزلة والغدير وغيرها. (777) ولانتفاء سبق كفره. (778) ولكثرة الانتفاع به. · Āmulī pp. 392–393, 395

(779) وتميزه بالكمالات النفسانية والبدنية والخارجية. · Āmulī pp. 395

[125] §757. Qur'ān 3:61; the argument identifies 'Alī with the person included under 'ourselves' in the mutual-imprecation verse.

[126] §775. Al-Ḥillī interprets this through a report comparing particular virtues of 'Alī with those of Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses, and Jesus, rather than asserting that he possesses prophethood [النبوة].

The eleven subsequent imams

§780 Recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] reports indicate [the imamate [الإمامة] of] the eleven; also [it follows] from the necessity [الوجوب] of protection from error and sin [العصمة], its absence in others, and the presence of perfections in them.[127]

(780) والنقل المتواتر دل على الأحد عشر ولوجوب العصمة وانتفائها عن غيرهم ووجود الكمالات فيهم. · Āmulī pp. 397

Judgements concerning opponents

§781 Those who wage war against ʿAlī—peace be upon him—are unbelievers; those who oppose him [in the imamate] [الإمامة] are transgressors.

(781) ومحاربو علي عليه‌السلام كفرة ومخالفوه فسقة. · Āmulī pp. 398

[127] §780. The eleven are the imams after ʿAlī. Al-Ḥillī enumerates al-Ḥasan, al-Ḥusayn, ʿAlī Zayn al-ʿĀbidīn, Muḥammad al-Bāqir, Jaʿfar al-Ṣādiq, Mūsā al-Kāẓim, ʿAlī al-Riḍā, Muḥammad al-Jawād, ʿAlī al-Hādī, al-Ḥasan al-ʿAskarī, and the Awaited Imam.

Division 6
The return, the promise, the threat, and related matters

المقصد السادس في المعاد والوعد والوعيد وما يتصل بذلك

The possibility of another world

§782 The same judgement applies to two things that are alike; transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates the possibility [الإمكان] of a counterpart [to this world]. §783 Sphericity [as a necessary feature of another world], the necessity [الوجوب] of a void, and a divergence between things alike [in nature] are not conceded.[128]

(782) حكم المثلين واحد والسمع دل على إمكان المماثل (783) والكرية ووجوب الخلاء واختلاف المتفقات ممنوعة. · Āmulī pp. 398–400

The world and nonexistence

§784 Contingency [الإمكان] allows nonexistence [العدم] [of the world]. §785 Transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates its [actual] occurrence. §786 For the morally responsible person [المكلف], this is interpreted as the dispersal [of bodily parts], as in the story of Abraham—peace be upon him.[129]

(784) والإمكان يعطي جواز العدم.
(785) والسمع دل عليه. (786) ويتأول في المكلف بالتفريق كما في قصة إبراهيم عليه السلام. · Āmulī pp. 401–402

Against treating annihilation as an entity

§787 Positing annihilation [الفناء] [as a distinct existent] is unintelligible: if it subsisted by itself it would not be a contrary [to substance] [الجوهر]; and the same is true if it subsisted in a substance. §788 Also because there is no ground of priority [for its annihilating the substance [الجوهر] rather than the substance excluding it]. §789 Also because it entails either a reversal of essential natures or an infinite regress [التسلسل].

(787) وإثبات الفناء غير معقول لأنه إن قام بذاته لم يكن ضدا وكذا إن قام بالجوهر.
(788) ولانتفاء الأولوية. (789) ولاستلزامه انقلاب الحقائق أو التسلسل. · Āmulī pp. 403–404

Against treating persistence as an added entity

§790 Positing persistence [البقاء] (baqā') outside a substrate [المحل] entails either preference without a determining ground or the conjunction of contradictories. §791 Positing it within a substrate [المحل] entails a thing's dependence on itself, either immediately or through an intermediary.

(790) وإثبات بقاء لا في محل يستلزم الترجيح من غير مرجح أو اجتماع النقيضين. (791) وإثباته في المحل يستلزم توقف الشيء على نفسه إما ابتداء أو بواسطة. · Āmulī pp. 404–405

[128] §783. These are premises of objections to another world. 'Not conceded' denies their necessity [الوجوب] in the argument, rather than simply asserting that the present heavens are not spherical.

[129] §786. The dispersal account preserves the identity of what will be reassembled. Al-Ḥillī explicitly relates it to the earlier rejection of the restoration of what has become absolutely nonexistent, and to Qur'ān 2:260.

Bodily resurrection

§792 The obligation to fulfil the promise, and wisdom [الحكمة], require resurrection [البعث]. It is known without inference [الضرورة] that bodily [resurrection] [المعاد الجسماني] belongs to the religion of the Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—and it is possible. §793 It is not necessary to restore the morally responsible person [المكلف]'s superadded [bodily] parts.[130] §794 [Arguments from] the claim that the celestial spheres cannot be ruptured, Paradise's being above them, the persistence of life during burning, the generation of the body without procreation, and the finitude of bodily capacities [القوى الجسمانية] are merely appeals to improbability.

(792) ووجوب إيفاء الوعد والحكمة يقتضي وجوب البعث والضرورة قاضية بثبوت الجسماني من دين النبي صلى‌الله‌عليه‌وآله‌وسلم مع إمكانه.
(793) ولا تجب إعادة فواضل المكلف.
(794) وعدم انخراق الأفلاك وحصول الجنة فوقها ودوام الحياة مع الاحتراق وتولد البدن من غير التوالد وتناهي القوى الجسمانية استبعادات.

Āmulī pp. 405–407 ·

Deserving reward and punishment

§795 Reward [الثواب] and praise are deserved for performing the obligatory and the recommended, performing the contrary of what is bad, and omitting the bad—provided that the obligatory is done because it is obligatory or because of the ground of its obligatoriness; the recommended likewise; the contrary [of the bad] because it is abstention from the bad; and its omission because it is such an omission. For hardship without compensation [العوض] is injustice [الظلم]; and, if [the benefit] could be bestowed initially [without the obligation], [imposing the obligation] would be purposeless.[131]

(795) ويستحق الثواب والمدح بفعل الواجب والمندوب وفعل ضد القبيح والإخلال به بشرط فعل الواجب لوجوبه أو لوجه وجوبه والمندوب كذلك والضد لأنه ترك القبيح والإخلال به لأنه إخلال به لأن المشقة من غير عوض ظلم ولو أمكن الابتداء به كان عبثا.

Āmulī pp. 407–408 ·

§796 Likewise punishment [العقاب] and blame are deserved for doing what is bad and omitting what is obligatory, because [the prospect of punishment] provides gracious assistance [اللطف] and because of transmitted revelation [السمع].[132] §797 There is nothing improbable in simultaneously deserving [praise and blame] in different respects. §798 Imposing hardship as gratitude for a benefit is bad. §799 Also because reason [العقل] judges it [gratitude] obligatory despite ignorance [of revealed obligations].[133]

(796) وكذا يستحق العقاب والذم بفعل القبيح والإخلال بالواجب لاشتماله على اللطف وللسمع.
(797) ولا استبعاد في اجتماع الاستحقاقين باعتبارين. (798) وإيجاب المشقة في شكر النعمة قبيح. (799) ولقضاء العقل به مع الجهل.

Āmulī pp. 408–409 ·

§800 Deserving reward [الثواب] requires that the act or omission be difficult; it does not require the absence of regret for having performed it, nor the absence of immediate benefit, if it was performed for the relevant ground.[134]

(800) ويشترط في استحقاق الثواب كون الفعل أو الإخلال به شاقا لا رفع الندم على فعله ولا انتفاء النفع العاجل إذا فعل للوجه.

Āmulī pp. 410 ·

[130] §793. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes the original parts constituting personal bodily identity from parts added through growth and nutrition. Ṭūsī's short clause answers objections based on the changing matter of bodies.

[131] §795. The distinction between performing a contrary and mere omission is deliberate. The closing argument distinguishes reward [الثواب] accompanied by deserved honour from a benefit that could simply be bestowed without prior obedience; al-Ḥillī explains both points.

[132] §796. Al-Ḥillī explains that knowing one deserves punishment [العقاب] for disobedience deters the obligated person [المكلف] from it and brings that person nearer to obedience. The gracious assistance [اللطف] concerns that deterrent prospect.

[133] §799. Al-Ḥillī treats this as a second objection to al-Balkhī's claim that revealed obligations are simply payment of gratitude for prior benefits and therefore earn no reward [الثواب].

[134] §800. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes initially deserving reward [الثواب] from retaining that desert: the absence of subsequent regret is not a condition of the first, although it is relevant to the second.

The attributes of reward and punishment

§801 Reward [الثواب] must be accompanied by honour, and punishment [العقاب] by humiliation, because it is known without inference [العلم الضروري] that both are deserved when the acts that warrant them are performed. §802 Both must endure perpetually, because this provides gracious assistance [اللطف], because praise and blame endure, and because their opposites would occur without it.[135] §803 Both must be unmixed [with their opposites]. Otherwise reward [الثواب] would be inferior to compensation [العوض] and gratuitous favour [التفضل], supposing such purity in those two; and [unmixed punishment] [العقاب] is more effective as a deterrent.

(801) ويجب اقتران الثواب بالتعظيم والعقاب بالإهانة للعلم الضروري باستحقاقهما مع فعل موجبهما. (802) ويجب دوامهما لاشتماله على اللطفية ولدوام المدح والذم ولحصول نقيضهما لولاه. (803) ويجب خلوصهما وإلا لكان الثواب أنقص حالا من العوض والتفضل على تقدير حصوله فيهما وهو أدخل في باب الزجر. · Āmulī pp. 410–411

§804 Everyone who has a rank in Paradise desires no higher one. Their delight in gratitude reaches the point at which hardship disappears; their reward [الثواب] frees them from need and thus removes the difficulty of abstaining from bad acts. The people of the Fire are compelled to refrain from the bad.

(804) وكل ذي مرتبة في الجنة لا يطلب الأزيد ويبلغ سرورهم بالشكر إلى حد انتفاء المشقة وغنائهم بالثواب ينفي مشقة ترك القبائح وأهل النار يلجئون إلى ترك القبيح. · Āmulī pp. 411

The conditions of reward

§805 Reward [الثواب] may depend on a condition; otherwise the person who knows only God Most High would be rewarded [without accepting His messenger]. §806 It is conditioned on final perseverance [الموافاة] (muwāfāt), because of His—Most High—saying, 'If you associate partners [with God], your work will surely be nullified', and His saying, 'Whoever among you turns back from his religion'.[136]

(805) ويجوز توقف الثواب على شرط وإلا لأثيب العارف بالله تعالى خاصة. (806) وهو مشروط بالموافاة لقوله تعالى : (لَئِنْ أَشْرَكْتَ لَيَحْبَطَنَّ عَمَلُكَ) وقوله تعالى (وَمَنْ يَرْتَدِدْ مِنْكُمْ عَنْ دِينِهِ) · Āmulī pp. 412

The cancellation of merits and demerits

§807 Nullification [الإحباط] [of reward [الثواب] by subsequent sin] is false, because it entails injustice [الظلم], and because of His—Most High—saying, 'Whoever does an atom's weight of good will see it.'[137] §808 Also because there is no ground of priority when one is twice the other, and because contradictories result when they are equal.[138]

(807) والإحباط باطل لاستلزامه الظلم ولقوله تعالى (فَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْراً يَرَهُ). (808) ولعدم الأولوية إذا كان الآخر ضعفا وحصول المتناقضين مع التساوي. · Āmulī pp. 413

[135] §802. The scope of this general formulation is expressly qualified below: at §§809–810 Ṭūsī limits endless punishment [العقاب] to unbelief [الكفر] and rejects endless punishment for the believing perpetrator of a grave sin [الكبيرة].

[136] §806. Qur'ān 39:65 and 2:217. Muwāfāt concerns the final state in which one reaches death or the hereafter; the second cited verse continues by specifying death in unbelief [الكفر]. The matn quotes only its opening.

[137] §807. Qur'ān 99:7. The immediate target is the theory that accrued merits and demerits cancel each other, with differing formulations attributed by al-Ḥillī to Abū ʿAlī and Abū Hāshim.

[138] §808. Al-Ḥillī's example is five units of reward [الثواب] and ten of punishment [العقاب]: which equal half of the latter should the former cancel? If the two totals are equal, simultaneous mutual cancellation is alleged to require each to act while nonexistent. This explains the compressed objections without endorsing their validity.

The punishment of grave sinners

§809 The unbeliever remains forever [in punishment] [العقاب]; the punishment of the perpetrator of a grave sin [الكبيرة] comes to an end, because he deserves reward [الثواب] through his faith [الإيمان], and because [endless punishment in his case] is bad in the judgement of rational persons. §810 The transmitted texts [السمعيات] [cited against this] are subject to interpretation; perpetual punishment [العقاب] belongs exclusively to the unbeliever.

(809) والكافر مخلد وعذاب صاحب الكبيرة منقطع لاستحقاقه الثواب بإيمانه ولقبحه عند العقلاء. (810) والسمعيات متأولة ودوام العقاب مختص بالكافر. · Āmulī pp. 414–415

Divine pardon

§811 Pardon [العفو] occurs. For [punishment] [العقاب] is His—Most High—right and may therefore be waived; abandoning it causes Him no harm, while it harms the one on whom it descends, so waiving it is good; and it is an act of beneficence [الإحسان]. §812 Also because of transmitted revelation [السمع].

(811) والعفو واقع لأنه حقه تعالى فجاز إسقاطه ولا ضرر عليه في تركه مع ضرر النازل به فحسن إسقاطه ولأنه إحسان.
(812) وللسمع. · Āmulī pp. 415–416

Intercession

§813 There is consensus [الإجماع] concerning intercession [الشفاعة]. It has been said to consist in increasing benefits, but [confining it to this] is refuted by our [prayers] on his behalf—God bless him and his family and grant them peace.[139]
§814 Denying an [intercessor] who is obeyed does not entail denying one whose petition is answered. The remaining transmitted texts [السمعيات] [of denial] are interpreted as concerning unbelievers.

(813) والإجماع على الشفاعة فقيل لزيادة المنافع ويبطل بنا في حقه صلى الله عليه وآله وسلم.
(814) ونفي المطاع لا يستلزم نفي المجاب وباقي السمعيات متأولة بالكفار. · Āmulī pp. 416

§815 It has also been said to consist in removing harms. The truth is that 'intercession [الشفاعة]' applies to both, and that the second is established for him—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—by his saying, 'I have reserved my intercession for the perpetrators of grave sins [الكبيرة] among my community.'

(815) وقيل في إسقاط المضار والحق صدق الشفاعة فيهما وثبوت الثاني له صلى الله عليه وآله وسلم بقوله ادخرت شفاعتي لأهل الكبائر من أمتي. · Āmulī pp. 417

The obligation and intention of repentance

§816 Repentance [التوبة] is obligatory because it averts harm, and because remorse for every bad act or omission of an obligation is obligatory. §817 One must regret the bad because it is bad; otherwise repentance [التوبة] is absent. If fear of the Fire is the ultimate aim, the same applies; likewise with omission [of an obligation].

(816) والتوبة واجبة لدفعها الضرر ولوجوب الندم على كل قبيح أو إخلال بواجب. (817) ويندم على القبيح لقبحه وإلا انتفت وخوف النار إن كان الغاية فكذلك وكذا الإخلال. · Āmulī pp. 417–418

[139] §813. The objection is that prayers asking God to raise the Prophet's rank would then make ordinary believers his intercessors. The next two lemmata develop the competing account and Ṭūsī's conclusion.

Repentance from some sins

§818 It therefore cannot be valid for some [bad acts alone]; and the analogy with performing an obligation does not hold.[140] §819 But if he believes [the unrepented act] to be good, it is valid. §820 The same applies when an [unrepented] wrong is regarded as negligible [beside the graver wrong repented of].[141]

(818) فلا تصح من البعض ولا يتم القياس على الواجب. (819) ولو اعتقد فيه الحسن صحت. (820) و كذا المستحقر. · Āmulī pp. 419

§821 The correct analysis is that a preponderant motive [الداعي] for remorse over some [bad acts] brings it about, although the motive for regretting the bad is shared, just as with motives for action. If the preponderance were shared, the occurrence of remorse would also be shared. The words of the Commander of the Faithful and his descendants—peace be upon them—are to be interpreted accordingly. Otherwise one would have to judge unbelief [الكفر] to persist in a person who repents of it while continuing in a minor sin.[142]

(821) والتحقيق أن ترجيح الداعي إلى الندم عن البعض يبعث عليه وإن اشترك الداعي في الندم على القبيح كما في الدواعي إلى الفعل ولو اشترك الترجيح اشترك وقوع الندم وبه يتأول كلام أمير المؤمنين وأولاده عليهم‌السلام وإلا لزم الحكم ببقاء الكفر على التائب منه المقيم على صغيرة. · Āmulī pp. 420

Repentance and outstanding obligations

§822 If a sin against His—Most High—right consists in a bad act, remorse and resolve [not to return to it] suffice. For omitting an obligation, the ruling differs according to whether [the obligation] remains due, requires later performance, or neither. If the sin concerns a human being's right, it is followed by restoring that right when it was an injustice [الظلم]—or resolving to restore it when unable—or by giving guidance when it was misguidance. These are not constituent parts [of repentance] [التوبة].[143] §823 One must apologize to the person one has backbitten when [the backbiting] has come to his attention.

(822) والذنب إن كان في حقه تعالى من فعل قبيح كفى فيه الندم والعزم وفي الإخلال بالواجب اختلف حكمه من بقائه وقضائه وعدمهما وإن كان في حق آدمي استتبع إيصاله إن كان ظلما أو العزم عليه مع التعذر أو الإرشاد إن كان إضلالا وليس ذلك أجزاء. (823) ويجب الاعتذار إلى المغتاب مع بلوغه. · Āmulī pp. 421–422

Disputed requirements of repentance

§824 There is difficulty concerning the requirement [to repent] in detail when [the sins] are remembered. §825 There is also difficulty concerning the obligation to renew [repentance [التوبة] when a sin is remembered again]. §826 Likewise concerning [repentance [التوبة] for] the effect together with its cause [before the effect has occurred].[144] §827 And [likewise, there is difficulty concerning] the necessity [الوجوب] of punishment [العقاب]'s being remitted through it.[145]

(824) وفي إيجاب التفصيل مع الذكر إشكال. (825) وفي وجوب التجديد إشكال. (826) و كذا المعلول مع العلة. (827) ووجوب سقوط العقاب بها. · Āmulī pp. 422–423

[140] §818. This is the argument considered before Ṭūsī's own more discriminating resolution at §821. That resolution must be read with the present clause.

[141] §820. The clause concerns repentance [التوبة] from a grave wrong while a much lesser wrong remains unrepented. Al-Ḥillī still states that remorse for all one's wrongdoing is required.

[142] §821. Ṭūsī distinguishes a general reason for remorse from its differing motivational strength in particular cases. Partial repentance [التوبة] is therefore not excluded absolutely.

[143] §822. The digital source reads ijzā' (إجزاء), but al-Jalālī, p.307, visibly prints ajzā' (أجزاء), 'parts', agreeing with al-Ḥillī's explanation. The translation follows this verified reading. The ensuing duties are distinguished from the definition of repentance [التوبة].

[144] §826. Al-Ḥillī's example is a person who has shot an arrow before it hits: must remorse concern the shooting, the anticipated injury, or

The effect of repentance

§828 Punishment [العقاب] is remitted through [repentance] [التوبة], not through the abundance of its reward [الثواب], since it may occur with [its reward] nullified. Otherwise there would be no difference between preceding and following [the sin], and no restriction [to the sin repented of]. It is not accepted in the hereafter because the condition is absent.[146]

(828) والعقاب يسقط بها لا بكثرة ثوابها لأنها قد تقع محبطة ولولاه لا يبقى الفرق بين التقدم والتأخر ولا اختصاص ولا تقبل في الآخرة لانتفاء الشرط. · Āmulī pp. 424

The grave and the events of the return

§829 Punishment in the grave [عذاب القبر] occurs, because it is possible and because recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] revelation attests its occurrence. §830 The other matters received through revelation—the Balance, the Path, the Reckoning, and the flying forth of the records—are possible, and transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates their reality; they must therefore be affirmed.

(829) وعذاب القبر واقع لإمكانه وتواتر السمع بوقوعه. (830) وسائر السمعيات من الميزان والصراط والحساب وتطاير الكتب ممكنة دل السمع على ثبوتها فيجب التصديق بها. · Āmulī pp. 424–425

Paradise and the Fire

§831 Transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates that Paradise and the Fire have already been created; the opposing texts are subject to interpretation.

(831) والسمع دل على أن الجنة والنار مخلوقتان الآن والمعارضات متأولة. · Āmulī pp. 426

Faith unbelief and transgression

§832 Faith [الإيمان] is assent [التصديق] by heart and tongue. The first alone does not suffice, because of His—Most High—saying, 'Their souls were certain of them', and similar texts; nor does the second alone, because of His saying, 'Say: You have not believed.'[147] §833 Unbelief [الكفر] is the absence of faith [الإيمان], whether accompanied by its contrary or not. Transgression [الفسق] (fisq) is departure from obedience to God Most High while retaining faith. Hypocrisy [النفاق] is displaying faith while concealing unbelief. §834 The transgressor is a believer, because the definition [of a believer] is realised in him.

(832) والإيمان التصديق بالقلب واللسان ولا يكفي الأول لقوله تعالى (وَاسْتَيْقَنَتْهَا أَنفُسُهُمْ) ونحوه ولا الثاني لقوله (قُلْ لَمْ تُؤْمِنُوا). (833) والكفر عدم الإيمان إما مع الضد أو بدونه والفسق الخروج عن طاعة الله تعالى مع الإيمان والنفاق إظهار الإيمان وإخفاء الكفر. (834) والفاسق مؤمن لوجود حده فيه. · Āmulī pp. 426–427

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both?

[145] §827. The Arabic inherits 'there is difficulty' from the preceding lemmata. Al-Ḥillī explicitly reads it this way; rendering this as a positive assertion that remission is necessarily obligatory would reverse the sense. Compare al-Jalālī, pp.307–308.

[146] §828. The distinction is between repentance [التوبة]'s own effect, when its conditions hold, and an arithmetic excess of reward [الثواب] over punishment [العقاب]. Al-Ḥillī explains the absent condition in the hereafter by the compulsion of direct experience: the remorse is no longer chosen because the act is bad.

[147] §832. Qur'ān 27:14 and 49:14. The first fragment belongs to a verse describing outward denial despite inward certainty.

Enjoining right and forbidding wrong

§835 Enjoining what is obligatorily right is obligatory, as is forbidding wrong. [Enjoining] what is recommended is recommended. [These rulings are established] by transmitted revelation [السمع]; otherwise either something contrary to actuality or a failure in His—Most High—wisdom [الحكمة] would follow.[148] §836 Their conditions are that the person undertaking them knows the relevant moral status, considers that they may be effective, and [anticipates] no harmful consequence.

(835) والأمر بالمعروف الواجب واجب وكذا النهي عن المنكر ، والمندوب مندوب سمعا وإلا لزم خلاف الواقع أو الإخلال بحكمته تعالى.

(836) وشروطهما علم فاعلهما بالوجه وتجويز التأثير وانتفاء المفسدة. · Āmulī pp. 427–428

Closing formula in al-Jalālī's edition

And God knows best what is correct.[149]

والله أعلم بالصواب

[148] §835. 'By transmitted revelation [السمع]' governs the obligation to enjoin and forbid. Al-Ḥillī explains the rejected rational argument as one that would impose the same duty on God in a way that either eliminates wrongdoing altogether or attributes neglected obligation to Him. This is not a denial that acts themselves have rationally knowable goodness [الحسن] and badness [القبح].

[149] Al Jalālī, p.310, prints this formula in parentheses; his apparatus records its absence from witnesses bā' and dāl. It is absent from the controlling extracted matn and is therefore presented separately.

Terminology guide

These explanations describe how the terms function in this translation. They are reading aids tied to the passages cited, not an exhaustive history of the terminology.

English and contextual explanation	Arabic term
existence. The shared notion of being, distinguished from quiddity and divided into mental and external existence. §§2, 4, 5, 14, 16	وجود wujūd
nonexistence. Negation or absence of existence, considered absolutely or in relation to a specified thing or possession. §§28, 34, 35, 42	عدم ʿadam
quiddity. What answers "What is it?"; considered in itself, it carries no additional determination merely by being that quiddity. §§135, 138	ماهية māhiyya
essence; the thing itself. The thing itself or its essence; §135 applies the term to quiddity with existence taken into account. §§70, 135, 254	ذات dhāt
reality; essential nature. A thing's reality or nature; §135 associates this term with quiddity regarded together with existence. §§135, 136, 398	حقيقة ḥaqīqa
establishment. Establishment may be mental or external; §28 identifies the relevant sense with existence while rejecting an intermediate state. §§26, 28, 40, 57, 60	ثبوت thubūt
thingness. The consideration of something as a thing; treated as a secondary intelligible and coextensive with existence. §§23, 40	شيئية shay'iyya
possibility; contingency. Intrinsic contingency excludes necessity of both existence and nonexistence; broader modal and dispositional senses are distinguished in the text. §§46, 53, 64, 73, 76	إمكان imkān
necessity; obligation. Necessity in existence or in the connection of a predicate with its subject. Intrinsic necessity differs from necessity through another: a contingent thing may be necessitated by its cause without becoming necessary in itself. In moral and legal arguments, wujūb means obligation; it is not reserved for God's mode of existence. §§46, 61, 71–72, 74, 474, 650, 658, 792	وجوب wujūb
impossibility. Necessity of nonexistence, either in itself or through another; one of the three modalities alongside necessity and possibility. §§46, 50, 51, 58, 61	امتناع imtināʿ
necessity; non-inferential or self-evident. In modal usage, ḍarūra includes both necessity and impossibility: necessary affirmation or existence, and necessary negation or nonexistence. It is therefore not exclusively a term for how something is known. In epistemic usage, ḍarūrī describes immediate or non-inferential knowledge, obtained without a deliberate process of proof. It does not mean a merely spontaneous belief, and correct conception may still be required. Al-Ḥillī's sixfold account includes sensory awareness and cognition involving implicit reasoning. Such knowledge can concern contingent facts; a necessary truth can conversely require demonstration. The epistemic division in §448 must be distinguished from the division of knowledge by its mode of existence in §449. §§51, 53, 69, 124, 438, 448–449, 452, 675	ضرورة / ضروري ḍarūra / ḍarūrī
power. The power to act, especially in voluntary agency. Rendered "power" to distinguish it from the several contextual senses of quwwa. This is an English translation convention; the Arabic semantic fields can overlap. §§24, 487, 491, 493, 576, 714	قدرة qudra

English and contextual explanation	Arabic term
potentiality; faculty; capacity; force. Potentiality when opposed to actuality; a faculty in psychology; a capacity in broader causal contexts; an acquired force in forced motion; and strength when describing the degree of an ability. A capacity can remain while exercised; potentiality opposed to actuality concerns what is not actual in the relevant respect. §§238, 304, 340, 343, 352, 516, 525, 557, 756, 794	قوة quwwa
analogical predication. Predication of a shared meaning with differences of priority or strength, as illustrated by existence, priority, and opposition. §§38, 79, 90, 189	تشكيك tashkīk
eternity; beginninglessness. Being unpreceded by another or by nonexistence, according to the respect considered; essential and temporal questions must be distinguished. §§77, 82, 84	قدم qidam
origination. Being preceded by another or by nonexistence; essential origination and temporal coming-to-be are distinct considerations. §§77, 82, 83, 320, 323	حدوث ḥudūth
substance. A contingent existent not existing in a subject; this classification does not imply independence from every cause or from matter. §§253, 254, 258, 338	جوهر jawhar
accident. An existent in a subject; the discussion includes quantity, quality, and the other categories examined in Division II. §§253, 256, 376, 377, 390	عرض ʿaraḍ
subject. A substrate subsisting independently of the accident it supports; in logic, the subject of predication. §§35, 36, 111, 253, 255, 256	موضوع mawḍūʿ
receptacle; substrate. A receptacle for something inhering; broader than subject because it can include matter constituted by form. §§228, 231, 254, 255, 257	محل maḥall
matter. The receptive factor in a composite; §284 rejects inferring matter additional to body from the body's divisibility. §§228, 254, 284	مادة mādda
form. The formal factor in a composite; also a mental representation or the arrangement of an inference, according to context. §§15, 231, 254, 441, 472	صورة ṣūra
soul. The first perfection of a potentially living organic body; the rational soul's immateriality is argued separately. §§331, 338, 351, 352	نفس nafs
intellect; reason. Can designate a separate immaterial substance or an intellectual disposition or faculty; the context determines which sense is intended. §§254, 327, 457, 458, 692	عقل ʿaql
conception. Apprehension of a thing without thereby affirming or denying a proposition; one of the two divisions of knowledge. §§124, 436, 438	تصور taṣawwur
assent. Affirmative or negative judgement; knowledge properly so called requires firm, corresponding, stable assent, and the term also appears in the definition of faith. §§3, 436, 438, 832	تصديق taṣdīq
goodness; moral acceptability. In §619 this broad category includes obligatory, recommended, permissible, and disliked acts: their performance does not merit blame. §§619, 620	حسن ḥusn
badness; moral wrongness. Marks the blameworthiness of an act; the text argues that it can be known rationally, as with injustice. §§619, 620, 626, 796	قبح qubḥ

English and contextual explanation	Arabic term
gracious assistance. Assistance bringing the accountable agent nearer obedience or farther from wrongdoing while preserving choice; applied to prophecy and the imamate. §§658, 664, 692, 694, 711	لطف luṭf
moral obligation; imposition of obligation. The imposition of a known, demanding obligation on an agent; mukallaf is the person addressed by that obligation. §§474, 647, 650, 651	تكليف taklīf
compensation. A deserved benefit without the honour accompanying reward; especially important in the argument about pain and wrongful injury. §§674, 675, 678, 684	عوض ʿiwaḍ
reward. Deserved benefit for obedience, accompanied by honour; its grounds, conditions, and duration receive separate treatment. §§795, 800, 801, 802, 805, 806	ثواب thawāb
punishment. Deserved harm accompanied by humiliation; entitlement to it is distinguished from its execution, since pardon and intercession are admitted. §§796, 801, 811, 815	عقاب ʿiqāb
nullification. The disputed cancellation of prior reward by later sin; its rejection is paired with separate conditions concerning final perseverance. §§806, 807, 808	إحباط iḥbāṭ
return; resurrection. The eschatological return; bodily resurrection is defended through the reassembly of dispersed bodily parts. §§782, 786, 792, 793	معاد maʿād
protection from error and sin. Protection required of prophets and the imam; the text expressly treats it as compatible with the power to sin. §§695, 713, 714, 716	عصمة ʿiṣma
relation; the relative. Relation itself is distinguished from the thing bearing it; its establishment is argued to be mental. §§514, 515, 516, 518	إضافة / مضاف iḍāfa / muḍāf
motion; change. The first perfection of what is potential as potential; discussed in quantity, quality, place, and position. §§525, 533, 538, 540, 541	حركة ḥaraka

Sources and editorial scope

Primary text. Naṣīr al Dīn al Ṭūsī, Tajrīd al iʿtiqād, as quoted in al ʿAllāma al Ḥillī, Kashf al murād fī sharḥ Tajrīd al iʿtiqād, edited and annotated by Ḥasan Ḥasanzāda Āmulī, Muʾassasat al Nashr al Islāmī. Rafed electronic edition, 646 pages. The translated matn occurs on pp.20–428. The continuous medieval commentary was used for interpretation; modern annotations beginning on p.429 were excluded from the translation corpus.

Comparison text. Naṣīr al Dīn al Ṭūsī, Tajrīd al iʿtiqād, edited by Muḥammad Jawād al Ḥusaynī al Jalālī. Qum: Markaz al Nashr, Maktab al Iʿlām al Islāmī, first edition, 1407 AH / 1986–87. Princeton University Libraries copy digitised by Arabic Collections Online. The matn runs from printed p.101 to p.310. Selected readings were checked, rather than every witness or every apparatus entry.

Terminological check. Muḥammad ʿAlī al Tahānawī, Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al funūn wa al ʿulūm, 1996 edition, vol.1, p.90, entry ubna, was consulted for the historical term in §696. The glossary otherwise follows the local usage of the matn and al Ḥillī's explanations.

Modern translation identified. Sayyid Amjad H. Shah Naqavi, Theology Abstracted, an Arabic critical edition and English translation of Ṭūsī's Tajrīd al-iʿtiqād. London: The Shīʿah Institute Press, 2025. ISBN 9781917761000. The public preview, including the editorial introduction and selected Arabic and English passages, was consulted during revision. The complete book was not collated.

Assessment of editions. Al-Jalālī describes four manuscript witnesses and comparison with earlier commentaries (introduction, pp.76–85). Naqavi's preview identifies Tehran Majlis 9006/630, fols.65r–80v, as his base witness and discusses its audition note (introduction, pp.11–13). These are distinct editorial undertakings. Establishing a definitive text would require a full comparison of their evidence and apparatus; recency alone cannot settle the readings.

English style. Michael E. Marmura's introduction and conventions for Avicenna, The Metaphysics of The Healing (BYU Press, 2005), and a sample of his earlier translation of "On the Relative" were consulted as stylistic and editorial models. Jon McGinnis and David C. Reisman's translator preface to Classical Arabic Philosophy (Hackett, 2007, pp.xi–xii) also informed the balance between idiomatic English and visible ambiguity. These modern works guide presentation, not the interpretation of Ṭūsī's doctrines; their translations have not been copied into this text.

Arabic terminology. Selected technical senses were cross-checked against Jamīl Ṣalībā's al-Muʿjam al-falsafī and al-Tahānawī's Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al-funūn wa-l-ʿulūm. These references clarify distinctions between related terms. Ṭūsī's Arabic and the local argument control the bracketed equivalents.

Jamīl Ṣalībā, al-Muʿjam al-falsafī. Entries consulted include imkān (I, pp. 134–135), ḍarūra (I, p. 757), māhiyya (II, pp. 314–315), mawḍūʿ (II, p. 447), qudra (II, p. 188), quwwa (II, p. 201), qadīm (II, p. 189), and sarmadī (I, p. 654). Online text.

Muḥammad ʿAlī al-Tahānawī, Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al-funūn wa-l-ʿulūm. Entries consulted include wujūb, dhāt, ḥāll, iḍāfa, taklīf, ḥusn, qudra, and luṭf. Online text.

Textual limits. This volume translates the complete accessible recension embedded in al Ḥillī's commentary. It is not a newly constituted critical Arabic text, an exhaustive manuscript collation, or a translation of all commentaries. Notable differences from al Jalālī are identified at §§1, 312, 366, 496, 572, 579, 605, 636, 683, and 822, and at the separately identified closing formula. Some of these are transcription corrections or agreements in a sensitive reading, rather than divergent textual clauses.

Interpretive limits. Bracketed explanations usually follow the attached al Ḥillī commentary. Where he offers alternatives, disagrees with the matn, or where the supplied reading remains difficult, the relevant note says so. Later commentaries by al Iṣfahānī, al Jurjānī, al Qūshjī, and al Lāhījī have not been comprehensively collated for this version.

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McGinnis and Reisman Classical Arabic Philosophy

Al Tahānawī dictionary entry

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